



गौरव अभियान

Seva Se Samarpan



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Visionary Prime Minister
Hon'ble Shri.

Narendra Modi ji

Heartiest congratulations

-: Well-wisher :-

Ek Nath Sambhaji Shinde
Deputy Chief Minister, Maharashtra





French riot police stand guard during a student protest over overcrowded classrooms, teacher shortages and dilapidated schools, in Paris on Tuesday. REUTERS

Police fire tear gas as France school protests draw 2,50,000

Associated Press
Paris, October 6

POLICE FIRED tear gas to control crowds in Paris and elsewhere in France on Tuesday as more than a quarter of a million people rallied nationwide to support school pupils demanding more education funding, according to government figures. The protests increased pressure on administration of outgoing President Emmanuel Macron.

As pupils again blockaded high schools, large crowds waving flags and placards gathered in Marseille, Strasbourg and other cities. The demonstrations showed how protests that began at a high school in the Paris region in mid-September have grown into a nationwide movement — the latest of many that have marked Macron’s nearly

decade-long tenure.

“We need to listen to them,” said Léa Monimart, a demonstrator in the northern city of Lille. “They are 17 years old; they are not clueless, and they know what they are talking about. It’s important to show there are adults who support them.”

The Interior Ministry estimated that 256,000 people took part in demonstrations across the country on Tuesday, including 56,000 in Paris, where small groups of protesters clashed with riot officers at a city square during a largely peaceful march through the city.

The widespread use of arrests, tear gas and riot-control weapons against teenagers is fueling defiance and angering some parents and teachers.

Interior Minister Laurent Nuñez said police response had

been proportionate in “almost all cases” and that the protests had at times turned into riots, requiring police intervention.

French Prime Minister Sébastien Lecornu said the government and school leaders must listen to students’ concerns and find solutions.

Questioned in parliament on Tuesday about protest movement, Lecornu denounced “ultra violence” threatening schools. Responding to criticism of police tactics, he pledged any “accidents” would be investigated and described allegations that the police are racist as a “lie.”

More than two weeks of class boycotts and school blockades, and policing that has led to over 6,100 arrests, mostly of minors, have become a flashpoint in the early days of the presidential election campaign.

PREPARING COUNTERMEASURES FOR MASSIVE RUSSIAN STRIKE, SAYS ZELENSKY

Ukraine fires 900 drones at Russia, braces for response

Over 650 drones targeted Moscow: Defence Ministry

Associated Press
Kyiv, October 6

RUSSIAN AIR defenses intercepted nearly 900 Ukrainian drones overnight over multiple regions of the country, as well as occupied Crimean Peninsula and Sea of Azov, Defence Ministry in Moscow said Tuesday.

Unconfirmed media reports said a major fuel depot in the Moscow region was on fire after the attack that killed two people. Ukraine’s domestically developed long-range drones and, increasingly, missiles have allowed Kyiv to hit Russian soil during the more than 4 and a half years since Moscow’s forces launched a full-scale invasion. It has hit targets as far as Urals and Siberia.

The bigger Russian military’s air superiority during the war has made aerial attacks on civilian areas of Ukraine routine.

Ukrainian officials are now bracing for what President Volodymyr Zelenskyy warned Tuesday is an upcoming “massive” aerial attack by Russia.

“Today, we received updated intelligence on Russia’s preparations for a massive strike. We are preparing countermeasures,” Zelenskyy said on social media.



Rescue workers extinguish burning ambulances after a Russian strike damaged a medical facility in Kramatorsk, Ukraine, on Tuesday. REUTERS

“We set deadlines for a significant part of the tasks, and the highest-priority ones are already being implemented.”

Ukraine’s Foreign Minister Andrii Sybiha said last week that Kyiv estimates Russia is holding 600 ballistic missiles in reserve and can produce up to 140 ballistic missiles per month.

Without ammunition for its US-made Patriot air defense systems, which is in short supply, Ukraine is at the mercy of Russia’s ballistic weapons.

Moscow Mayor Sergei Sobyenin said 650 drones flew toward the Moscow region between Monday evening and Tuesday morning. Most were destroyed far away, and 105 were downed as they approached city, he said.

Sobyenin later reported 68 more drones targeting Moscow were downed during daylight on Tuesday morning.

Ukraine has regularly targeted Russian oil refineries and storage depots, claiming last weekend that it had disabled 51% of Russia’s oil refining capacity. The claim could not be independently verified. Russian President Vladimir Putin said last week that the attacks had cost Russia roughly 1% of its gross domestic product.

Russia has traditionally been the world’s third-largest producer of refined fuel products from crude, after the US and China. The Kremlin has banned diesel exports due to the Ukrainian strikes, pushing global prices

Israeli dentist recalls 45-min care that saved Capt Machchhar’s life

Press Trust of India
Tel Aviv, October 6

CAPTAIN SMIT Machchhar suffered severe bleeding to his head and hand after being attacked by the co-pilot of a Tel Aviv-bound flydubai flight, surviving through the 45-minute intervention of an Israeli dentist on board. Dr Shuta Musaev, a Georgian dentist living in Israel, used makeshift pressure dressings and ice packs to stabilise Machchhar after his pulse dropped dangerously low.

Speaking to ABC News, Musaev recounted the medical crisis after Omani national Hamamal-Hammami attacked Machchhar in an attempt to crash the aircraft carrying more than 170 passengers.

Machchhar, hailed as a “hero” by Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu, is making “steady progress” and “regaining his health” at a hospital in the United Arab Emirates, the Indian Embassy in the UAE said Tuesday.

Musaev said Machchhar was lying injured on the cockpit floor



Dubai Crown Prince visits injured Captain Smit Machchhar at a hospital in Abu Dhabi. FILE

when he realised the plane was descending and made “one last push” to open the cockpit door.

Musaev rushed forward after hearing screams, helped restrain the attacker and then treated the captain, who was bleeding from wounds to his head, neck and hands. Another passenger, Yaniv Hayun, dragged the suspect from the cockpit, took control of the plane and levelled it before a third pilot took control.

“There was heavy bleeding from his head and left hand,” Musaev told The National from Holon. He used T-shirts to press the wounds, but the bleeding continued. He then asked the stewards for ice.

“He had very, very deep cuts and we needed many ice packets,” Musaev said. He kept applying pressure for 45 minutes, while reassuring Machchhar and asking him not to sleep.

“Help me, please. Help me, please. I don’t want to die here,” Musaev recalled him saying.

When Machchhar’s pulse became too low, Musaev raised his feet and said his pulse returned. When his lips turned blue, Musaev urged the steward to land quickly.

Musaev gave Machchhar small sips of water but decided

against administering pills because of the heavy bleeding and risk of re-bleeding. He monitored the captain’s vital signs, using his speech, pulse and lip colour as indicators.

A small group scanned the cabin for attackers until landing.

Musaev handed Machchhar over to doctors on the ground. He later said he and his wife suffered post-traumatic stress in the days following.

“Smit saved our lives. Smit is a hero,” Musaev said. “It’s karma, he saved our lives, and we saved his life.”

Russia: No plague cases detected among contacts of deceased lab worker

Reuters
Moscow, October 6

RUSSIA’S HEALTH watchdog said on Tuesday that no cases of plague had been detected among anyone who had come into contact with a Siberian plague institute laboratory worker who died last week, and locals said their lives had barely been disrupted.

Authorities say the 28-year-old woman died on Friday from pneumonia of an as-yet unestablished origin, in a case that has prompted international concern, including from US President Donald Trump.

Rospotrebnadzor, the watchdog, said in a statement that no infectious diseases had been reported among the staff of the same plague research institute

in Irkutsk over the past 10 days and that extensive testing had found no microorganisms in the deceased woman’s body linked to her work.

“A comprehensive set of anti-epidemic measures was immediately organised and implemented in full in accordance with public health legislation,” the watchdog said.

“This included identifying the widest possible circle of individuals who had been in contact with the patient and arranging for them to be placed under medical observation in hospital with daily laboratory tests.”

It said the results had revealed two cases of COVID-19 and two cases of rhinovirus infection, but that no pathogens causing other infectious diseases had been detected.

US, China discuss reciprocal visits to n-sites: CNN

Washington: The United States has discussed starting reciprocal visits to nuclear sites with China, and plans to continue pushing in meetings in the coming months, CNN reported Tuesday, citing sources familiar with the matter.

The idea of reciprocal visits was raised by China in meetings with US officials this year, and visits to US Department of Energy national laboratories and equivalent Chinese facilities were discussed, CNN said, citing a source.

The discussions between US and Chinese officials have mainly been on the sidelines of gatherings by the UN Security Council’s five veto-wielding permanent members, CNN reported. Reuters could not immediately verify the report.

The White House and the Chinese embassy in Washington did not respond to requests for comment. REUTERS

US military restricts Okinawa troops after Marine held for killing woman

Reuters
Washington, October 6

THE US military in Okinawa, Japan, is pausing all operations for two days, restricting the ability of troops to leave their base and ordering training after a Marine was arrested on suspicion of killing a local woman.

Lt. Gen. Benjamin Watson, commander of III Marine Expeditionary Force, said in a letter posted on social media Tuesday episodes like these “demand we pause for reflection” and that serving on the Japanese island “comes with responsibility.”

The arrest of the Marine has renewed protests against the heavy American military presence on the southern island and the rise in military-related crime. The killing could also complicate Prime Minister Sanae Takaichi’s push to



US Marine Devin Jacob Ballard is escorted to Naha prosecutors’ office in Okinawa, Japan. FILE

strengthen the Japanese military on Okinawa and to work closely with US military to deter China in the region.

“We live, work, and socialize alongside the people of Okinawa; their home is our home,” Watson wrote. “Every interaction with our neighbors either

builds or undermines the trust that is essential to our team. When that trust is damaged, it affects the strength of our alliance and the security of this region. Accordingly, we will take time to think hard about discipline, standards and our alliance responsibilities.”

The 48-hour pause will last from Wednesday through Friday. Service members will receive training on standards, discipline and “our responsibilities as members of the Okinawa community.”

Okinawa prefectural police said they arrested Lance Cpl. Devin Jacob Ballard, 20, who is stationed at Futenma Air Station, on suspicion of strangling Anna Yagi, 39, at a hotel in the island’s capital city, Naha, early Saturday and stealing her wallet and backpack. He has denied the allegations, according to Japanese media.

UK police arrest 7th suspect over security incident at Fairford base

Associated Press
London, October 6

BRITISH POLICE on Tuesday arrested a 22-year-old man in London on suspicion of a terror offense over a security incident at a US-run military airbase in England that authorities have linked to Iran.

The arrest is the seventh in connection with a suspected plot against RAF Fairford, located 160 kilometres west of London, which has been used by American bombers to strike Iran during this year’s war.

Counter Terrorism Policing said the man, a British national, was detained in the Westminster area of central London on suspicion of preparation of terrorist acts. Six other men have been released on bail under probe.

Vicki Evans, the senior national coordinator for counter-terrorism policing said detectives “continue to pursue multiple lines of enquiry” and “remain committed to investigating all possible angles.”

Scores of residents were evacuated from their homes near the base early on September 27 as armed police officers and army bomb-disposal experts swooped on the rural area. Police later said they had found a quantity of an accelerant, gasoline, in three vans linked to the five suspects, but no explosives.

Prime Minister Andy Burnham has said the UK sees “strong indications” Iran played a part in incident, without saying why or what the nature of the plot was.

• BRIEFLY

GERMANY

Ex-spy chief arrested on suspicion of trading state secrets and treason



August Hanning, former intelligence chief

A FORMER head of Germany’s foreign intelligence service was arrested on Tuesday on suspicion that he had passed state secrets to a foreign intelligence service, federal prosecutor’s office said. August Hanning, who led the Federal Intelligence Service, known by its German acronym BND, from 1998 to 2005, is “strongly suspected of treasonous espionage, spying out state secrets, attempted treason, and espionage,” the federal prosecutor’s office said in a statement. Hanning

was arrested in Bad Tölz-Wolfratshausen in southern Germany. A former aide, identified as Manfred D, was also arrested on Tuesday and has been charged with aiding and abetting attempted treason and treasonous espionage. AP

PAKISTAN

PM Sharif invites Imran Khan’s party for talks

PRIME MINISTER Shehbaz Sharif on Tuesday invited the opposition Pakistan Tehreek-i-Insaf (PTI) for talks to resolve contentious issues through dialogue, as he urged the party founded by jailed former premier Imran Khan to call off its long march to Islamabad. Sharif issued the call for talks two days after the PTI launched its long march from Lakki Marwat town of Khyber-Pakhtunkhwa with the intention to make it to the national capital in the coming days to give a sit-in to press the government to set Khan free. PTI

KENYA

Kenya confirms first Ebola case linked to Congo

KENYA CONFIRMED its first Ebola case on Tuesday after a Kenyan citizen who had travelled from Democratic Republic of Congo died in Nairobi. Kenya is the fourth country to record a case linked to the Ebola epidemic in eastern Congo, the second largest on record with over 8,000 cases. The Kenyan patient, who had lived in Congo for seven years, had been ill for about a month before travelling by road from Congo to Uganda’s capital, Kampala, and then flying to Nairobi on Saturday, Kenya’s Health Minister Aden Duale told a news meet. REUTERS

• BEST-SELLING NOVELIST WAS MEMBER OF PARLIAMENT & DEPUTY HEAD OF THATCHER’S CONSERVATIVE PARTY

Jeffrey Archer, whose real life rivalled the twists of his edge-of-seat thrillers, dies at 86

Alan Cowel,
October 6

JEFFREY ARCHER, a bestselling British author, politician, philanthropist, athlete and one-time jailbird, whose resume seesawed between achievement and disgrace, and who inspired abiding public fascination with headline-grabbing accounts, both fictional and personal, of ambition, self-promotion, misbehavior and scandal, died Monday at his London home. He was 86.

His publisher, HarperCollins, announced his death in a statement. His final novel, *Adam and Eve*, about the intertwined destinies of the highborn and the humble, was scheduled

for publication Tuesday.

Archer’s thrillers and sagas of the rich and powerful sold hundreds of millions of copies worldwide. In his London apartment overlooking the Thames, the walls were adorned with paintings, including works by Claude Monet and Pablo Picasso.

As a host there, he became known for annual parties at which celebrity guests were served top-end Krug Champagne and lowly shepherd’s pie. He also maintained homes in Mallorca and in the village of Grantchester outside Cambridge, England, where he bought the 17th century Old Vicarage, once the home of poet Rupert Brooke. Routinely,

he was reported to borrow the overseas homes of wealthy friends and acquaintances to compose the multiple first drafts of his novels.

In his days as a politician — both as a member of Parliament in the elected House of Commons and as deputy head of Margaret Thatcher’s Conservative Party — he displayed a barely veiled hunger for the top job. His friendships and alliances eventually won him a place in the unelected House of Lords with the title Baron Archer of Weston-super-Mare — his childhood hometown in southwest England.

A political Houdini, he survived many vicissitudes, in-



Jeffrey Archer at his London flat in 2011. REUTERS FILE

cluding a perjury conviction in 2001 when he was found guilty of creating false diaries and concocting a story to win a trial over whether he had slept with

a prostitute to whom he paid hush money.

He once said that politics was his first choice of career, but it was from his 40-plus books that

he amassed wealth, starting with a novel entitled *Not a Penny More, Not a Penny Less*, published in 1976 after he had been defrauded of his personal fortune and stepped down as a law-maker. “I was so low I would have sold fake Gucci bags on street corners,” he told the Chicago Tribune. “Once you’ve lost a million dollars, you may as well have lost a hundred million dollars.”

A former public relations man, he turned to writing thrillers and found he had an immediate skill for quick action that connected with readers. “Where I come from in the West Country, we say ‘Tell ‘em a yarn, m’dear, and make ‘em keep turning the pages, and you won’t be

far wrong,” he explained.

His first published novel told the story of four men who banded together to defraud a con man who had robbed them of \$1 million each. Like the works that were to follow, it drew condescending criticism from some writers boasting more elevated literary credentials and less-padded bank accounts. Archer described himself as a storyteller, a qualification which he depicted as unusual and object of resentment.

“Storytellers are very rare, but they create a lot of envy,” Archer said in an interview with fellow author Anthony Horowitz for *The Sunday Telegraph Magazine* in 2011. “The people

who survive are storytellers.”

Jeffrey Howard Archer was born in London on April 15, 1940, and grew up in Weston-super-Mare. His mother was Lola (Cook) Archer, a journalist with a column in a local newspaper; he described her as largely “penniless.”

In 1963, he went on to study for a diploma in education at the University of Oxford, where he was associated with Brasenose College. In 1966, he married an Oxford chemistry undergraduate, Mary Weeden. In addition to his wife, who became a chemistry professor at the University of Cambridge, he is survived by two sons, William and James; and five grandchildren. NYT



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If there are questions of current or contemporary relevance that you would like explained, please write to explained@indianexpress.com

• NOBEL PRIZE IN PHYSICS

Through ‘ghost particles’ in ice, window to universe



AMITABH SINHA

NEUTRINOS, VERY small sub-atomic particles produced mainly in nuclear reactions in stars, are among the most abundant particles in the universe, second only to photons (or light particles). And they can reveal a huge amount of new information about the universe. The problem has been that they are extremely difficult to detect, the reason they are often described as ghost particles.

The quest to detect neutrinos, and attempts to study them, have already led to several Nobel Prize wins. Another one was added on Tuesday, with the 2026 Nobel Prize in Physics being awarded to Francis Halzen, a Belgian-American scientist who designed an elaborate set-up under ice sheets in Antarctica to detect these elusive particles.

The IceCube facility in Antarctica is not the first observatory to detect neutrinos. Neutrinos were first proposed in the 1930s and first detected in the 1950s. Several observatories around the world are dedicated to detecting and studying these particles.

Studying distant space

What the IceCube facility managed to do was something unique. It was successful in detecting a special variety of high-energy neutrinos that was coming from far away in space. Till now, only those neutrinos that originated in the close vicinity of the Earth, primarily being produced in the Sun, were being detected. Most of the neutrinos passing through the Earth are produced in the nuclear processes inside the Sun.

For scientists, the detection of extra-galactic neutrinos has opened a new source of information about the universe. Initially, visible light was the only tool available to scientists to study the cosmic phenomena. Then, detectors were developed for the full electromagnetic spectrum of radiation and for cosmic rays. The detection of gravitational waves in 2015 opened an entirely

• **‘For decisive contributions to the IceCube Neutrino Observatory and the discovery of high-energy neutrinos of astrophysical origin’**



“His idea was to use glacial ice at the South Pole to capture the secretive particles called neutrinos. The result was the IceCube Neutrino Observatory, which can track neutrinos that originate in the distant cosmos.”



FRANCIS HALZEN, 82
University of Wisconsin-Madison, Madison, US.

ON WEDNESDAY: NOBEL PRIZE IN CHEMISTRY



The IceCube Neutrino Observatory at the Amundsen-Scott South Pole Station, in Antarctica. ICECUBE/NSF

new window for scientists looking at the universe. Extra-galactic neutrinos add another dimension of possibilities.

Together these different kinds of signals enable what is called multi-messenger astronomy, the ability to study the same cosmic event using different kinds of signals, said D Indumathi, a scientist at the Bengaluru-based Indian Institute of Astrophysics who was formerly associated with India's effort to build a neutrino detector.

‘Shy’ particles

The reason neutrinos are so difficult to detect is that they have an extremely low propensity to interact with matter. The Nobel Prize committee described them as the “shyest particle”. They simply pass through very dense regions of matter without any disturbance.

A very common example often cited is the fact that nearly 65 billion neutrinos pass through human finger nails every second without anyone ever noticing. Because they are also electrically neutral, they do

‘Shy’ particles

Neutrinos are difficult to detect because of their extremely low propensity to interact with matter.

• They simply pass through dense regions without disturbance. Nearly 65 billion neutrinos pass through your fingernails every second.

not respond to electromagnetic fields the way charged particles do.

The detections happen on the very rare occasions that they do interact with matter. That happens to, maybe, one in billions or trillions of neutrinos. That is why neutrino observatories the world over are very large facilities, built in extremely isolated, often underground locations, that maximise the chances of interaction and minimise noise.

The elusive nature of neutrinos is also what makes them particularly interesting to study. They pass through regions of cosmic space that other signals may never be able to cross. Very dense regions in space, for example, can absorb or scatter all electromagnetic radiations, but neutrinos simply flow through. They can thus reveal processes happening within or beyond that dense region, which are otherwise inaccessible to scientists.

The IceCube facility

The 82-year-old Halzen, who had been studying cosmic rays since the 1960s, came

to know of the attempts of Soviet researchers to build a neutrino detector in Antarctica, a press release from the Nobel Prize committee said. When a neutrino collides with an atomic nucleus in the ice, it creates an electric spark. This produces radio waves which could be detected using radio antennas.

Halzen thought of a slightly different idea. He realised that light sensors could be installed in glacier ice. These sensors could produce flashes of light from collisions of neutrinos with the nucleus of ice atoms. The area around the South Pole was a favourable location. It was isolated and, at significant depths, there was a lot of darkness with no disturbance from other radiations or signals.

He discussed his ideas with some of his colleagues and did most of the theoretical work on designing an observatory deep below the ice-sheets. IceCube is one cubic kilometer of ice equipped with over 5,000 light sensors on long cables, along with an overground facility where signals are collected. On the rare occasion when the neutrino interacts with an atomic nucleus of ice, a charged particle is produced. If that charged particle travels faster than the speed of light in ice, it produces a faint glow. From the characteristics of this glow, scientists are able to reconstruct the energy and direction of the neutrino involved in the collision.

This exquisite set-up became operational in 2011. By that time, it had already recorded a couple of events that suggested the involvement of extra-galactic neutrinos. In 2013, the observatory presented the first evidence of having detected very high-energy neutrinos. Since then several such incidents have been recorded and verified.

“It’s a very special detector and the work that Halzen has done is really very exciting. It has opened new avenues for astronomy and astrophysics,” said Naba K Mondal, former project director of India-based Neutrino Observatory (INO), a much-delayed effort to build a neutrino detector in India. “In neutrino research circles, this award to Halzen was expected for a few years.” INO was supposed to be located initially in Kerala and then in Tamil Nadu but ran into opposition from local and political groups over land acquisition and environmental grounds. A new location is yet to be finalised.

• POLITY

The 2006 Keralam road project that has come to haunt the CEC

Shaju Philip
Thiruvananthapuram, October 6

KERALAM’S CONGRESS-LED government on Sunday directed the state’s Vigilance and Anti-Corruption Bureau to reopen a 2006 probe into an alleged claim of bribery against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar. It comes as Congress leaders have demanded the CEC’s resignation over alleged irregularities in the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) process.

Kumar, a 1988-batch IAS officer of the Keralam cadre, then served as Secretary of the state Public Works Department (PWD). The allegation stemmed from the suicide note of a Malaysian engineer, who was part of a World Bank-aided road work project.

What was the project?

The Kerala State Transport Project (KSTP) has been a flagship PWD project. Costing Rs 1,600 crore, it was envisaged to modernise and renovate 1,600 km of major roads with a World Bank loan.

Initial discussions were completed during the last lap of the CPI(M)-led government from 1996 to 2001, and P J Joseph, the leader of the breakaway faction Kerala Congress (Joseph), was the PWD minister. Then part of the Left Democratic Front (LDF) al-

liance, Joseph is now with the ruling United Democratic Front (UDF).

What went wrong?

KSTP was the first project in the state associated with an overseas contractor, with Keralam-based Bhageeratha Engineering and Malaysian firm PATI joining hands for the bid. The joint venture took up work worth Rs 216 crore, mainly involving the modernisation of a key road from Thiruvananthapuram in the south to Angamaly in Central Keralam.

PATI-BEL began work in December 2002 after entering into a final agreement with the then Congress-led government. IJML leader M K Muneer was the PWD minister. However, the government handed over the project without acquiring land. The acquisition notification was issued only in 2004. In October 2006, the contractor stated it could not complete the work within the original deadline, citing the delay. As construction costs rose, PATI-BEL demanded a 30% increase in the contract amount. The CPI(M) government refused and sought the World Bank’s permission to re-tender the work.

What was the suicide case?

Lee See Been, 54, was the chief project manager of the PATI-BEL work, for which

Project marred by delays

• The Kerala State Transport Project (KSTP) was a flagship project of the PWD.

• It was envisaged to modernise and renovate select major roads with a World Bank loan, but saw multiple delays and rising costs.

the company submitted bills worth Rs 18 crore in 2006. According to Assembly documents, PATI-BEL officials visited ministers several times to seek payment. Lee was reportedly under pressure from subcontractors and construction material vendors who sought dues. As the work was delayed, the Congress-led Opposition put pressure on the CPI(M) government. Assembly documents show Congress demanded the company be blacklisted, and alleged that the CPI(M) government had an understanding with PATI-BEL to increase the project cost by 30% as demanded by the firm.

On November 11, 2006, Lee died by suicide in Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia. He reportedly left a note, alleging that PWD officials had sought bribes for clearing the bills. It was also claimed in news reports that the suicide note had included the name of the then PWD Secretary, Gyanesh Kumar. The note was never made public.

What did the probe find?

The death spotlighted issues including bureaucratic hurdles, corruption and delays in the execution of public work. A month later, the CPI(M) government removed Kumar from his post and ordered the Vigilance Bureau to examine the allegations. It also cancelled the contract with PATI-BEL.

In March 2010, then Home Minister Kodiyeri Balakrishnan, a CPI(M) leader, informed the Assembly that there were two vigilance probes. One related to foreign consultants for KSTP during 2003-04 (when Congress was in power). The other, ordered in December 2006 (a month after Lee’s suicide) was about lapses in KSTP work.

The probe, however, did not proceed further. According to Congress leader Malayinkeezhu Venugopal, on whose petition Home Minister Ramesh Chennithala ordered reopening the probe last week, the earlier investigation was torpedoed midway. Kumar, who was removed as the PWD Secretary in December 2006, was not given any fresh posting in the state. He then went on central deputation to New Delhi, when the Congress-led UPA was in power. CPI(M) had also supported the UPA-I.

What happened to the road work?

In early 2007, the CPI(M) government cancelled the contract on the grounds that the delay in completion would invite action from the World Bank. Despite re-tendering, no entity came forward to bid. A year later, the government agreed to renew the contract with PATI-BEL. It took over the project again after the state allotted an additional Rs 72 crore, amid Opposition criticism.

• HISTORY

China, Russia: The two October revolutions and their enduring legacy



EXPERT EXPLAINS

SYED ALI NADEEM REZAVI

PROFESSOR OF HISTORY AT ALIGARH MUSLIM UNIVERSITY

OCTOBER HOLDS a singular place in the history of the modern world. It is associated with two revolutions that transformed not merely governments but the very language of politics. On October 1, 1949, Mao Zedong stood at Tiananmen in Beijing and proclaimed the People’s Republic of China. Thirty-two years earlier, in October 1917 (according to the calendar then used in Russia), the Bolsheviks under Vladimir Ilyich Lenin had seized power in Petrograd.

The two revolutions arose from very different circumstances. Yet an important historical thread connects them. The Russian Revolution established the first durable state founded in the name of Marxist social-

ism. The Chinese Revolution demonstrated how Marxism could be reshaped to suit the circumstances of a predominantly agrarian Asian society. Together they profoundly shaped the 20th century and the struggles of millions far beyond their borders.

Russia, 1917

The Russian Revolution cannot be separated from the catastrophe of World War I. Imperial Russia entered the conflict burdened by social inequality, agrarian tensions, a restless industrial working class and an autocracy that had survived the revolution of 1905 without resolving its underlying problems. Military defeats, shortages and inflation eroded the authority of Tsar Nicholas II.

The February Revolution of 1917 brought down the Romanov dynasty, but the Provisional Government continued the war and postponed land reform. Meanwhile, “soviets” (councils) of workers and soldiers emerged as alternative centres of authority. Lenin returned from exile in April and demanded peace and “all power to the soviets”. By September, the Bolsheviks had majorities in the Petrograd and Moscow Soviets, and Leon Trotsky headed the Petrograd Soviet.

In October, Bolshevik-led soldiers,

sailors and Red Guards occupied strategic points in Petrograd and took the Winter Palace. The new government issued decrees on peace and land. To its supporters, October represented the transfer of power to workers and peasants; to its critics, it was the seizure of power by a disciplined minority that eventually led to one-party rule.

Yet, 1917 changed the world far beyond Russia. Land redistribution, workers’ rights, public ownership, mass education and social welfare suddenly appeared as programmes that a state might attempt to realise. Even societies opposed to communism had to respond to the challenge.

China, 1949

China followed another road. The Qing dynasty had fallen in 1911, but political fragmentation, warlordism, unequal treaties and foreign intervention continued. The May Fourth Movement of 1919 radicalised a generation of Chinese intellectuals. The Communist Party of China was founded in 1921, partly under the intellectual impact of the Russian Revolution.

After Chiang Kai-shek turned against the communists in 1927, the movement was driven increasingly into the countryside.



The People’s Liberation Army enters a Chinese city in 1949. WIKIMEDIA COMMONS

Here lay the great Chinese innovation. In a predominantly agrarian society, Mao placed the peasantry at the centre of revolutionary strategy. Rural organisation, land reform and guerrilla warfare became instruments of mobilisation.

The Long March of 1934-35 (the retreat of the communist forces) ensured the survival of the movement. Resistance to Japanese invasion subsequently enhanced the communists’ nationalist credentials, while

renewed civil war after 1945 ended with the defeat of the Kuomintang, the nationalist Chinese party, and its retreat to Taiwan.

On October 1, 1949, Mao proclaimed the People’s Republic. China altered the balance of the emerging Cold War, but its importance to the colonial and post-colonial world went further. It appeared to demonstrate that an agrarian Asian society could develop its own path to revolution. The peasant could become as important a revolutionary figure as the industrial worker.

The meaning of October

The Soviet experiment achieved remarkable advances in literacy, education, science and industrialisation, and the Soviet peoples bore an enormous burden in defeating Nazi Germany. Yet, forced collectivisation, famine, the Great Terror and the Gulag produced immense suffering.

China transformed landholding, education, public health and the legal position of women, and subsequently achieved striking improvements in literacy and life expectancy. Yet, the violence accompanying land reform, the disastrous ‘Great Leap Forward’ and the upheavals of the ‘Cultural Revolution’ also form a part of its history.

Their impact upon colonised societies was nevertheless profound. European imperialism had long presented itself as almost permanent. Russia’s revolution challenged imperialism ideologically, while China showed an Asian civilisation reclaiming political sovereignty.

India responded closely to both experiences. M N Roy debated colonial strategy with Lenin, Bhagat Singh read socialist literature, and Jawaharlal Nehru’s 1927 visit to the Soviet Union influenced his thinking about planning and development.

The Soviet Union disappeared in 1991, while the People’s Republic survives in a form profoundly altered by the economic reforms begun under Deng Xiaoping. Yet the significance of these revolutions extends beyond the states they created. They forced the world to confront questions of land, labour, poverty, inequality, education, welfare, imperialism and national sovereignty.

One need neither romanticise revolution nor overlook its tragedies to recognise its historical power. The political worlds they created have changed enormously, but the questions they raised remain with us.

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Union Cabinet hails 25 years of Modi at helm, flags 'mandate, trust, his governance'

From Gujarat CM to successive terms as PM, resolution traces his journey

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 6

THE UNION Cabinet adopted a resolution Tuesday, hailing the "enduring trust that the public have reposed" in Narendra Modi and his governance achievements over the last 25 years, first as Chief Minister of Gujarat and later as Prime Minister of the country.

Briefing reporters on the decisions of the Union Cabinet at its meeting Tuesday, Information and Broadcasting Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw said the resolution covers Modi's unbroken public service record, spanning the period

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Happening today

● **RBI WILL** announce its monetary policy, with experts expecting a rate hike after three-and-a-half years as inflation pressures rise due to the West Asia war.

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Resolution highlights Modi's achievements, from his role in Gujarat to Operation Sindoor. ANI

THE IDEAS PAGE PAGE 11



M VENKAIAH NAIDU

THE JOURNEY FROM 'CHALTA HAI' TO 'BADAL SAKTA HAI'

INSIDE PAGE 19
HARMANPREET STEPS DOWN, MANDHANA IS NEW INDIA CAPTAIN

THE BIG PICTURE
THE 'MOUNJARO BRIDES': A YEAR LATER PAGE 13

PARLIAMENT STREET SHUTS DOWN FOR MUCH OF THE DAY

Opp hits the street against CEC, its leaders detained

Time for him to resign, says Rahul; BJD joins protest, DMK stays away

Asad Rehman & Manoj CG
New Delhi, October 6

ESCALATING THE bitter political fight over the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls by the Election Commission, INDIA bloc MPs, led by Leader of Opposition in Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi, staged a protest Tuesday and attempted to march to the Commission headquarters, demanding the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar.

The standoff with the police through much of the day ended in the evening with the detention of Gandhi and several leaders including Congress MP Priyanka Gandhi Vadra.

Among those who joined the march from Parliament towards Nirvachan Sadan — it was the second such joint street protest since the rollout of the SIR — were SP's Akhilesh Yadav, TMC's Abhishek Banerjee, NCP (SP)'s Supriya Sule, RJD's Manoj Kumar Jha and CPM's John Brittas.

Gandhi and Congress MPs including Vadra, »CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

MORE REPORTS, PAGE 6



Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi being detained by police in New Delhi, Tuesday. GAJENDRA YADAV

MPs wanted a meeting in Parliament Annexe... against protocol, says EC

'Panel offered to send senior official to get memo but MPs declined'

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 6

SAYING THAT no party had sought an appointment until 4 pm Tuesday, the Election Commission (EC) said it was later informed by police that the Opposition Members of

BJP: Stop daily drama, learn from PM to win people's support

Jatin Anand
New Delhi, October 6

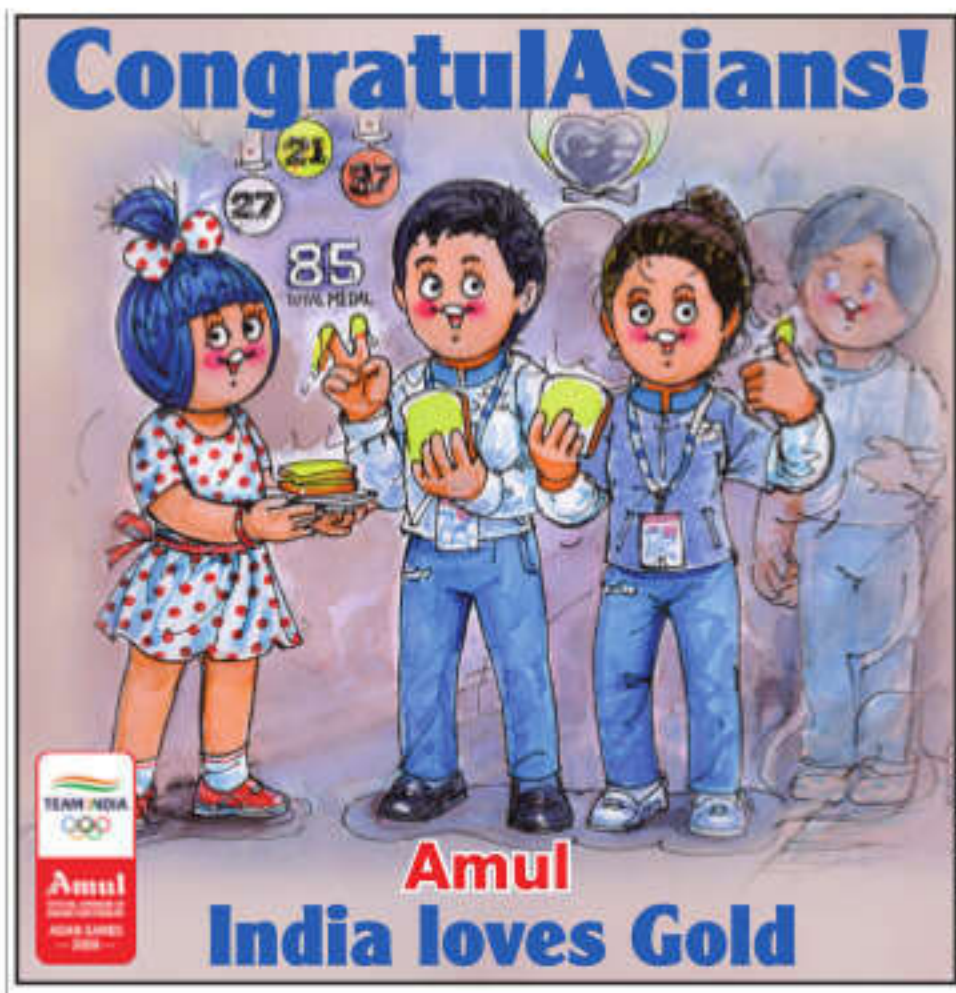
DESCRIBING THE Congress protest against the Election Commission of India as "drama", the BJP Tuesday accused the principal Opposition party and leaders of non-NDA parties who had joined it of abusing the Commission after failing to secure the mandate of the people.

Union Minister Kiren Rijiju said Rahul Gandhi, Leader of Opposition in Lok Sabha, »CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



SP's Akhilesh Yadav and TMC's Kalyan Banerjee were among leaders at the protest. ABHINAV SAHA

Parliament (MPs) wanted a meeting at Parliament House Annexe. It said this request was »CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



At least 12 Indian sailors injured in attacks in Black Sea, Hormuz; MEA condemns

Shubhajit Roy
New Delhi, October 6

WITH INDIAN seafarers being injured in two separate attacks on commercial vessels in the Strait of Hormuz and the Black Sea, the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) on Tuesday condemned the incidents and expressed "deep concern" over the "targeting of commercial shipping".

Eleven Indian crew members were injured after a Panama-flagged vessel was hit by a projectile while transiting the Strait of Hormuz on Tuesday. In the other incident, »CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Business as Usual
By EP UNNY



2026 NOBEL PRIZE PHYSICS



FRANCIS HALZEN

A WINDOW TO UNIVERSE THROUGH 'GHOST PARTICLES' IN ICE EXPLAINED

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What drove Mumbai ‘lone wolf’ accused: ATS cites preachers, divorce and eviction

Mohamed Thaver & Sadaf Modak
Mumbai, October 6

A RECENT divorce, being asked by his landlord to leave his rented home and his “obsessive food habits”, including a distrust of food cooked by strangers, drove a US-returned man to further a despair before he carried out a ‘lone wolf’ attack in Mira Road, stabbing two security guards near his residence on April 27 after asking their religion, according to the nearly 2,500-page chargesheet filed by the Anti-Terrorism Squad (ATS) last week.

Zaib Ansari (31) “self-radicalised” by watching online videos of extremist preachers, the chargesheet said.

The ATS has invoked the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act (UAPA) against Ansari, who is in jail, and claimed that a note found at his home said “lone wolves will pounce on you”.

Investigators first examined whether anyone had guided Ansari but found no such evidence, an official said. “Based on his interrogation and other evidence, we have ruled out any outsider being involved in this.”

Ansari “was mentally disturbed”, the official said, and watching videos of preachers such as Anwar al-Awlaki on social media radicalised him. Al-

Awlaki was a radical American Muslim cleric of Yemeni descent linked to a series of terror attacks globally. “He was further disturbed by reports of killings of children in Palestine,” the official said.

Ansari moved from the US in 2019. In the US, he made money coaching students in tennis, but he had no regular source of income in India, the agency found. After his divorce, he was living alone, and his landlord asked him to leave because she did not want to rent to bachelors.

These factors, along with the attacks on Palestine, drove him to extreme content online, which radicalised him over six to eight months, an officer said.

“While his family members are based in the US, we have recorded the statement of his mother who had come down to visit him and his Kurla-based uncle with whom he was initially staying,” the official said.

During earlier court proceedings, Ansari’s lawyer told the court that he has schizophrenia and was previously on medication. The lawyer also said Ansari eats only vegetarian food that he prepares himself, and never eats food cooked by others, not even at a relative’s home or a family gathering. Police officials too initially faced trouble over his food while he was in custody.

[FROM PAGE 1 | FULL REPORTS ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM]

Opp parties step up protest

K C Venugopal, Pawan Khera, Imran Pratapgarhi, Charanjit Singh Channi, Praniti Shinde and Depender Hooda forced their way into the premises of the Akashvani Bhavan, situated next to the EC headquarters, where they staged a sit-in there for several hours before being detained by police.

All roads leading to the Nirvachan Sadan were heavily barricaded by police. The standoff began when Gandhi and others were stopped by police near Akashvani Bhavan. Gandhi, who climbed atop the barricades, was detained and was seen walking towards a parked police bus. He then spoke to his sister Priyanka Gandhi Vadra and her, along with some Congress MPs, entered the Akashvani Bhavan complex.

“All I want to do is meet the Chief Election Commissioner and tell him that he has done ‘vote chori’. I can continue to sit here. I am comfortable here. If

they don’t want us to sit here, give us some other site,” Gandhi said.

Targeting the Prime Minister, Union Home Minister and the RSS chief, he alleged that the country had been “hijacked” with the “vote chori”.

“What has been done to our country is treason. Nobody is going to escape,” he said. In a post on X as the march began, Gandhi said, “Gyanesh it’s done bro. Time to resign.”

The standoff ended eight hours later when police detained the leaders after several rounds of discussions, and heated exchanges.

Posting a video of his detention, Gandhi said, “To save the traitors of democracy, the remnants of democracy have been dragged. There will be a reckoning — not a single traitor will be spared.”

Late in the evening, the detained leaders were taken to the Kingsway Camp police facility.

BJP: Stop daily drama

should learn from Prime Minister Narendra Modi and the BJP on securing people’s support on the basis of work instead of relying on “drama”.

“It is time to stop the drama that Rahul Gandhi ji and his colleagues keep doing daily against the Election Commission and the Supreme Court. It has been going on since 2014... In a democracy, serve the people and you will get their mandate,” he said.

“You call the Election Commission a thief, the government a thief. This will neither serve democracy nor the rise of the Congress party again. I especially want to tell Rahul Gandhi ji: Learn from Modi ji, from BJP karyakartas who continue to serve, not for their own sakes but selflessly. If you serve them, you will earn the trust of the people. Doing this drama will not help,” he said.

Asking the Congress to “stop peddling the narrative of anti-national forces”, Rijiju sought to underline that the party which ruled the country for 55 years, including two years of the Emergency, was now talking of democracy.

Union Minister Shivraj Singh

Chouhan said the Opposition leaders were “venting their frustration” over electoral defeats by levelling baseless allegations.

“Friends in the Opposition, the very system you are questioning is the one under which you won in Kerala. Was that victory illegitimate? You won in Karnataka. Was that victory illegitimate? You won in Himachal. Was that victory illegitimate? Opposition governments were formed in Punjab and Jharkhand. Were those victories illegitimate?” he said.

“If you question constitutional institutions, you will commit the sin of plunging the country into the fires of anarchy. Do not commit the sin of plunging the nation into unrest and anarchy. The country and its people will never forgive you,” he said.

Lok Sabha MP and former Union Minister Ravi Shankar Prasad said Rahul Gandhi, Congress, and the Opposition alliance were attempting to create an atmosphere of “anarchy” in the country.

He said the Supreme Court had held the SIR to be legally valid yet the Congress was “insulting the voters of the country

After one set of leaders were taken inside, police had to close the gate as scores of Congress workers reached the spot. Vadra, who was in another bus, could not be taken inside because of the surging crowd. She was seen climbing the gate after which the police opened the gates to let her in.

Last month, an investigation by *The Indian Express* revealed that Election Commissioners Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi had objected on record 14 times in 10 months to steps taken by the Commission under the CEC, from keeping them in the dark to adding new voters and deleting names.

While the DMK, which was part of the protest last year, was missing Tuesday, the Opposition camp got unexpected support from the BJD. The Naveen Patnaik-led Odisha party sent two of its MPs to participate in the march. For many years, the BJD had maintained equidistance from the NDA and the INDIA bloc.

But there were rumblings within the INDIA bloc after the

by blaming the Election Commission for its repeated electoral defeats”.

“Instead of accepting the people’s verdict, the Congress is trying to undermine democratic institutions and create confusion and disorder through unfounded accusations,” Prasad said.

“The question is whether Rahul Gandhi, the Congress party, and the Opposition alliance want anarchy in the country. Opposition leaders have gathered in Delhi and surrounded a sensitive area of the national Capital. Opposition leaders are claiming that Prime Minister Narendra Modi Ji, Union Home Minister Amit Shah, and Mohan Bhagwat have Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar under their control. This is extremely irresponsible, and we strongly condemn it,” he said.

He said Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge had gone even further and said that all elections should be cancelled and conducted again through ballot papers which “reflects their real intention and desire”.

“Congress leaders cannot win fair elections and, therefore, they now want a return to booth capturing, stamping, and winning elections through pressure by pouring ink into ballot boxes.

protest. Some allies of the Congress felt “mistreated” because the Gandhi siblings stole the show by sitting in protest at Akashvani Bhavan.

Around noon, all INDIA bloc MPs were in buses and were subsequently taken to different police stations, but the Gandhis and their close aides stayed back.

Sources said Congress’s Venugopal later conveyed to the INDIA bloc parties that the party leadership had acted on the spur of the moment, and that he regretted the “mistrust” that had been created by not keeping allies in the loop.

Only after calls from the Congress did the TMC leaders reach the AIR office later.

Some Opposition leaders also said that the Congress’s decision to demand a meeting with the Election Commission was not something that the allies would have agreed to.

“Why would we meet the ECI when we are demanding the resignation of CEC Gyanesh Kumar? If this was discussed with the allies, we wouldn’t have agreed,” a Left MP said.

They want to prevent the poor, Dalits and marginalised sections from voting in villages. This is how the Congress used to win, whether in Bihar or Uttar Pradesh,” he said.

Addressing the media at the party headquarters, BJP spokesperson Sambit Patra said, “The Congress has been repeatedly trying to launch and re-launch Rahul Gandhi by any means necessary. When, despite numerous attempts, he failed to gain traction, the Congress and some of its allies decided that even if it meant resorting to anarchy and undermining the nation’s democracy, they would launch Rahul Gandhi politically at any cost.”

In the evening, after the Election Commission issued a statement saying no party had sought an appointment until 4 pm Tuesday and that it was later informed by police that Opposition MPs wanted a meeting at Parliament House Annex, BJP spokesperson and Rajya Sabha MP Sudhanshu Trivedi slammed Gandhi: “It is clear that telling the EC anything was not his intention... Neither did he seek any appointment, and when time was given, he did not go. After that, when it was said that a representative would be sent to collect a memorandum from him, he was not ready.”

12 Indian sailors injured in attacks in Black Sea, Hormuz; MEA condemns

at least two foreign crew members were killed and some others, including an Indian, were injured after a Russian drone strike caused a fire on a Turkish-owned civilian cargo vessel in the Black Sea on Monday.

“We condemn the attack earlier today on a Panama-flagged commercial vessel, MT On Peace, off the coast of Oman, where it was struck by a projectile while transiting the Strait of Hormuz,” the MEA said in a statement. “Of the total crew of 19, 17 are Indian nationals. It is learnt that 12 crew members have been injured, including 11 Indian nationals,” it said.

“With the assistance of Omani authorities, the injured crew have since been evacuated and are receiving medical treatment in Khasab, Oman. We thank the Omani authorities for their valuable support,” it said.

The MEA said the continuing incidents of attacks on shipping in the region remain a “cause of deep concern” for India. “We reiterate our call for an immediate cessation of such attacks in the interests of peace and stability in the region,” it said.

“The targeting of commercial shipping, seafarers and civilian infrastructure in the region must end, and navigation and commerce through international waterways must be restored at the earliest,” the MEA said.

In the other incident, the Indian Embassy in Romania reported that there were “three Indian nationals among the crew members” and “one of them has been injured and is receiving medical attention”.

“We have learnt of an attack today on commercial vessel MV Royad Mammadov in the Black Sea. As per preliminary information, there have been 2 casualties (foreign nationals) while some crew members have been injured and are undergoing medical treatment in Romania. It is further reported that there are three Indian nationals among the crew members,” the mission posted on X. It said all three Indians are safe and “in good health”.

“We condemn the attack on MV Royad Mammadov in the Black Sea in which two foreign seafarers were killed and some members of the crew, including Indian nationals, injured. The injured have been rescued by

E. EXPLAINED

The India concern

Indian seafarers account for about 12 per cent of global maritime workforce. With the conflicts in West Asia and Ukraine-Russia seeing a rise in attacks on the high seas, India has, time and again, expressed concern over the safety of seafarers. External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar has said that India started the latest round of conversations with Russia and Ukraine in July this year, after commercial ships came under attack in the Black Sea.

Romanian authorities and are receiving medical attention. The three Indian nationals, who were part of the crew, are safe. We thank Romanian authorities for their swift action in this incident,” the MEA said.

India views these attacks on “commercial shipping and seafarers with grave concern”, it said. “The targeting of traffic in international waterways is severely undermining global commerce and welfare of people across the world. We continue to call for dialogue and diplomacy to bring an end to the ongoing conflicts”.

Indian seafarers account for almost 12 per cent of the global maritime community. According to sources, at least nine Indian seafarers have died, one is presumed dead, and seven have been injured since the start of the West Asia crisis, until July this year. There have been at least 29 incidents of attacks on vessels carrying Indian seafarers -- four involving Indian-flagged vessels and the rest involving foreign-flagged vessels.

In the Black Sea, too, Indian seafarers have been victims of attacks from both Russia and Ukraine. In fact, India started actively pushing for Russia-Ukraine peace after Indian seafarers were hit by such attacks.

In September 2026, India and Liberia launched a 25-nation ‘Group of Friends on Safety and Security of Shipping and Seafarers’ during the UN General Assembly to ensure safety and security of merchant crews and commercial shipping against targeted attacks, the MEA said.

WITH PTI, LONDON

Opp MPs wanted to meet in Parliament Annexe, against protocol, says EC

“unusual”, because, as per protocol, “such meetings are held only on the premises of the Election Commission of India”. The EC said it still offered to send a senior officer to receive their memorandum, but the MPs rejected its proposal.

“Earlier today, during the march of certain political parties towards the Election Commission, it was learnt through the media that some MPs wished to meet the Commission along with their delegation. With regard to today’s developments, it is clarified that, till 4 pm today, no political party, through its representatives, had sought an appointment for a meeting with the Election Commission,” the poll panel said in its statement on Tuesday evening.

The EC said it was informed by the Delhi Police, around 4 pm that a delegation of MPs led by the Leader of Opposition in Lok Sabha, Rahul Gandhi, wanted to meet the Commission to submit a memorandum.

“After 4 pm today, when the Election Commission was considering the above proposal for the above-mentioned meeting with the Hon’ble MPs, it was informed by the DCP, Delhi Police, that the meeting being sought was to be held with a group of 240 MPs and that the proposed venue was the Parliament House Annex. The Election Commission considered this re-

quest as unusual and therefore, could not be accepted, as, in accordance with ECI protocol, such meetings are held only on the premises of the Election Commission of India,” it said.

The EC said it still proposed to send its most senior officer on duty to the meeting venue to receive the memorandum, which in itself would have been an unprecedented step. “However, this offer was also declined by the Hon’ble MPs,” the Commission said.

“ECI respects the parliamentary and democratic processes of the country, as well as its own protocols and conventions, which are of utmost importance. Any political party may, at any time, request for a meeting with the Election Commission; and the Commission, keeping in view the suitability of time, schedules a date and time for the meeting. This is a regular practice,” it said.

It pointed to the procedure laid down in 2025 for meetings with political parties. “All political parties had been informed of the same and they follow this procedure. Whenever a delegation of a political party, or a joint delegation of several parties, wishes to meet the Commission, it seeks an appointment through its duly authorised representative. The meeting is thereafter held at a time mutually agreed upon by both sides,” it said.

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Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Sameer Ahmed S/o Rafi Ahmed R/o 1365, 15 Rajeev Gandhi Nagar New Mustafabad Delhi Gokulpuri North East Delhi India** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 254/2024 U/s 279/337 IPC at PS: Nand Nagri, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Sameer Ahmed** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Sameer Ahmed of FIR No. 254/2024 U/s 279/337 IPC at PS: Nand Nagri, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 13.11.2026.**
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Abhay Choudhary
Judicial Magistrate First Class-09
Court Room No.20, 1st Floor, Shahadarkarkardooma Courts, Delhi
DP/14269/NE/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED
(See Section 82 Cr. PC)/
(84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023)
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Sheikh Salman @ Ganju S/o Sheikh Aslam R/o H.No. 55, Gali No.14, Near Shiv Mandir Ram Park Loni Gaziabad UP** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 7120 U/s 356/379/411/34 IPC at PS: ODRS, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Sheikh Salman @ Ganju** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Sheikh Salman @ Ganju** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Sheikh Salman @ Ganju of FIR No. 7120 U/s 356/379/411/34 IPC at PS: ODRS, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 16.12.2026.**
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Coming in 2030, 7-km train line to connect IGIA Terminal 1 with 3

Sukalp Sharma
New Delhi, October 6

AT DELHI'S Indira Gandhi International Airport, getting from Terminal 1 to Terminal 3 can mean a 15-20 minute road journey – longer during peak hours or VIP movements – despite both being part of the same airport.

By 2030, that journey could be made by train.

Delhi International Airport Limited (DIAL), the airport operator, is planning a 7.3-km automated people mover (APM) or inter-terminal rapid rail system that will connect Terminal 1 with Terminal 3, with stops at Aerocity and the airport's cargo area.

The proposed system is estimated to cost around Rs 3,500 crore, bringing IGI – the country's largest airport with three passenger terminals and four runways – at par with some of the leading global airports where passengers can move swiftly between terminals using driverless trains.

DIAL CEO Pradeep Panicker on Tuesday expressed confidence that the intra-airport transit system would be ready by 2030, adding that its design and other modalities are under finalisation.

The APM system will be 7.3 km in length, and will have six stations— Terminal 1 station, three stations at various locations in Aerocity, a cargo area station, and Terminal 3 station, which will also serve Terminal 2.

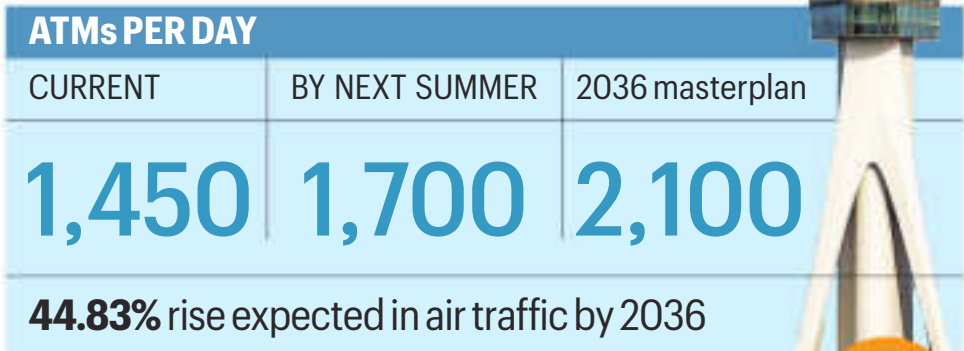
As per Panicker, APM stations for Terminal 1 and Terminal 3, and one of its Aerocity stations will be built adjacent to existing stations of Delhi Metro lines, which would allow passengers and those working at the airport the option to transfer between the APM and Delhi Metro almost seamlessly.

While the APM is likely to be free for passengers transiting between terminals to catch connecting flights, DIAL is yet to take a call on whether the

● Airport traffic set to rise

AIR TRAFFIC MOVEMENTS (ATMs)

Each landing and take-off counts as one ATM



PASSENGER TRAFFIC



Passenger category	Current	Projected	CAGR*
Domestic passengers	57 million	86 million	3.90%
International passengers	22 million	39 million	6.10%

*COMPOUND ANNUAL GROWTH RATE; SOURCE: DIAL

non-passenger riders will have to pay for using the system.

Panicker said the AMP track will be elevated for 5.3 km, and at grade for the remaining 2 km. The total travel time between Terminal 1 and 3 will be 13 minutes, and DIAL plans to run APM trains at a 10-minute frequency. It estimates the initial daily ridership on the APM to be 55,000, expecting it to eventually rise to 85,000.

The APM, which has been in planning for years, is part of IGIA's proposed Master Plan till 2036, when the airport expects to have a passenger handling capacity of 125 million per year, which could be further increased to 129 million. IGIA's current passenger handling capacity stands at 106 million per year. The plan has been submitted to the government for stakeholder consultations, said DIAL.

As per the Operation, Management and Development Agreement (OMDA) for the airport, the master plan is required to be updated every 10 years.

Speaking on other facets of

the new 10-year Master Plan, Panicker said that Terminal 1's capacity will be increased to 45 million passengers per annum from the current 42 million, while Terminal 2's capacity will remain stable at 14 million passengers. Both the terminals will continue to cater only to domestic airlines.

IGIA's largest terminal — Terminal 3 — will also see significant capacity augmentation. Its domestic passenger handling capacity is expected to rise to 27 million from the current 19 million, while international passenger capacity will go up to 39 million per year from the prevailing 31 million.

Panicker said a new pier is planned to be built at Terminal 3 to boost its capacity, which will take the total number of piers at the terminal to five. The new pier and related works under the Master Plan are expected to cost about Rs 2,500 crore, as per DIAL's estimates.

Other capacity expansion works proposed include additional check-in counters, security screening machines, and parking stands.

Cameras on uniforms, speakers on streets: Delhi Police changes approach amid claims of manhandling

Alok Singh
New Delhi, October 6

THE CAMERAS were hard to miss.

Attached to the uniforms of police personnel deployed on Parliament Street on Tuesday, the small body-worn devices were recording as officers prepared to deal with another round of protests near the Election Commission headquarters.

"This has been given to the ground staff so that no one makes false allegations," a Delhi Police constable said, pointing to the camera fixed to his uniform. He was deployed to maintain law and order during the INDIA bloc's protest demanding Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar's

resignation.

The cameras, along with speakers blaring announcements and police personnel largely without batons, were part of a visibly more cautious approach adopted by the force, as protests in Central Delhi entered their fifth day.

The measures come after three days of criticism and allegations over the handling of protesters, including sexual assault allegations made by three female journalists.

By Tuesday, around 80 body-worn cameras had been distributed among ground staff, according to a senior officer. They were deployed among almost all ground-level personnel up to the rank of DCP, with officers told to record their interactions while manag-



An officer wears a body-worn device on Tuesday. EXPRESS

ing crowds.

"If required, more cameras will be given to the ground

staff," the officer said.

Body-worn cameras are not new to the Delhi Police.

Traffic personnel have used them for several years to record interactions while issuing challans, while local police sometimes use them when dealing with members of the public, but not on such a large scale. Their deployment on this scale during crowd-control duties is a recent measure, another officer said.

Further, police personnel were largely seen without batons or other weapons as Opposition leaders approached the barricades. Speakers repeatedly urged people not to gather in the area, with prohibitory orders under Section 163 of the BNSS in force across Parliament Street and adjoining areas.

Over five companies of paramilitary personnel, along with local police, were deployed along the routes expected to be taken by the protesters from Makar Dwar of Parliament to the Election Commission office. Multi-layered barricades came up outside the EC office's main entrance and around Jantar Mantar. The New Delhi district has been witnessing protests since October 2, with Opposition parties holding demonstrations.

Police have registered nine FIRs in connection with the protests near Jantar Mantar over the last five days. The cases include alleged violations of prohibitory orders, rioting and attacks on police personnel while they were discharging their duties. Eighteen people have also been arrested.

Jantar Mantar assault case: Regular bail for Swatantra Bharadwaj

Nirbhay Thakur

New Delhi, October 6

A DELHI court Tuesday granted self-styled influencer Swatantra Bharadwaj regular bail in a case where he allegedly attacked the father of a student protester who had participated in the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) protest in July.

Additional Sessions Judge (ASJ) Saurabh Pratap Singh Laler of the Patiala House Court had earlier granted Bharadwaj interim bail for three weeks. ASJ Laler had then said that it would observe his conduct before considering his plea for regular bail. A detailed regular bail order is awaited.

Granting Bharadwaj interim bail, ASJ Laler had said, "Weighing all circumstances, the Court takes into account that the applicant has been in custody for a little over 10 days... a period that should have afforded him time for reflection."

Bharadwaj had purportedly admitted to attacking the father of the student protester at Jan-

tar Mantar in a video. He was picked up by the Crime Branch officers from his house in Bulandshahr on September 4 and brought to Delhi after securing a transit remand.

On September 4, relevant sections pertaining to the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989 (SC/ST Act), were added to an earlier FIR registered against Bharadwaj over the alleged attack, amid a protest by CJP supporters and the IYC, as well as Lok Sabha MPs Chandra Shekhar alias Azad and Rajesh Ranjan alias Pappu Yadav.

The same day, another FIR was registered under sections of the Protection of Children from Sexual Offences Act (POCSO), 2012, and for criminal intimidation based on the protester's complaint alleging she had received rape threats from Bharadwaj's supporters. Bharadwaj had been in judicial custody since September 5 till he was granted interim bail on September 15.

'Their entire career lying ahead': Court grants bail to 17 anti-CEC protesters

Nirbhay Thakur

New Delhi, October 6

GRANTING BAIL to 17 people arrested by the Delhi Police during a protest against CEC Gyanesh Kumar on Monday, a Delhi court late in the night sought a report from the DCP (New Delhi) on allegations that two of those arrested were beaten up at the Parliament Street police station.

In four separate orders, Judicial Magistrate First Class (JMFC) Animesh Kumar of the Patiala House Court granted bail to the 17 accused. "The accused persons are of very young age and do not appear to be habitual offenders. They have their entire career lying ahead," JMFC Kumar said.

The police had submitted that the protesters were part of an unlawful assembly and had blocked the public space when prohibitory orders imposed under Section 163 of BNSS was in place.

After two protesters told the court that they sustained injuries as they were beaten inside

the Parliament Street police station after they were detained, JMFC Kumar sought that CCTV camera footage from inside the police station be preserved.

"Since accused Dharmender and Samartha have levelled allegations regarding custodial torture, let report be called from DCP New Delhi regarding the same. The relevant CCTV footage of PS Parliament Street be also preserved," he said.

JMFC Kumar said, "...One official has allegedly sustained injuries ... While any person has right to protest peacefully, however, assaulting police officials on duty is serious concern which cannot be permitted under the garb of peaceful protest."

"However, it cannot be ignored that all the offences involved in the case except offence punishable under Section 132 of BNS are bailable... Even the offence punishable under Section 132 of BNS (assault or criminal force to deter public servant from discharge of his duty) provides for maximum imprisonment of 2 years only," he added.

● Skywatch



Forecast:

October 7, 2026

Partly cloudy sky

No rain

MAX: 34-36

1.8°C below normal

MIN: 22-24

1.7°C below normal

• Sunrise: 6:18 AM (Oct 8)

• Sunset: 6:01 PM (Oct 7)

• Moonrise: 3:50 PM (Oct 8)

• Moonset: 3:01 AM (Oct 7)

● AQI Tracker



Anand Vihar

Moderate

AQI: 153

Narela

Poor

AQI: 236



Sirifort

Moderate

AQI: 169

Rohini

Moderate

AQI: 192

● Good (0-50)

● Satisfactory (51-100)

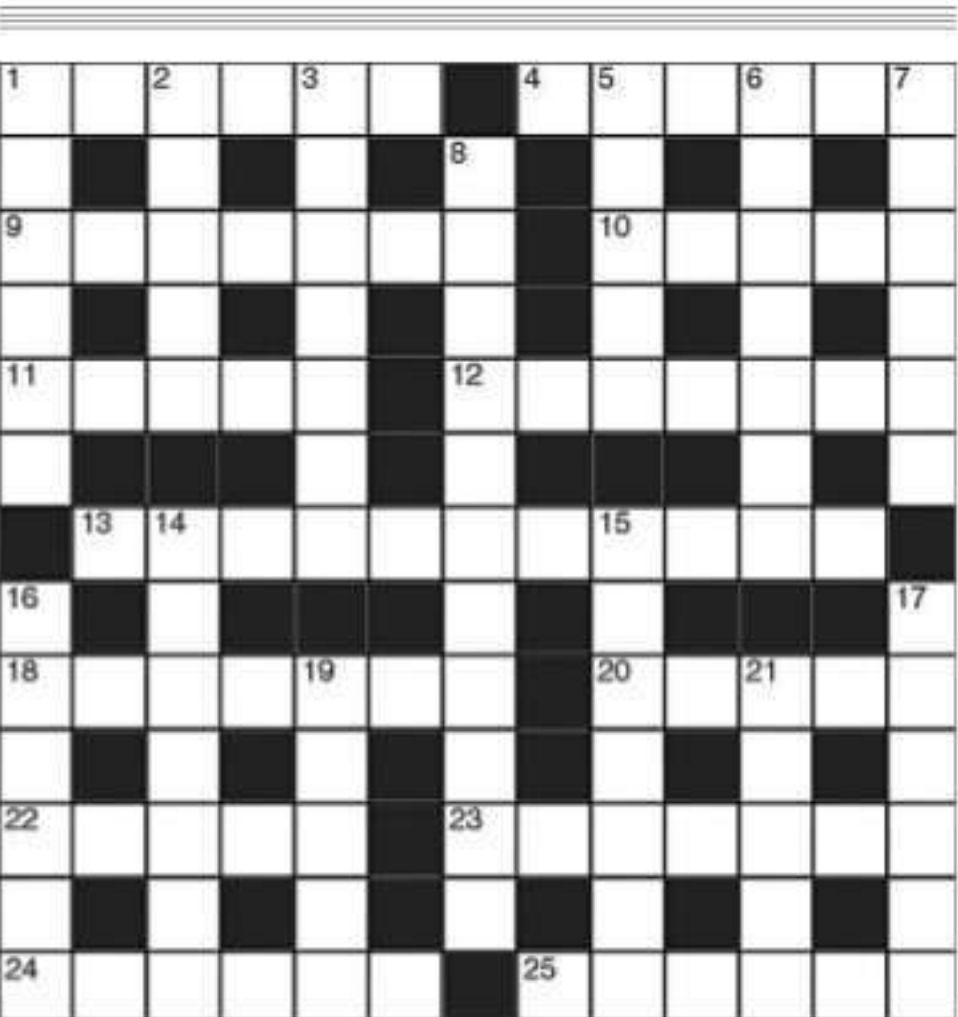
● Moderate (101-200)

● Poor (201-300)

● Very Poor (301-400)

● Severe (401-500)

● CROSSWORD



ACROSS

- 1 Strip joint on the street (6)
- 4 Customer has the legal right in court (6)
- 9 Sole support for a jockey (7)
- 10 Rita's broken bones (5)
- 11 Got us to display zest (5)
- 12 Exercise restraint about newspapers (7)
- 13 Finishes - a sentence? (4,1,4,2)
- 18 I'm close to danger and put in jeopardy (7)
- 20 Complain when I get in difficulty (5)
- 22 Tried a new way when weary (5)
- 23 Superior people who like to gamble (7)
- 24 Don's best port? (6)
- 25 Talk about the foreign dwelling (6)

DOWN

- 1 Falsely signed sketch (6)
- 2 Seven dancing castaways? (5)
- 3 Grieves they may be drowned (7)
- 5 Drunk started smoking (3,2)
- 6 Eastern organisation seen to be taken seriously (7)
- 7 Justification for drinking (6)
- 8 Groups that promote diversionary activities (6,5)
- 14 Prime US source of judges (7)
- 15 Looking out for a situation for the hands? (2,5)
- 16 Cold tart (6)
- 17 Afternoon service? (3,3)
- 19 Went on a horse to the ring for the show (5)
- 21 One type of wood that's perfect (5)

SOLUTIONS CROSSWORD 6112 ACROSS: 1 Codicil, 5 Melee, 8 Miscellaneous, 9 Cargo, 10 Extreme, 11 Toecap, 12 Cave in, 15 Iron Age, 17 Lifer, 19 Bride and groom, 20 Elect, 21 Blocked DOWN: 1 Comic, 2 Deserve notice, 3 Cremona, 4 Lilies, 5 Manet, 6 Loose-leaf book, 7 Eastern, 11 Thimble, 13 Allegro, 14 Pen nib, 16 Avert, 18 Rimed

JUMBLED WORDS

Given below are four jumbled words. Solve the jumbles to make proper words and move them to the respective circles below. Select the letters in the shaded circles and jumble them to get the answer for the given quip.

An income tax form is like a laundry list - either way you _____. - Fred Allen (4,4,5)

VEORR

RDSSO

GHPILT

COTHUY

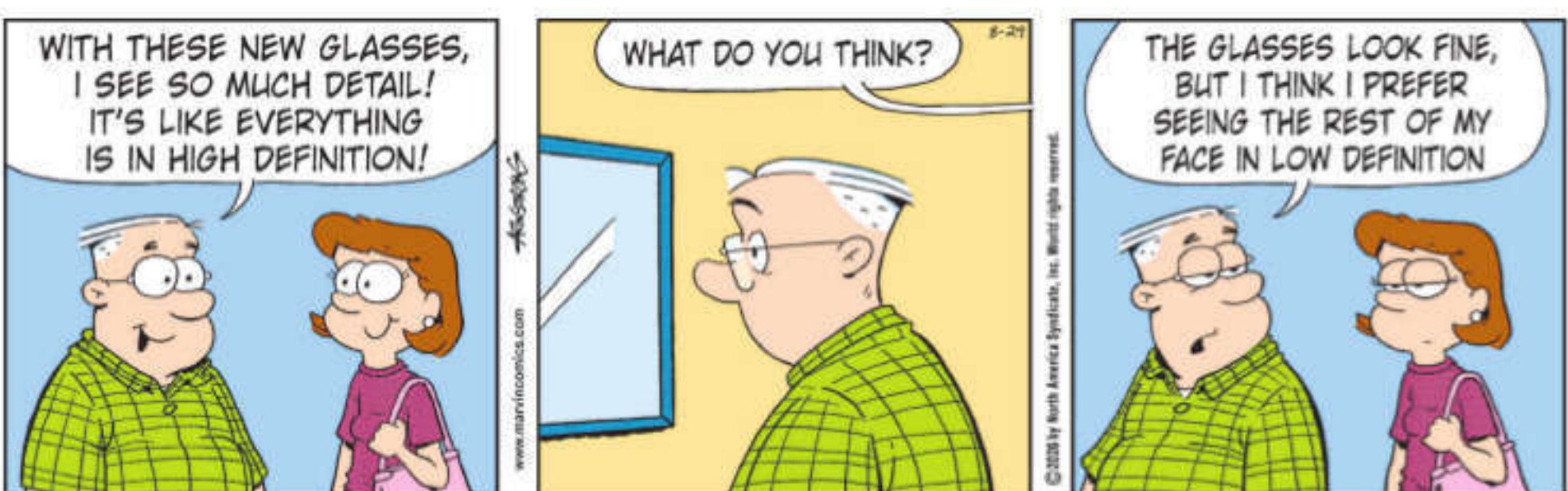
● OVER THE HEDGE



● CALVIN & HOBBS



● MARVIN



DIFFICULTY LEVEL 2s INSTRUCTIONS

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every digit from 1 to 9 must appear in each of the nine vertical columns, in each of the nine horizontal rows and in each of the nine boxes.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL

1s = Very easy; 2s = Easy; 3s = Medium; 4s = Hard; 5s = Very Hard; 6s = Genius

SUDOKU 6464

2		9			6		1	
	7						5	
		1		5	7			3
5			6	1				
		9				2		
					2	3		5
7			3	6		1		
	5						6	
9	3		1					4

SOLUTION SUDOKU 6463

9	2	1	3	4	8	5	6	7
7	5	6	9	1	2	8	3	4
8	3	4	5	7	6	1	2	9
2	4	7	8	5	1	3	9	6
5	6	8	4	9	3	2	7	1
1	9	3	6	2	7	4	5	8
6	7	2	1	3	4	9	8	5
3	1	9	7	8	5	6	4	2
4	8	5	2	6	9	7	1	3



A drone survey identified a major bottleneck on the corridor. FILE

Congestion ahead: Accurate Google Maps update on Barapullah traffic expected soon

Sakshi Chand
New Delhi, October 6

THE DELHI Traffic Police is co-ordinating with Google Maps to ensure that the traffic situation on the newly opened Barapullah Phase-III corridor is accurately reflected on the app, officers said on Tuesday.

This comes a day after the Delhi Traffic Police on Monday said in a post on X that with the app showing the route as relatively clear, commuters are being directed towards the already congested stretch. A drone survey had identified a major bottleneck at the Sundial Park merger near Sarai Kale Khan where lanes merge into the existing Barapullah corridor.

Traffic Police officers said this is adding to the traffic load as vehicles that would otherwise use DND or NH-24 turns towards the new corridor, choking it further. “The newly opened corridor is attracting substantial traffic that would otherwise use NH-24 and DND, thereby increasing the traffic load,” an official said.

The Traffic Police said the issue on the navigation app will be sorted out in a few days.

Public Works Department (PWD) officials have also blamed Google Maps for feeding “misinformation” to commuters, exacerbating the lockjam. “There is some misinformation on Google Maps; apparently, it is not updating real-time traffic information for commuters to properly navigate, causing more congestion on the stretch,” PTI quoted an official as having said.

Officials said that despite a recent meeting with the Traffic Police and the National Highways Authority of India, no solution has been reached so far.

Appropriate traffic-control measures and signals at suit-

able merging points may also be considered to regulate the inflow of vehicles and prevent excessive accumulation, Traffic Police officers said.

The Traffic Police is also examining the possibility of regulating or diverting traffic towards NH-24, wherever feasible. Officers, meanwhile, also pointed to a traffic signal on the corridor that has no electricity connection yet, stating that once functional, it is expected to help regulate traffic entering the corridor. “A request for an electricity connection has been sent to the BSES,” the official said.

Barapullah Phase-III flyover was inaugurated on September 29 and opened to commuters on September 30. The corridor has since witnessed heavy traffic and congestion.

The Traffic Police and PWD had on October 1 conducted a joint aerial inspection using drones. The survey identified a sharp, almost rectangular geometry at the merger, resulting in an abrupt convergence of traffic and a bottleneck.

“There is a significant mismatch in lane capacity at the merging point. Multiple streams of traffic are converging towards the existing Barapullah corridor, which has comparatively limited lane capacity,” an official had said.

A senior officer said that they had asked the PWD to work on the ‘curvature’ near Sundial park patch of the Barapullah flyover. The Traffic Police said it was closely monitoring the corridor and coordinating with PWD and other agencies to address the ongoing issues.

Commuters have been advised to follow traffic advisories and directions of traffic police personnel and use alternate routes wherever advised.

Pragynesh
New Delhi, October 6

ANYA VATS, prime accused in the Yuvraj Singh Manchanda case, needed Rs 90 lakh to pay for an out-of-court settlement. She told her live-in partner, Sanyam Sachdeva, that she was being threatened to pay up. What he allegedly did not know was that the person threatening her did not exist.

A Delhi Police officer said Anya invented a “senior officer”, sent threatening messages to herself from another number and convinced Sanyam that they were in danger. Then she allegedly told him that the only way out is to kill their former colleague, Yuvraj, who worked with Adani Realty, and take his money.

It all began with a post-dated cheque, police alleged.

Anya had issued the cheque of Rs 90 lakh to settle a cheating case involving a senior Punjab National Bank (PNB) official. Investigators suspect that she did not have the money and identified Yuvraj as someone who could provide it.

On September 2, Anya, who was working as a freelance real estate agent, met Yuvraj at Roots Cafe in Gurugram’s Sector 29. Yuvraj, who was due to get married in October, was looking to buy a home.

“Anya had told him about some flats in Gurugram’s Pyramid Society in Sector 70 that were available at throwaway prices,” said an officer.

Police said Anya was trying to find out exactly how much money Yuvraj could put together: how much he had in his accounts, how much he planned to borrow from banks, and how much he was taking from friends and family.

Four days later, Yuvraj was dead. Anya and Sanyam allegedly shot him dead inside their white Creta in Gurugram’s Sector 70.

The ‘threat’

Anya and Sanyam had both worked with Yuvraj at real estate developer Emaar.

Police said Anya and Sanyam were fired in 2022 the same year they met at work.

EXPRESS special

Yuvraj murder: Accused cited Rs 90L debt, used ‘fake threats’ to involve partner

● WHAT LED TO YUVRAJ’S MURDER



● Anya Vats allegedly posed as a senior officer and sent herself threatening messages.

● She convinced her partner, Sanyam Sachdeva, that they were being pursued and needed to act.

● She allegedly came to know about Yuvraj Manchanda’s finances, knew he could raise money.

● She used a fake investment opportunity to get Yuvraj into their SUV.

“She had been bringing clients to Emaar, but was also making side-deals, along with Sanyam, for extra money. When the company learnt of it, they were fired,” said the officer.

Anya and Sanyam’s relationship had also begun at Emaar, said police. When she first met Sanyam, he had been married for six years and had a daughter.

The officer said, “She allegedly messaged his wife, claiming that Sanyam was making romantic advances towards her. She also allegedly created a fake profile of his wife and showed it to Sanyam, trying to prove that she was also keeping secrets from him. Sanyam left his family and started living with Anya.”

After being let go from Emaar, the couple went to Dehradun for over one-and-a-half years before returning to Gurugram. Anya and Sanyam also had a son.

By September of 2024, Anya

was facing financial trouble.

According to the officer, Anya had two cases of cheating registered against her.

One of them involved the high-level PNB official, whom Anya and Sanyam had allegedly cheated of Rs 1.25 crore between 2025 and 2026. A case was registered against them at Parliament Street police station in August this year.

In the FIR lodged on August 16, the PNB official said he had been served fake ED notices by Anya and Sanyam. Police said Anya also claimed strong connections in the government, and allegedly took more than Rs 1.25 crore from him, saying the money was being paid to get his name cleared. But when they demanded more money, the official examined the notices and allegedly found them forged.

“Anya feared action and she proposed an out-of-court settlement to the complainant. He demanded that she start by pay-

ing him a post-dated cheque of Rs 90 lakh,” said the officer.

But Anya didn’t have Rs 90 lakh in her account.

According to the police, it was then that Anya began manipulating Sanyam.

Police said she allegedly showed Sanyam some messages from a “senior officer”, who was threatening her to return his money. The only way to pay him back, she allegedly told Sanyam, was to kill Yuvraj and take his money.

“But there was no senior officer. It was Anya posing as one; she had allegedly been sending messages to herself since April from a different number to make Sanyam believe she had influential connections,” said the officer.

The murder

Anya knew Yuvraj was doing well from his social media, said the officer. Her plan, the officer claimed, was to take Yuvraj’s money and clear her dues.

She allegedly asked Sanyam to get a gun and two bedsheets and keep them inside their SUV.

On September 6, Anya called Yuvraj while he was having lunch with his sister, Karishma, at Golden Dragon restaurant in Lajpat Nagar. She allegedly told him that a client wanted to invest with Adani Realty but that the deal had to be closed immediately.

Yuvraj drove to Anya and Sanyam and got into their car. Inside, police alleged, they shot him. They covered his body with bedsheets and kept it inside the vehicle for two days.

Yuvraj did not return home that night. Yet his family continued receiving messages suggesting that he was safe.

On September 8, police alleged, Anya and Sanyam dumped his body in a drain at Badshahpur. They then travelled to Vrindavan and later to Kaichhi Dham in Uttarakhand. They were later arrested from a PG accommodation.

On September 16, Delhi Police learnt that a body had been found days earlier in Gurugram’s Sector 70. But it had been cremated even before it could be identified.

The body was Yuvraj’s.

ACCUSED MEN BOOKED, PROBE ON

Nagaland woman pulled towards car by 3 men at 5-star hotel, friends attacked

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 6

A WOMAN from Nagaland was allegedly harassed and forcibly pulled towards a Mercedes car by three men in the parking lot of a five-star hotel in Chanakypuri early Sunday. When her friends intervened, the men allegedly assaulted them with hockey sticks and iron rods, police said.

The incident took place around 3.30 am Sunday, police said. According to a complaint filed by the woman, she had visited the hotel with friends. While they were leaving, three men, who were travelling in a white Mercedes, allegedly approached them, tried to stop the woman and attempted to pull her into the vehicle.

Police said the woman’s friends intervened, following which the accused allegedly attacked them with hockey sticks

and iron rods. “One of the friends suffered injuries to his teeth...,” an officer said.

The accused allegedly fled from the spot in their car after police reached the location. The complainant had noted down the car’s registration number, which helped investigators trace the men, police also said.

The three accused were booked at Chanakypuri police station. The woman was taken to RML Hospital, where she underwent a medical examination. Police said the case was registered on the basis of her complaint and the medical report.

Police are examining CCTV camera footage from the hotel and other evidence to establish the sequence of events. The medical reports are also being examined to ascertain the injuries suffered by those involved, they said.



CJ Surya Kant with newly-appointed Supreme Court judge Justice DK Upadhyaya during a swearing-in ceremony on Tuesday. PTI

Tried to softly bend law towards justice: CJ Upadhyaya as he bids farewell to HC

Justice Nitin Wasudeo Sambre to preside over as acting Chief Justice

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 6

FOLLOWING HIS elevation as a judge of the Supreme Court, Delhi High Court’s outgoing Chief Justice DK Upadhyaya on Tuesday remarked that he tried to “softly bend the law towards justice for deserving litigants” when law failed to ensure a just outcome in a case.

With CJ Upadhyaya bidding farewell to the Delhi HC, the second senior-most judge of the High Court — Justice Nitin Wasudeo Sambre — will now preside over as the acting Chief Justice of Delhi HC.

“As a judge, I’ve always tried to bind justice, law and compassion together. Like other judges, I came across unforeseen situations when law was not able to ensure a just outcome in the case, and it appeared isolated from justice. In

such situations, I tried to softly bend the law towards justice for the deserving litigant, and to be able to do so has been a blessing for me,” he said.

CJ Upadhyaya, with his parent high court at Allahabad, has been in charge of Delhi HC since January 2025. Appointed as a judge of the Allahabad HC in November 2011, CJ Upadhyaya is due to retire in June 2027. Prior to Delhi HC, he also served as Chief Justice of Bombay HC.

During CJ Upadhyaya’s tenure at HC, 85 advocates of the Delhi HC were designated as senior advocates.

His tenure at Delhi HC was also marked with several important orders. Nearly two months after he took charge, HC judge Justice Yashwant Varma was embroiled in the controversy after alleged unaccounted cash was found at his official residence during a fire, in March 2025. In its aftermath, CJ Upadhyaya had submitted a report on the incident following a preliminary inquiry to then Chief Justice of India Sanjiv Khanna with the “prima facie opinion that the entire matter warrants a deeper probe”.

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 6

EXPANSION OF the ANMOL scheme, which raises the free newborn screening programme for newborns, from 56 to 63 diseases, doubling of the monthly incentive for ASHA workers from Rs 3,000 to Rs 6,000 — these were among the several new healthcare initiatives launched by the Delhi Government on Tuesday under the “Seva Sankalp Abhiyan” programme, organised at Thyagraj Stadium.

The programme also saw the virtual inauguration of the State Organ and Tissue Transplant Organisation (SOTTO) building at GB Pant Hospital.

Further, a Nursing Home Management System portal was launched, which moves registration and renewal for private nursing homes online, officials said.

The hike in incentives is set to benefit 6,690 ASHA workers in the Capital, officials said, adding that the increment is a recognition of the dedication with which the workers bring Delhi’s health services to households. ASHA workers act as the link between the community and the public health system. They register pregnant women, push for institutional deliveries, track immunisation, counsel families on nutrition and sanitation, and accompany patients to health facilities and



Chief Minister Rekha Gupta during the launch of the healthcare initiatives in New Delhi on Tuesday. PTI

work under the National Health Mission.

Speaking on the develop-

ment, Health Minister Pankaj Kumar Singh said, “The incentive had been pending for

nearly a decade. Through the Covid years, the workers kept serving. The steps to recognise them did not come. This government has addressed it.”

On Tuesday, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta also felicitated outstanding workers at the “ASHA Sammelan-2026 and ASHA Samman Samaroh”. She said she expects them to reach every family like an elder sister, and announced a special dandiya programme for them during Navratri.

Delhi Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu said, “ASHA workers stand on the frontlines of the healthcare system, taking health services and awareness to pregnant women, children and families.”

● PLATFORM USES AI TO IDENTIFY THE AGENCY RESPONSIBLE FOR A ROAD, FILE COMPLAINTS AND PUBLICLY TRACK WHETHER POTHOLES ARE REPAIRED

1,815 complaints, 20 repairs: Meet Delhi teen behind platform to fix potholes

Sophiya Mathew
New Delhi, October 6

LAST OCTOBER, Parth Anand’s parents were driving to Delhi’s Karol Bagh to buy clothes for his grandparents’ anniversary when their motor-cycle hit a pothole.

They fell off the vehicle and suffered fractures. It took them about three months to recover.

Anand reported the pothole through the Municipal Corporation of Delhi’s (MCD) system. But responses, he found, could take three to four months.

“What struck me was that more and more people were complaining, but the authorities were still not re-

sponding. That frustration kept growing,” he said.

That experience eventually became the starting point for Project Sadak.

In March this year, the 15-year-old began building a platform that would do more than collect pothole complaints. It would identify the agency responsible, send the complaint to it and, crucially, leave a public trail of what happened next.

Anand built the first platform himself, working on it alongside school — he studies at St Francis de Sales School in Janakpuri — during a roughly three-hour window between tuition and his commute home.

He later used AI to develop the platform further.

As of September, the platform had recorded 1,815 reports across India, including more than 220 from Delhi. Bengaluru accounts for more than 1,500, while other reports have come from Rajasthan, Uttarakhand and Kerala.

More than 20 repairs have been documented through the platform.

In Vikaspuri, two potholes reported through Sadak in April were fixed in about five days, Anand said. In Bengaluru, a complaint filed in June was followed by a repair within two days. Anand said his analysis of pothole complaints in the



Parth Anand, 15, started building the platform in March this year.

city found that repairs typically take three to four months.

The number of reports also rose during the monsoon, increasing by 25% in cities such as Bengaluru and Delhi, he added.

A resident first uploads a photograph and location of the damaged road. The report then goes through an AI-assisted verification process to identify whether the image actually shows a pothole and to detect duplicate reports.

The system also asks the person reporting the pothole to classify the nature of severity. Anand said this determines how the platform follows up with authorities.

Once a report is verified, an AI agent identifies the authority responsible for that particular road and files a complaint with it.

Depending on the road, this could mean agencies such as the MCD or NHAI. The AI agent also follows up through email.

Each report, Anand said, is photographed, geotagged and timestamped, and its status remains publicly visible.

“What makes it different is that existing channels like MCD 311 / PWD helplines take complaints, but citizens rarely see what happens next — and there’s no public record of how long the fixes take. Sadak’s focus is primarily on public

tracking,” said Anand.

Initially, Anand built the platform using his own coding knowledge. As the project grew more complex, he began using AI to further develop and scale it. “The basic reporting form was easy to build myself. It got complex once real reports started coming in.”

One of the problems was duplicate reporting. “Many people report the same pothole, so the system has to tell if two reports are the same spot using GPS and photos,” he said.

Alongside the project, Anand said he is working on AI research in mechanistic interpretability with Prof Manolis Kellis’s lab, at MIT Computer

Science and Artificial Intelligence Laboratory (CSAIL), and is an Emergent Ventures fellow.

The project also received a grant from the Lift Off Grant, an independent microgrant programme, which was used to meet the development costs of the project.

On future plans, Anand said he had discussions with another country about adapting the platform to meet its national reporting requirements, and was in talks with an automotive technology company to deploy instant pothole-fixing machines, which could raise awareness about Project Sadak and the need for faster repairs.



Hot Spot

MEMBERS OF the Samajwadi Party, participating in the INDIA bloc protest demanding CEC Gyanesh Kumar's resignation, had a difficult time on Tuesday afternoon as the sun beat down on Sansad Marg. The spot where the SP MPs were standing outside Akashvani Bhawan was without any shade and several MPs complained of discomfort. Rampur MP Mohibullah Nadvi almost fainted due to heat exhaustion. When some reporters tried to get an interview with the MP, he refused and signalled that he was not feeling well and wanted to be left alone.

Grand Closing

EAST WILL meet west during not one but two simultaneous closing ceremonies of the Seva Sankalp Yatra on Wednesday. The two yatras, which began on September 17 to mark Prime Minister Narendra Modi's 25 years of public service as the head of government, from Gujarat's Vadnagar and Uttar Pradesh's Varanasi, will conclude with grand ceremonies in Varanasi and Vadnagar, respectively. In addition to young party workers chosen to be 'Seva Yatris' from across the country, "young citizens" will also take part in the two events in "significant numbers", party sources said. In Varanasi, the yatra will culminate with a 'Jalabhishek' at the Kashi Vishwanath Dham in the presence of BJP president Nitin Nabin, Uttar Pradesh CM Yogi Adityanath, Assam CM Himanta Biswa Sarma and BJYM national president Hemang Joshi. In Vadnagar, the Yatra will conclude with a 'Jalabhishek' at Hateshwar Mahadev Mandir. Union Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan, West Bengal CM Suvenud Adhikari, Gujarat CM Bhupendra Patel and Gujarat Dy CM Harsh Sanghavi would address the gathering on the occasion.

TN privilege case: SC closes proceedings, but keeps open questions of law

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 6

WITH THE 2003 Tamil Nadu case that triggered a reference to its seven-judge bench on the question of legislative privileges vis-a-vis free speech having been withdrawn, the Supreme Court on Tuesday closed proceedings in the matter, while leaving the question of law open to be decided on a future occasion.

The bench presided by CJI Surya Kant noted that the 2003 resolution of the Tamil Nadu Assembly, which formed the basis of the reference, was withdrawn by the Assembly in 2004. The bench, also comprising Justices Aravind Kumar, PK Mishra, Joy-malya Bagchi, Vipul Pancholi, Shree Chandrashekhar and V Mohana, said that the July 30, 2004 Assembly resolution withdrawing the earlier resolution of November 7, 2003 "was not specifically brought to the notice of this Court". "It also escaped notice" when it made the reference to the seven-judge bench.

The case dates back to a 2003 article in *The Hindu*, criticising then CM J Jayalalithaa and her government. The Assembly concluded that it amounted to a breach of privilege. After the November 7, 2003, resolution, police arrested *The Hindu* Editor N Ravi, along with four others. This was challenged in the SC.

AAM JANATA UNNAYAN PARTY CHIEF HUMAYUN KABIR ARRESTED IN REJINAGAR, RELEASED

Bengal bypolls see 80% turnout, Opp seeks repoll; Vijay faces acid test in TN

Ravik Bhattacharya, Atri Mitra & Arun Janardhanan
Nandigram, Kolkata, Chennai, October 6

THE BYPOLLS for the two Assembly constituencies in West Bengal on Tuesday saw the arrest of Aam Janata Unnayan Party (AJUP) chief Humayun Kabir and the Opposition's pitch for a repoll over alleged vote-rigging and other irregularities. There were no reports of any violence during polling.

The Opposition's allegations were rejected by the ruling BJP in the state and Chief Minister Suvenud Adhikari.

The Nandigram Assembly seat in Purba Medinipur district recorded a turnout of about 80.87%, while Rejinagar in Murshidabad registered about 80.07% polling, as per the Election Commission officials. The bypolls in the two seats were necessitated after Adhikari resigned from the Nandigram seat and retained his Bhabanipur constituency in Kolkata, while Kabir vacated the Rejinagar seat and retained his Nowda seat.

Soon after polling began, Kabir was arrested by police in Rejinagar after he accused them of interfering with voting at



Voters at a polling booth in Nandigram on Tuesday. PARTHA PAUL

multiple polling stations. His son Gulam Nabi Azad is the AUPJ candidate from Rejinagar.

"Police are intimidating our workers, booth agents and voters. We will not leave the booths," Kabir told reporters before being arrested.

In his hometown Nandigram, Adhikari said polling has been peaceful. "In 2016, I won in Nandigram by 82,000 votes. I think this time we will cross the margin," he said. "The Nowda MLA (Kabir) was arrested. Law is same for all. Even for me. I can cast my vote in my booth... I cannot visit other booths or campaign. If I

break the law, I will be arrested."

Later, Kabir was released by police at around 9 pm.

The Congress's Nandigram candidate, Milan Pradhan, however alleged that "during the day, genuine voters were not allowed to vote, but booths were captured by BJP agents with the help of police." He was recently arrested in old cases linked to the 2007 Nandigram land-acquisition agitation, but was later released on interim bail.

The BJP has fielded Hansirani Rath, mother of Chandranath Rath — Adhikari's aide who was murdered — as its

candidate in Nandigram.

In Rejinagar, Congress candidate Abdullahil Kafi staged a sit-in protest near the police station alleging that booths had been captured by BJP agents.

Rabiul Alam Chowdhury, the Mamata Banerjee-led TMC candidate, sent a letter to the state's Chief Electoral Officer, demanding repoll. Bengal Congress president Subhankar Sarkar also demanded a repoll in both seats. However, the BJP targeted the Opposition, saying that they want "old violent polling days to return" in the state.

Five months after the C Joseph Vijay-led TVK stormed to power in Tamil Nadu, the state saw voting in the Madurantakam and Dharapuram Assembly bypolls, which was largely peaceful, barring EVM glitches and isolated disputes. Madurantakam recorded 86.26% turnout, compared with 87.84% in the April Assembly election, while Dharapuram registered 80.30% polling as against 86.74% earlier, as per the EC officials.

Both constituencies are Scheduled Caste (SC)-reserved seats vacated by the AIADMK legislators who resigned within weeks of being elected as they crossed over to Vijay's party.

These two leaders — Maragatham Kumaravel in Madurantakam and P Sathyabama in Dharapuram — are now contesting as the TVK candidates.

Facing his first major electoral test, Vijay campaigned extensively for his candidates. He spent four days campaigning in the two constituencies — two days of public rallies and two of roadshows — a substantial commitment for bypolls from a CM whose own appearances during the state Assembly elections had been relatively limited. In these bypolls, DMK supremo M K Stalin and AIADMK chief Edappadi K Palaniswami or EPS also campaigned pro-actively for their respective candidates, sharpening their attacks on Vijay.

In neighbouring Puducherry, the bypoll to the Thattanchavady Assembly seat recorded 80.81% polling at 6 pm. The bypoll was necessitated as the AINRC chief and CM, N Rangasamy, a BJP ally, vacated it after retaining his Mangalam seat.

Meanwhile, in Assam, voting for the Nagaon Lok Sabha seat bypoll registered 76% turnout until 5 pm. The counting of votes for all the bypolls is scheduled for October 9.

EXPRESS special

Police had protest under control, then Gandhis walked into Akashvani

Asad Rehman

New Delhi, October 6

AS THE INDIA bloc tried to make it to the Election Commission, its leaders ran into police barricades metres from the poll panel's office. Soon afterwards, Opposition leaders started getting detained and herded into police buses. The march seemed all but over, and only a handful of Congress leaders remained.

Just then, the Gandhi siblings pulled off an impromptu move, upending the script and taking police and their fellow Opposition leaders by surprise. Around 8 pm, police moved in to detain the Gandhis and other Opposition leaders. It all kicked off around noon when Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi climbed a barricade near the NITI Aayog office at Sansad Marg, a few hundred metres from the ECI headquarters of Nirvachan Sadan, and waved the Tricolour as cameras clicked him.

Rahul then climbed down as police began detaining MPs sitting on the road. Minutes later, he dashed back towards a bus parked near Akashvani Bhavan, the headquarters of All India Radio, where his sister Priyanka Gandhi Vadra was seated, catching many Opposition MPs, including some from the Congress, by surprise. As Rahul was about to get into the bus, the siblings locked eyes with each other. Priyanka got down and, along with her brother, walked past policemen towards Akashvani Bhavan, leaving the cops also surprised.

Though the Akashvani staff tried to stop them, leading to a tense stand-off, the two eventually made their way inside. "We don't know what happened. This was not part of the plan," said a Congress leader. A Congress MP outside



Congress MP Priyanka Gandhi Vadra being detained by police from Akashvani Bhavan in New Delhi on Tuesday. GAJENDRA YADAV

usually made their way inside. "We don't know what happened. This was not part of the plan," said a Congress leader. A Congress MP outside

Akashvani said, "Only the two of them know what they had in mind when they walked in." Congress leaders credited the Gandhis with derailing police's attempts to end the protest. "The protest would have been over had they not done this," said a leader. Congress leaders said Rahul made the plan on the fly to use Akashvani as a shortcut to Nirvachan Sadan, which is located near the back gate of the broadcaster's headquarters. However, police closed the gate, leaving the Congress leaders to camp on Akashvani's premises.

Delhi Police and Rapid Action Force personnel have been stationed outside the Bhavan.

While Opposition sources claimed Priyanka was leading negotiations with senior government officials — insisting the protest will continue until they

are allowed to meet Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar and Election Commissioners Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi — the Home Ministry dismissed it as "fake".

Around 2.30 pm, as reporters pushed their microphones through the grille, Rahul told them from inside the premises, "I don't care what the BJP says. I'm standing here to protect democracy. What has been done to the country is treason. Be it PM Modi, (Amit) Shah, the RSS chief, or Gyanesh Kumar, none will be spared."

Until reports last came in, Congress leaders led by the siblings were carrying on from the sit-in, with Opposition MPs such as Derek O'Brien and Mahua Moitra of the Mamata Banerjee-led All India Trinamool Congress also joining them at the Bhavan. "Unmoved. Unfazed. We will not budge until our demands are met. We will not rest until our democracy is saved from the *Vote Chors*," KC Venugopal posted on X.

Telangana lodges 1st FIR on 'illegal' Form 7, BJP's BLA booked

Nikhila Henry

Hyderabad, October 6

POLICE IN Chikkadpally, Hyderabad, have registered an FIR against a Booth Level Agent (BLA) of the BJP for filing allegedly fraudulent form 7s against 30 people — all of them Muslim — in the Musheerabad Assembly constituency.

The action comes a day ahead of the end of the claims and objections phase of the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral roll in the state.

The FIR was filed against BJP's S Balachander, on a complaint by Musheerabad Electoral Registration Officer T Praveen Kumar Reddy, after a preliminary inquiry reportedly showed that Form 7s submitted by him were pre-printed with names of voters concerned. BJP rivals have called this proof that the Form 7s had been "centrally generated" from the BJP office.

Similar forms with pre-printed voter information have also been reported in Bahadurpura and Goshamahall constituencies in Hyderabad.

The 30 people against whom Balachander is said to have submitted Form 7s — for the deletion of names from electoral roll — include a Congress BLA. As per the FIR, the BLA brought 30 "pre-printed Form 7s and made efforts to submit them to the BLO, polling station no. 210, on September 28, 2026, with a mala fide intention for deleting voters not connected to him". When the BLO and BLO Supervisor "collectively refused to receive" the forms, in spite of "repeated

requests from the said BJP BLA", Balachander "left the forms (on) the BLO's premises and fled".

The officials said that a "personal field verification" by them on October 1 showed that all the 30 whose names were flagged by the BLA were residents of Musheerabad. "Therefore, the form 7s in question cannot be accepted and (are) liable for rejection," the FIR says. Balachander was booked under BNS sections 217 and 318(2), pertaining to giving false information to a government officer and cheating, and Section 31 of the Representation of the People Act, 1950.

On Monday, Telangana Chief Electoral Officer C Sudarshan Reddy issued a memo asking district collectors and District Election Officers of the state to take action against those filing false Form 7s, saying instances of this had come to their notice.

AIMIM supremo Asaduddin Owaisi claimed that in Goshamahall seat too, "false" Form 7s had been filed to delete names of Muslim voters. "Our request to the CEO is to not spare anyone who is spreading this hatred against Muslims," Owaisi said.

BJP state president N Ramchander Rao has denied attempts by the party to delete voters, accusing the Congress of "misguiding" the public against a constitutional institution like the ECI. Telangana had 3.39 crore voters before the SIR process started on June 15. In the draft list, 73.39 lakh voters names were deleted and 92 lakh voters were sent notices. The final electoral roll is to be published on November 9.

CEC postpones 2-day visit to Chhattisgarh

Jayprakash S Naidu

Raipur, October 6

CEC GYANESH Kumar and other senior ECI officials have postponed their two-day visit to Chhattisgarh, scheduled for October 7 and 8. Kumar was scheduled to visit Danteshwari Mata temple in Dantewada, Chitrakoot waterfall (Bastar), and Bhordawade temple (Kawardha).

As per a letter issued on Tuesday by the Chief Electoral Of-

ficer's office in Chhattisgarh, Kumar had been declared a State Guest for the duration of his visit.

"It is informed that the Election Commission has postponed the Chhattisgarh visit of Shri Gyanesh Kumar, Hon'ble Chief Election Commissioner, and other senior officials of the Commission, due to unavoidable reasons. The revised date of the visit will be communicated separately once it is received from the Commission," the letter read.

'Maharashtra now centre of Maoist urban network', need MSPS Act: Govt to HC

Omkar Gokhale

Mumbai, October 6

SEEKING DISMISSAL of pleas by the state Congress and others challenging the Constitutional validity of the Maharashtra Special Public Security (MSPS) Act, the state Home department told the Bombay High Court that Maharashtra "due to its highest urban population has become the centre of Maoist urban network" and as it did not have a legal framework to ban frontal organisations, the law was enacted "to establish a robust legal framework to prevent and tackle unlawful, subversive, and extremist activities".

A bench led by Chief Justice Mahesh Chandra Tripathi granted petitioners to file rejoinder to the state's affidavit, and posted further hearing to

October 16. Petitions filed by the Congress, the Communist Party of India (CPI) and the All India Trade Union Congress (AITUC) contended that the law curbed peaceful and legitimate dissent and conferred "wide-ranging, arbitrary, and excessive powers" on the executive to ban organisations "without any judicial scrutiny or oversight."

"Maharashtra, because of its highest urban population, became the centre of Maoist urban network. It did not have legal framework of public security Act to ban frontal organisation like other Left Wing Extremism-affected states (Andhra Pradesh, Madhya Pradesh, Telangana, Chhattisgarh)," read the affidavit by state Home Department deputy secretary Pritam Kumar Jawale, and contested petitioners' legal standing to file the pleas.

GOA FORWARD PARTY SAYS ALLIANCE CANNOT WORK IF CONGRESS IS TARGETED; AAP SAYS BJP-CONGRESS 'JOINT VENTURE' DESTROYED STATE

Goa's anti-BJP coalition teeters as AAP ally makes a case for 'grand unity'

Pavneet Singh Chadha

Panaji, October 6

WEEKS AFTER the AAP and the Goa Forward Party (GFP) announced a joint alliance for the 2027 Assembly polls in the coastal state, the alliance seems to be fracturing in less than a month.

The AAP and the GFP had announced the "Goa First" alliance on September 13, calling it a "non-BJP, non-Congress" platform, which would offer an "alternative to the BJP-Congress collusion" in the state.

In the days leading up to the alliance, hoardings bearing the AAP and GFP symbols came up

along the state's national highway. The hoardings targeted the BJP and the Congress over the issue of defections, saying, "Congress and BJP cheated you twice. Don't let them cheat you the third time." On Tuesday, some of these hoardings were pulled down.

In the past few days, GFP president Vijai Sardesai has reiterated that the people of Goa want a "grand alliance" of all the parties to defeat the BJP, leading to speculation of allying with the Congress. On Tuesday, Sardesai said, "In politics, the voter is the King. From Goan voters, I can hear only one call...



AAP and GFP announced the 'Goa First' alliance on September 13. FILE

that a grand alliance is necessary. They want a grand alliance of all parties coming together to

defeat the BJP. This echo is such that even if you are hard of hearing, you will be able to hear it."

"If you brought mangoes to Goa and instead of Mancurad, you begin selling Alphonso or Dasheri from Delhi, will that sell? It won't. Because Goans don't like their taste. What do the Goans want? They want a Mancurad, be it a Cardozo Mancurad or a Bardez Mancurad. But they want an original Mancurad."

Sardesai said no final decision was taken though. "There is a call for a greater unity of all those who are genuinely opposed to the BJP. So, if this alliance is to be brought together, it can't be through targeting the principal Opposition party. This is what the people feel. And we

have to do what the people feel."

The AAP has now asked Sardesai to clarify his stand on the alliance. In a statement on Monday, the party's core committee said the BJP-Congress "joint venture" had destroyed Goa in the last decade and that Sardesai "must decide whether he stands with the BJP-Congress joint venture or with the people of Goa."

AAP Goa president Valmiki Naik said it was clear and agreed upon from the start that there would be no place for the Congress in the Goa First Alliance. Naik said Congress candidates had deep roots in the BJP and "all the signs point to a 'hat-

trick' of defections by the Congress". On Tuesday, the AAP reiterated that Goa First is a "non-BJP non-Congress" platform.

In 2022, the BJP emerged as the single-largest party, winning 20 of the state's 40 seats, while the Congress returned with 11. The GFP contested the 2022 Assembly polls in alliance with the Congress and won one seat, represented by Sardesai, the Fatorda MLA. The AAP won two seats. Subsequently, in September 2022, eight Congress MLAs defected to the BJP, bringing the Congress's tally down to three. Earlier, in 2019, 10 Congress MLAs had defected to the BJP.

Vizag Naval base staffer, driver held for spying for Pak

Sreenivas Janyala
Hyderabad, October 6

BUSTING A module allegedly involved in sharing sensitive defence information with Pakistan Intelligence Operatives (PIOs), the Andhra Pradesh Police's Counter Intelligence Cell has arrested two persons associated with the naval base at Visakhapatnam, officials said.

Police said the module comprises 18 suspects of which 13 are from the Navy.

The arrested accused include Pradeep Mukharjee, an employee of Visakhapatnam base, who was held in Coimbatore, Tamil Nadu, for his alleged involvement in sharing an OTP for activation of a WhatsApp account by a PIO, communicating with them, and sharing sensitive information relating to Naval/Defence establishments, officials said.

He was produced before a court in Vijayawada on Tuesday, which sent him to judicial remand till October 14.

The other person to have been arrested is Annam Sai Varaprasad, a civilian contractual driver engaged for naval officers at Visakhapatnam, who was allegedly involved in sharing sensitive information with a PIO in lieu of money, officials said.

He was produced in a court in Visakhapatnam on Tuesday, which also sent him to judicial remand till October 14.

The arrests are part of a co-ordinated operation, titled "Operation Firewall-2026", launched by the Counter Intelligence (CI) Cell on October 1.

As part of this, 12 teams of the CI cell were deployed across 10 states and Union Territories,

4 with Bhatti links held in J&K, Punjab; 'items from Pakistan' seized

Arun Sharma
Jammu, October 6

THE JAMMU & Kashmir Police on Tuesday claimed to have arrested four people, including a Punjab resident, for allegedly being members of a cross-border narco-terror module with links in Pakistan. Police claimed the accused had links with Pakistan-based gangster Shahzad Bhatti.

The arrested persons included two residents of Talhar, both called Ajay Kumar who went by the aliases Rabb and Sam, respectively, and one Rahul from Treva.

Police claimed they have seized an Italian-made Beretta pistol along with two magazines and four live rounds, besides 500 grams of heroin and opium each from them.

The seized items were reportedly dropped by drone from Pakistan, a police official said. Police said all three accused are in their early 20s and are drug addicts.

namely Andhra Pradesh, Kerala, Maharashtra, Karnataka, Gujarat, Goa, Delhi, Tamil Nadu, Chhattisgarh and Bihar.

A case was registered in this regard at the Counter Intelligence Police Station, Vijayawada, on September 2 under Sections 61(2), 147 and 148 read with Section 3(5) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS) pertaining to charges of criminal conspiracy, waging war, and conspiring to wage war or overawe the government, committed with a shared common intention. Besides, sections of the UAPA and Official Secrets Act have been slapped on the accused.

According to the FIR, the CI cell received credible information regarding certain persons in India allegedly maintaining direct contact with PIOs and their suspected involvement in an espionage conspiracy prejudicial to India's national security.

The suspects were allegedly collecting and sharing the sensitive/classified information relating to defence establishments and strategic locations in Visakhapatnam and other parts of the country through encrypted communication channels, the FIR stated.

In coordination with Anti-Terrorist Squads of the respective states, Naval officials and local police, the AP CI Cell investigation teams examined the alleged complicity of the 18 suspects and seized electronic gadgets from them.

The two suspects were arrested after prima facie their role was established in this case, said officials. Further investigation is underway for the remaining suspects.

CBI books Punjab CM's OSD for graft, searches Mann's 'camp office'

Kanchan Vasdev
Chandigarh, October 6

THE CBI on Tuesday registered a corruption case against Rajbir Singh Ghuman, an OSD to Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann, and other senior officials and conducted searches at eight locations, including Mann's camp office in Chandigarh, officials said. Mann said that the BJP has started preparing for Punjab elections and was now resorting to central agencies to target him and his government.

The CBI, in a statement, said that following the orders of the Punjab and Haryana High Court, "and receipt of report from the Enforcement Directorate", it has registered an FIR to "investigate the allegations of corruption against OSD to Punjab Chief Minister (CM) and his associates for influencing and manipulating postings of officers including that of IAS and IPS officers, departmental proceedings, matters pertaining to policy formulation, administrative approvals, tender conditions, licensing matters, land use conversion matters, property disputes, revenue and land related issues in lieu of pecuniary benefits".

"It is also alleged that the accused public servants purportedly accessed and provided drafts of orders and policies to



During the CBI raid at House No. 50 in Chandigarh's Sector 2. It serves as Punjab CM Bhagwant Mann's camp office. KAMLESHWAR SINGH

private persons prior to their issuance by the government," the CBI statement said, adding the agency has booked six persons, including two public servants. They include Ghuman, alleged middleman Nitin Gohal, Jitin Gohal alias Raja, Romi Raja Mahajan, Bir Devinder, RS Nagra and "unknown public servant(s) and private person(s)", it added.

The central agency carried out raids at House No. 50, the camp office allotted to Mann under the Chief Minister's pool, where Ghuman had been staying. It also conducted searches at Ghuman's residence in Gharachon in Sangrur district apart from locations in Mohali, Gurdaspur, Ludhiana, Patiala, and Jalandhar connected with the accused persons. "Incriminating

evidence such as laptops, mobile phones and documents have been seized. These are being scrutinized for evidence of bribery and impropriety..." read the CBI statement.

The raids came hours after the Supreme Court agreed to hear a Punjab government plea challenging a Punjab and Haryana High Court's order directing the CBI to investigate Ghuman and others. The high court, in its order on Monday, had held that material shared by the ED with Punjab DGP in the matter prima facie indicated their involvement in acts of corruption, including cash for transfers and cash for favourable orders.

The state filed a Special Leave Petition at around 2 am in the Supreme Court against the HC order.

EXPRESS special

'Imaandaar CM' to CBI raid: Mann's 2027 campaign faces a new test

Manraj Grewal Sharma
Chandigarh, October 6

"*IMAANDAAR CM*", "*Lokan da CM*", "*AAP da ikkonaara, Bhagwant Mann dobara*." (Honest CM, people's CM; AAP has one slogan, Bhagwant Mann for the second time).

As you drive down from Chandigarh to Jalandhar and then on to Kapurthala, a beaming Bhagwant Mann, the Punjab Chief Minister, is your constant companion, looking down at you from billboards in his trademark yellow turban. This is a far cry from late 2021, when Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) national convenor Arvind Kejriwal dominated the hoardings in Punjab, with Mann emerging later after a phone poll — "*Janta chunegi apna CM*" (People will choose their CM) — saw him handpicked for the top post with 93% of the votes.

While other parties, except the Shiromani Akali Dal led by the Badals, remain largely non-committal about their CM face, the AAP, which swept the 2022 Assembly polls by winning 92 of 117 seats, is clearly making Mann its mascot for 2027. The flip side to this is that it puts Mann, and by extension AAP, under intense scrutiny. There was a political firestorm on Monday after the Punjab and Haryana High Court ordered a CBI probe into allegations linked to his office, following the Punjab Police's failure to act on three letters sent by the Enforcement Directorate to the Punjab DGP. The allegations in-

volve Mann's Officer on Special Duty, Rajbir Singh Ghuman, and others. On Tuesday evening, the CBI raided Ghuman's residence and the CM's camp office even as the government challenged the High Court order in the Supreme Court earlier in the day.

For a couple of months now, the CM has been hitting the road almost every day with his "*lok milnis*" (public meetings), especially after the Akal Takht, the highest temporal seat of Sikhs, declared him a "*Guru Dokhi*" (betrayer of the Guru) on June 15 over a controversial video.

The Opposition had thought the edict would turn him into a social outcast of sorts. But Mann has remained constantly in the public eye, criss-crossing the length and breadth of the state almost every day, except for a short break in early July.

His message changes with the audience but has two constants: 300 units of free electricity a month, presented on billboards and in speeches as 600 units since bills are typically bi-monthly, and the "*satkar*" payments to women beneficiaries under the Maawan-Dheeyan Satkar Yojana that began on July 1. There is also a mandatory warning: "If you vote for other parties, all this will stop."

Focusing on the women who have now received money for six months under the scheme, which provides Rs 1,500 a month to eligible Dalit women and Rs 1,000 to others — with the first transfers made for three



'Imaandaar CM' hoarding in Ludhiana. GURMEET SINGH

months on July 1 and the second on October 1 — Mann has declared he will never let this "*toon-toon*" (sound of mobile notification about money coming in) stop. "*Kehnde Bhagwant Mann aurtan nu paise de ke sir charha reha hai ... toon-toon chaldi rahegi, band nahin hon devanga*." (They say I am spoiling women with money... this will carry on, it won't stop).

Potshots at Opposition

His other favourite pitch, especially in the countryside, is the increased access to canal water under his regime, from 26% in 2022 to 86% now, and the Rs 10 lakh health insurance for all. Many billboards relay the same message, with the tagline, "*Jo keeta so kar ke dikhaya*." (He delivered what he promised).

But it is his potshots at the Opposition that deliver the real sting: disparaging messages cloaked in laughter. Commenting on the elevation of former

Reacting to the development, Mann, in a post on 'X', said, "BJP has started preparing for the Punjab elections...CBI raided my camp office. Now, ED and CBI will be misused in Punjab, so that Punjab government and I can be defamed..." Mann said. The high court order came on a PIL filed by advocate Nikhil Saraf, who had sought an independent probe into the matter raised by the ED with the Punjab Police in its letters to the DGP. The ED had written to the DGP seeking registration of an FIR against an alleged middleman and others, reportedly linked to the Chief Minister's Office, for allegedly influencing transfers and postings of government officials, facilitating arms licence approvals, leaking confidential government documents and securing government approvals in lieu of alleged monetary and other benefits.

The ED had conducted searches on the premises of Nitin Gohal, Ajay Sehgal of Indian Cooperative House Building Society, the Suteec City Project and some others in May. The agency had submitted a 200-page affidavit in the high court on the PIL filed by Saraf.

The searches took place against the backdrop of an escalating confrontation between the Punjab government and central investigative agencies.

SC agrees to hear Punjab's plea against HC order for CBI probe into graft allegations

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 6

PUNJAB'S AAM Aadmi Party government on Tuesday approached the Supreme Court challenging the Punjab and Haryana High Court order directing the CBI to register a case and investigate allegations made by the Enforcement Directorate (ED) against people linked to Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann's office.

Senior Advocate Vikas Singh, appearing for the state, mentioned the matter before Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, seeking an urgent hearing on Tuesday itself. The CJI, however, said the court will consider listing the matter for hearing on Wednesday or Thursday.

Singh explained that in the case, under 66(2) of the Prevention of Money Laundering Act, information was given by the ED to the Punjab Director General of Police (DGP) in July-end.

He said that in the Vijay Madanlal Chowdhary case, in which the SC had upheld ED's powers of arrest and seizure, it was made clear that police have to act only if there is a cognizable offence, and that too only in a situation where a large amount of cash is found.

However, on October 5, the HC asked the CBI to register an FIR, he said. Seeking urgent listing, he said the CBI "can't be directed to register an FIR".

Singh said, "During election time, these kinds of cases are being trumped up...It's a state going to polls. It's a clear case of the federal structure which is... being violated."

The Punjab and Haryana HC on Monday directed the CBI to probe allegations raised in an ED communication to the police and submit its report within two months. The case is scheduled to come up before the High Court on December 7.

The ED had sought registration of a case against Mann's Officer on Special Duty Rajbir Singh Ghuman and his alleged associates Nitin Gohal and Bir Devinder. According to the allegations cited by the ED, Ghuman, Gohal and Devinder had allegedly interfered in transfers and postings of government officials, government work and tender processes.

The High Court order came on a PIL filed by advocate Nikhil Saraf, based on the ED communication sent to the DGP. The court noted that the communication was received in the DGP's office on August 3.

ED summons Punjab CM's brother-in-law in graft case; AAP: 'not his kin'

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 6

THE ENFORCEMENT Directorate (ED) on Tuesday summoned Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann's brother-in-law Amardeep Singh Grewal in connection with its probe into the alleged corrupt practices by senior officials linked to the Chief Minister's Office including cash for transfers and cash for getting favourable policies.

Grewal's wife and Mann's wife Gurpreet Kaur are cousins, an ED source said. The Aam Aadmi Party, however, said that Grewal is not related to Mann. "He is neither his brother-in-law, nor his co-brother. He is not even a friend," an AAP spokesperson said in Chandigarh.

ED had initially issued summons to Grewal for October 7, but following an appeal, he has been asked to appear at the Delhi office on October 9, a source privy to the developments said.

Grewal is associated with the Punjabi film industry and is linked to East Sunshine Production Pvt. Ltd. The company's corporate records list Grewal as one of its directors. He has been associated with various Punjabi films, including *Maujaan Hi Maujaan* (2023) and *Snowman* (2022), having overseas production/release linkages, an ED official said.

On Monday, the Punjab and Haryana High Court ordered the CBI to register an FIR and probe allegations of corruption against Punjab government officials, Rajbir Singh Ghuman, an officer on special duty to CM.

● BARRING ENTRY OF PASTORS FOR RELIGIOUS ACTIVITIES AMONG NEW RULES IN CHHATTISGARH VILLAGE INTRODUCED 'BY MISUSING SC VERDICT' IN A BURIAL RIGHTS CASE IN FEBRUARY

Gram sabha resolution against giving land for Christian burials raises concern

Jayprakash S Naidu
Raipur, October 6

AT PUNPALLI, a village in Chhattisgarh's Sukma district, a new banner has come up prohibiting the entry of pastors for religious activities.

The notice further states that the village will not allow any event being held for the purpose of conversions or any other religious activity. The development follows 12 resolutions taken recently by the village panchayat.

However, it is the resolution not written in the banner that has become a source of greater worry for the Christian community of 2,000 in this village.

"It (one of the resolutions) says that the village will not give any land for burials to tribals,

who follow Christianity," Madkam Bhima, a Janpat member elected from Punpalli village, said. Bhima said that till now, four villages have made such resolutions in Sukma, including Punpalli.

"It started from Errabore a few months ago followed by my village Polampalli. It will be done gradually in all villages," he said.

This village has only 21 families with 75 members who follow Christianity. If the resolution holds, the families will have to travel over 13 kilometers to Dhornapal for burials or to Sukma headquarters, which is over 40 kilometers away.

When asked if the dikat had a legal basis, Bhima said, "We are adhering to the PESA law."

During the October 2 meet-

ing, the Punpalli Gram Sabha cited the Panchayats (Extension to Scheduled Areas) Act, 1996 (PESA), as the village is covered under the Fifth Schedule of the Constitution of India.

The board that was put up soon after read: "According to PESA, the Gram Sabha has the right to protect its cultural identity, traditions, customs and social heritage. The villagers believe that activities related to religious conversion through inducement, pressure or any other means affect our traditional tribal culture, social unity and cultural identity. Therefore, it has been decided that any event related to religious conversion by outsiders, religious preaching whose objective is to convert people to another religion will



The decision was taken at a gram sabha meeting on October 2

not be acceptable..."

However, advocate Sudeep Shrivastava, who has been raising such issues in the region, said, "The entry of any Indian citizen in a village cannot be pro-

hibited. A person can profess his religion in any village. As far as others joining his prayers is concerned, the villagers have the right to voluntarily do so. If there is a resolution that says land will

not be given for any person living in the village, who professes Christianity, for burials, it is unconstitutional."

Nukesh Baghel, vice president of Bastar District Rural Christian Service Committee, said, "This is at least the 10th village in Bastar region which is doing this."

Nukesh said some groups have been misusing the split verdict by the Supreme Court in a burial rights case earlier this year. "The Supreme Court, in February, had ordered an interim stay on forcible exhumation of tribal Christians. Following this, villagers are not allowing us to bury the bodies in the first place," Nukesh added.

In January 2025, a two-bench judge was deciding a case

wherein Ramesh Baghel, son of a deceased Christian pastor from Chhattisgarh, was seeking to bury his father's body in his native village in Bastar district.

While Justice B V Nagarathna pulled up the gram panchayat authorities for denying the man a burial in the tribal-majority village, and allowed Ramesh to do so in his private agricultural land, Justice SC Sharma was of the view that the statutory rules did not permit this and said the burial should be conducted at a common designated burial ground designated for Christians of three-four villages in Karkapal. Baghel had to carry out the burial rites in Karkapal under heavy security.

"The right-wing workers are going to villages where tribes

and tribal Christians are living in peace. They provoke the tribals and get them to pass such resolutions, misusing the split verdict," said Nukesh.

"Soon after the SC's interim relief in February, we wrote to the Chhattisgarh DGP, requesting implementation of the top court order that forcible exhumation of bodies should not happen but it still takes place. We will approach the court in the matter again," said advocate Degree Prasad Chouhan, convenor of Chhattisgarh Association for Justice and Equality.

Mukund Thakur, CEO Zilla Panchayat, Sukma District, said, "It was not in the agenda. If I receive a written complaint, I will take action after checking the legality of the matter..."



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Three years later, a peace still out of reach

THE HORRIFIC terror attack on Israel by Hamas three years ago, in which almost 1,200 were killed and 251 taken hostage, set in motion a war that continues to ripple far beyond Gaza. The devastation that followed has left Israel isolated internationally, with several Western nations formally recognising the State of Palestine. Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu's decision to conduct joint military operations with the US against Iran, perceived to be weakened by internal turmoil and the decimation of its proxies, has plunged West Asia into further chaos. No lasting settlement in Gaza is possible without Israel's participation, or without Hamas giving up arms — peace still doesn't look within reach.

The situation in Gaza, where more than 70,000 people have been killed in the last three years, continues to be enormously disturbing. The humanitarian crisis remains acute, with shortages of supplies, displacement and military strikes by the Israel Defence Forces (IDF) despite the ceasefire that began almost a year ago. The much-touted peace plan of US President Donald Trump has made little progress. Only two weeks ago, the Board of Peace announced a \$2.45 billion recovery plan for the Strip — a fraction of the \$71.4 billion that the UN estimates will be required for recovery and reconstruction over the next decade. Hamas's disarmament remains an issue locked in an impasse: Israel says reconstruction cannot proceed without disarmament, while Hamas, which prolongs the stalemate and the suffering of Gazans, resists disarmament without a full Israeli withdrawal first. The first phase of the Trump plan envisaged Israel retaining control of 53 per cent of Gaza; since then, however, IDF forces have expanded their presence to two-thirds of the Strip.

The power to enforce meaningful progress lies ultimately with the White House, but the US President seems consumed by the political fallout of the war with Iran. At the same time, the once-unbreakable US-Israel alliance is fraying: Public support for Israel in America has fallen to historic lows, and the bipartisan consensus around military aid shows signs of weakening. Within Israel, the Gaza war has exposed deep divisions over the government's conduct — especially in light of revelations that Netanyahu ignored warnings from Egypt and the UAE about an impending Hamas attack — and the country's entanglement in regional conflicts, including in Lebanon and Syria. In 20 days, Israel will hold an election, giving citizens their first chance since the terror attack to pronounce a verdict on Netanyahu. The coalition that emerges after October 27 will help shape not only the future of Gaza, but also Israel's trajectory. It will indicate whether three years of militarism can give way to a path that leads away from war.

Cornell reminder on impunity, sexual violence

A WOMAN was sexually assaulted by seven men at a fraternity house in a US university which, when informed of the crime, allegedly did little to punish the perpetrators. This is the bare outline of a case that has rocked the US for over a week. The survivor filed a civil suit last month against Cornell University, the Chi Phi fraternity as well as the seven men who allegedly raped her in 2024, following which state prosecutors in New York, where the university is located, reopened a criminal inquiry into the incident.

Horrific as the assault was, what stands out in the Cornell case is that other men with knowledge of what was unfolding did nothing to inform the authorities or stop the assault; evidence from a fraternity group chat points to encouragement of the crime. Whether this range of disturbing reactions is rooted in a misplaced sense of loyalty, fear of offending one's peers or causing social discomfort or just indifference is immaterial. The larger picture they paint is one of impunity, where the cost of silence and inaction is paid, over and over, by women. This is why it is also a mistake to limit the conversation to what unfolded on one US university campus or treat it as the aberrant behaviour of a handful. That would risk underplaying the extent to which everyday sexism and gender stereotypes, normalisation of rape in the form of jokes and the sexualisation of women shape views about consent, about who deserves to be punished and who is shamed for what was done to them — across cultures and borders. Its echoes can be heard everywhere, from the cases brought to light by the global MeToo movement to the long battle of India's women wrestlers to bring a powerful man to account.

The survivor of the Cornell case had to drop out of college; the university closed the case after a half-hearted investigation. Two of her attackers were expelled while the rest were asked to write essays to "mitigate" the harm they had caused. This stark asymmetry speaks of a structural injustice where reluctance to acknowledge and confront rape emboldens would-be perpetrators and ensures that the cycle of violence continues. The conversation that has revived with Cornell must continue everywhere.

The storyteller and the twists in his tale

BRITISH WRITER Jeffrey Archer, who died at 86 on October 5, might have been the first to admit that his life was the sort of script that could have been rejected by an editor for being far too dramatic. Athlete, MP, political aspirant, bestselling novelist, convicted perjurer, comeback artiste — the arc of Archer's life showed a great talent for reinvention, a phoenix-like ability to rise from the ashes. He understood that public life, like fiction, runs on appetite — for money, power, recognition and redemption — and he had a keen instinct for all four. Even his death, arriving on the eve of the publication of *Adam & Eve*, carries the theatricality of a final twist.

Archer's literary life began after a personal setback, a financial default that had rendered him bankrupt. But *Not a Penny More*, *Not a Penny Less*, published in 1976, and followed in succession by *A Quiver Full of Arrows* (1980), *First Among Equals* (1984), and novels such as *Kane and Abel* (1979) and *Shall We Tell the President?* (1986) led to a reversal of fortunes. Despite a lukewarm reception by critics, his books sold over 300 million copies in a career spanning five decades. His appetite for drama, however, proved ruinous in politics — his ascent through Conservative ranks and his ambitions for high office ended in disgrace after a libel case, followed by his conviction for perjury and imprisonment. But prison turned into more source material, a new chapter in another new beginning that brought more bestsellers.

In an interview to fellow writer Anthony Horowitz for *The Sunday Telegraph Magazine* in 2011, Archer had said, "The people who survive are storytellers." In death as in life, Archer put the twist in the tale.

Can Election Commission untie knots of its own making? That's the question

THE ELECTION Commission of India (ECI) is in a bind like never before. That it worked hard to get here is a pity. An organisation that endeared itself by its friendly approach over the years finds itself friendless. Its only friend, the ruling party, pushes it further into a corner each time it comes to its defence.

The ECI is under attack from almost all quarters — people, civil-society organisations, retired civil servants, former judges, practising lawyers, political parties. The print media has written hard-hitting editorials against the Special Intensive Revision (SIR), and YouTubers have ready-made content as the ECI rides through this mire of its own making. The "war within" the ECI is in the public square with *The Indian Express* revealing cracks in an organisation in which confidence is crumbling. The 14 letters by the two Election Commissioners (ECs) have pushed the Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) into the eye of the storm, even if the storm might rock their boats too. Every attempt of the ECI to explain away the controversy drags it deeper into the morass.

With high courts questioning some of its decisions, serving judges exhorting against mass disenfranchisement, former ECs/CECs questioning its conduct, the clouds over the ECI become thicker. The Shakespearean platitude, "when sorrows come, they come not single spies, but in battalions", seems to be playing out, with petitions seeking the suspension of the CEC for his authoritarian ways admitted by the Supreme Court (SC).

As if this wasn't enough, hearing the petitions on October 5, the Chief Justice of

India reportedly observed, "No modified Form 6 has been approved by us." It is these modifications in Form 6 that one of the ECs termed "illegal and unauthorised" in his letter of August 14.

The ECI's responses to *The Indian Express* report added to its miseries. The first response on September 23 was "I plead not-guilty", claiming all decisions were unanimous. In its second response of September 26, the ECI climbed down but created confusion by admitting it used two versions of Form 6 for SIR and non-SIR purposes, asserting that the SC had "upheld" the changes. Soon, the ECI wilted and withdrew the declaration attached to Form 6 as if it was hiding the weapon used in the crime.

The CJT's remark has fuelled the fire, with critics calling it a vindication of their allegations of arbitrary, illegal action of the CEC. However, supporters quickly found a shield in paragraph 152 of the SC's May 27 judgement wherein it observed that Form 6 "sets out a framework of documentation; however, the same is tailored to the process of revision contemplated under Section 21(2) of the RP Act and may not, in all situations, be capable of literal application to an exercise of the present nature. The Commission, therefore, retains a degree of residual authority to formulate an appropriate documentation framework suited to the exigencies of a Special Intensive Revision. Such authority, however, is not unbounded. In devising such a framework, the Commission must remain cognisant of the existing statutory scheme, and any depart-



ASHOK LAVASA

With high courts questioning some of its decisions, serving judges exhorting against mass disenfranchisement, former ECs/CECs questioning its conduct, the clouds over the ECI become thicker

In Bihar, an experiment that bets on the young



SYED ATA HASNAIN

BIHAR IS India's youngest state, with a median age of approximately 26. That fact is usually invoked in discussions about employment, migration and the demographic dividend. Yet, before any of these comes education. Unless Bihar's young people can access credible colleges, complete their courses on time and acquire useful knowledge and skills, youthfulness alone will confer little advantage.

This is why an unusual experiment now unfolding deserves wider attention. The direction is significant: Expand access rapidly, recruit teachers transparently, improve university leadership and use technology to make a fragmented system more visible and accountable.

The most visible step has been the opening of 211 government degree colleges, largely in areas without convenient access to higher education. Distance is not a minor issue. For a rural family, particularly one educating a daughter, a nearby college can determine whether education leads to a degree or ends after Class XII. These colleges are still young. Many have begun with a few rooms, small faculties, limited support staff and enrolments below their eventual capacity. They cannot yet be judged as finished institutions. They are foundations upon which institutions must now be built.

To give them an academic core, Bihar appointed 2,451 contractual assistant professors. The recruitment, drawn from more than 23,000 applications, was completed in about 30 days through a centralised process. Speed attracted attention, but transparency matters even more. Public confidence begins when a qualified applicant believes that merit, rather than influence, will determine selection. The newly appointed teachers are joining colleges without established systems and traditions. Their initiative over the next two years will determine whether these colleges acquire academic energy or remain administrative units with classrooms.

Reform at the college level cannot succeed if universities remain weakly led. Bihar is also revisiting how vice-chancellors and pro-vice-chancellors are selected. Nearly 8,000 applications were received for 10 V-C positions through an online process. Numbers alone cannot guarantee good appointments. Careful scrutiny, credible search committees and matching of individual capabilities with institutional needs are essential. Yet widening the field is itself a reform.

Technology is providing the connective tissue for this effort. Samarth, the e-govern-

ance platform developed under the Ministry of Education, is being energised across Bihar's higher-education system. For students, a common digital window improves awareness of institutions, courses, admissions and opportunities that were once confined to notices on distant campuses. For administrators, its modules can connect admissions, registration, examinations, results, employee records and finance. For those responsible for oversight, it can reveal where a process has stalled.

The introduction of a uniform academic calendar across state universities follows the same logic. A calendar has value only when classes, examinations and results occur when promised. For students, a delayed result can mean losing a job, scholarship or admission elsewhere. Timeliness is, therefore, an element of educational justice.

The reforms will ultimately be tested inside classrooms. New colleges must attract students, particularly women and first-generation learners. Teachers must teach regularly and create cultures of reading, writing, discussion and mentoring. Libraries and laboratories must grow. Curricula must connect knowledge with employability without reducing education to vocational training alone. Buildings, portals and appointments create capacity; they do not automatically create quality. That requires faculty development, fair assessment, research support, institutional autonomy accompanied by accountability, and academic leaders willing to take difficult decisions.

Bihar also has Nalanda University. Although outside the state-university system, it provides an important beacon. Its evolving "Nalanda Approach" — connecting civilisational knowledge with contemporary challenges — can encourage Bihar's universities to be locally rooted, nationally relevant and globally engaged.

India's demographic future will be decided not only in metropolitan universities but also in public colleges serving small towns and rural districts. The present effort is the construction of an ecosystem in which access, teachers, leadership, technology and academic discipline reinforce one another. Bihar has begun assembling these parts at unusual speed and scale. The challenge is to turn momentum into institutional habit. A Viksit Bharat will require a Viksit Bihar, and that journey must begin by equipping its young people with credible, accessible and high-quality higher education.

The present effort is the construction of an ecosystem in which access, teachers, leadership, technology and academic discipline reinforce one another. Bihar has begun assembling these parts at unusual speed and scale

Jeffrey Archer and a quiver full of memories



SHALINI LANGER

BEFORE HOLLYWOOD came to our neighbourhoods, before Santa Barbara flummoxed our crammed living rooms, there was Jeffrey Archer. Accessible and dependable, churning out thrillers in book after book, putting us right there next to people in positions of power beyond our budding teenage comprehension. White House to Westminster, FBI to Mossad, within our reach, occupying pride of place on the mats of enthusiastic sellers of pirated books in Connaught Place's colonnaded, post-imperialist corridors (an irony to please any writer's heart); held aloft by indefatigable hawkers at traffic lights; or jostling for space with *Manohar Kahanian* and *Reader's Digest* at railway platform bookstalls.

Pop-up libraries, functioning from crummy, dimly lit garages in DDA colonies, stocked them, friends swapped them, and we of the '80s generation got a new vocabulary that didn't seem handed or drummed down, even as parents beamed in approval at "our love for reading English". This was unlike other parent-approved reading material — a big bulk of it Soviet-discounted literature — that one way or the other turned out to be a lesson in abstinence or discipline or "being better". Archer's characters had ambition, greed, villainy, rivalries, deviousness, and love for the good life, with his stories often ending on a satisfying twist. His women could be politicians and, yes, even the US President, run corporations and rock families, with Archer attributing it to the strong women in his own life. One of them was the late British prime minister Margaret Thatcher, who was behind Archer's own short-lived political career.

It worked, earning Archer 14 years and five months on Britain's *Sunday Times* bestseller lists, over five years on *The New York Times* bestseller lists, and sales of 300 million books worldwide.

When Archer served time for perjury, for lying in a libel case against a tabloid that said he had paid a woman for sex — years after the event — it seemed just the kind of scandal that would animate one of his novels. Unsurprisingly, wife Mary Archer, a scientist, earned herself some unforgettable lines too, with the judge remarking after her testimony: "Has she elegance? Has she fragrance? Would she have, without the strain of this trial, radiance?"

Archer probably would have kept it simpler, not sound as laboured as a judge in a wig. And yet for us non-native-English speakers, he was our introduction to terms such as *First Among Equals*, *Honour Among Thieves*, and a personal favourite, *A Quiver Full of Arrows*. It was a cosy, warm summer when we waited for that one, the "quiver" holding a promise as much in its title as how our lips and teeth met over the word. And has there ever been a title that sounded as intimate and as ambitious as *Shall We Tell the President?*

Archer reaffirmed his position as the author whose books we took into beds, and raced through over one night, with his professed love for India. He often came to the country, had friends here, and released books in India before they premiered abroad. One reason for this was to beat the book pirates. But would he have minded the boy hawker peddling "the latest Jeffrey Archer", while balancing countless other knockoffs, tapping on his car window at a traffic light? It would be a twist he would enjoy. As much as the fact that death came to him a day before the release of what would be his final book. Its title? *Adam & Eve*.

Archer's characters had ambition, greed, villainy, rivalries, deviousness, and love for the good life, with his stories often ending on a satisfying twist

PM optimistic on Punjab

PUNJAB IS much better today than it has been for a long time, according to Prime Minister Rajiv Gandhi. He said that in spite of the attempt on his life and on that of J F Ribeiro, the level of terrorism in that state had never been so low before. The terrorists, he said, had resorted to these attacks in an effort to salvage their image.

Security lapses reviewed

THE CHALLENGE posed by terrorists and the

lapses in the security arrangements for top political leaders and senior officials in sensitive posts were reviewed at the highest level. Prime Minister Rajiv Gandhi, first discussed the issue with Home Minister Buta Singh and senior officials, and later at the meeting of the Political Affairs Committee of the cabinet.

Medal lost after doping caught

INDIAN HEAVYWEIGHT boxer Daljit Singh has been deprived of his silver medal after the lone doping incident of the Asian Games, officials said in Seoul. Dope tests showed he had

used an illegal stimulant, they said. The silver medal was awarded to Pakistan's Kausar Abbas, defeated in the semifinals by Singh.

India, Jordan on Iran-Iraq war

INDIA AND Jordan expressed concern and regret over the continuing Iran-Iraq war and emphasised the need to bring about an immediate end to it. President Zail Singh, Jordanian King Hussein, and Queen Noor al-Hussein reaffirmed their country's support for the struggle of the Palestinian people led by the Palestinian Liberation Organisation.



40 YEARS AGO
October 7, 1986

The writer is Governor of Bihar

The writer is editor (planning and projects), The Indian Express. shalini.langer@expressindia.com



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A war in Iran, an election in America, and the blurred lines between politics & conflict



RAJA MANDALA
BY C RAJA MOHAN

IRAN'S REVOLUTIONARY Guards have found a new audience for their war with Donald Trump: The American voter. The history of warfare tells us that weakening the adversary's domestic support can be as important as defeating its armed forces on the battlefield. In a 25-page letter last week, the Guards appealed to the "honourable people" of the United States to reject Trump's policies and consider "peaceful coexistence" with Iran. Trump, in turn, hopes that escalating military and economic pressure will force the Islamic Republic to fall in line.

Coming just weeks before the midterm elections, the letter brings Tehran directly into America's domestic political contest. With Republicans vulnerable in November, the political consequences of the Iran war are becoming harder to separate from its military course. In Tehran, too, internal struggles between advocates of negotiation and hardliners favouring confrontation are shaping the war's conduct. That brings us to the idea of the "October surprise" in American politics — a major event or political move that changes the national mood before the traditional voting in the first week of November.

Iran helped make the phrase part of American political language during the 1980 presidential election. The Iranian Revolution of February 1979 overthrew the Shah, a close American ally. In November, militants seized the US embassy in Tehran and took its staff hostage. The crisis haunted President Jimmy Carter's re-election campaign. His Republican challenger, Ronald Reagan, feared that freeing the hostages before November would rescue Carter's political fortunes. Allegations that Reagan's team secretly worked to delay the release remain disputed. The hostages came home as Reagan took office in January 1981. Iran's up-

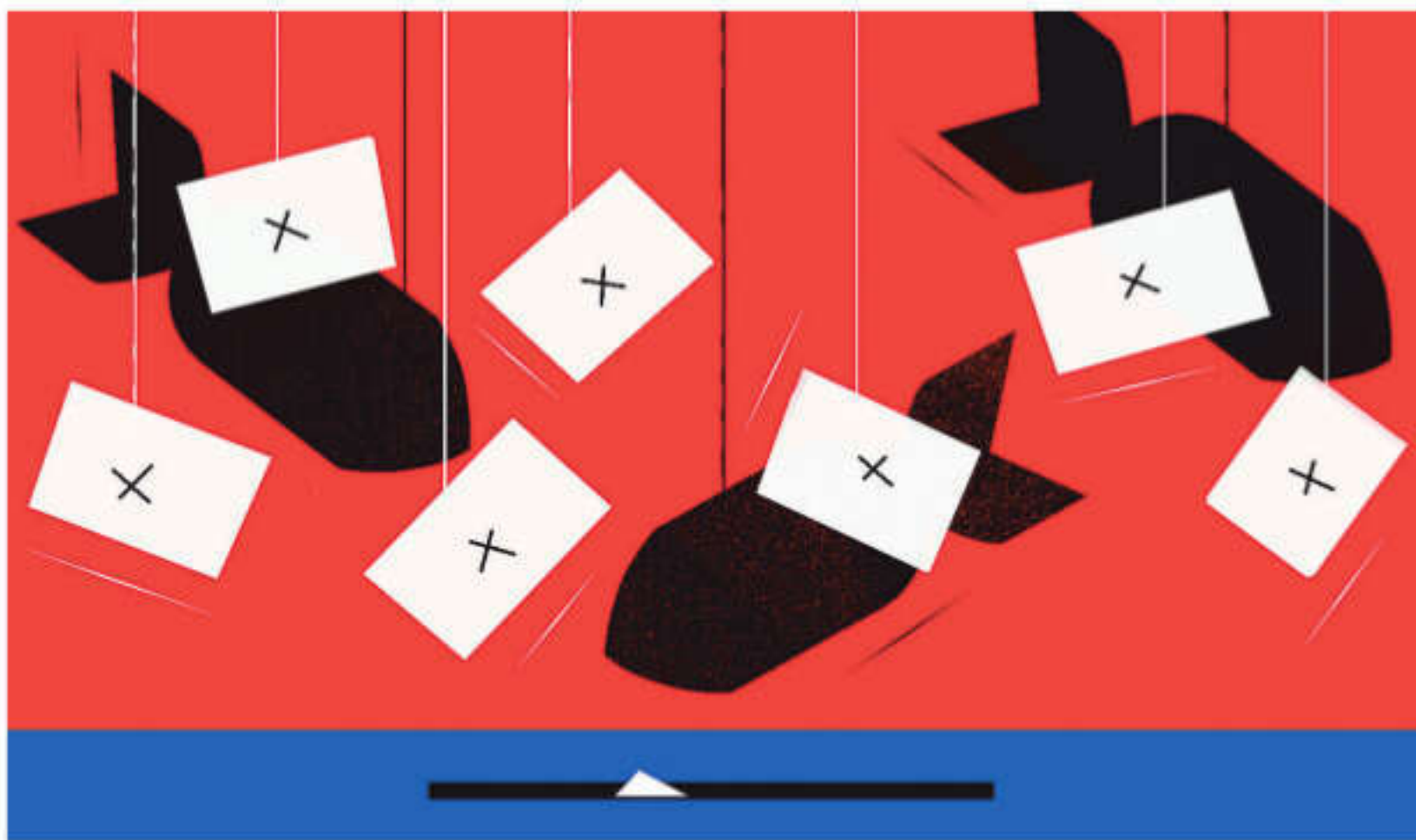


ILLUSTRATION: C R SASIKUMAR

heaval had become entangled with the struggle for power in Washington.

Today, Tehran hopes to exploit another American electoral moment. Trump insists the midterms do not determine his Iran policy. But the electoral calendar is now visibly intertwined with the military debate. In an interview last week, Trump said it was "possible" that US bombing of Iran could intensify after the November 3 elections. He has also said the war could be won "right after the election" — or perhaps before it. The military preparations reinforce the message. The unfolding deployment gives Trump more options if diplomacy fails — and gives Tehran reason to take his threats seriously.

Setting aside the Islamic Revolution's enduring slogan, "Death to America", the IRGC letter claims to have no quarrel with ordinary Americans. Its immediate target is Trump. It hopes public anxiety over the war and rising prices will weaken Republicans and create space for a more accommodating policy in Washington. The appeal could easily backfire as Republicans accuse Democrats of serving Tehran's interests.

Iran is not alone in trying to exploit domestic divisions. Trump

has hoped that military and economic pressure would encourage Iranians to challenge their rulers. That expectation has produced little so far. Tehran's appeal to American voters may prove equally ineffective. Both sides nevertheless see the adversary's home front as a battlefield.

Meanwhile, Trump has secured an important gain at Hormuz. The recovery in Gulf oil flows has accelerated. New data show Gulf crude exports averaged about 16.3 million barrels a day in September — roughly 91 per cent of pre-war levels.

This does not establish Trump's claim of "total control". Iran never enjoyed uncontested sovereignty over the international waterway. Its leverage lay in making passage dangerous and expensive. Tanker attacks, higher insurance costs and uncertainty forced its adversaries to spend heavily on keeping commerce moving. Nor has the energy crisis disappeared. The problem has shifted from crude supply towards logistics and refining. Refined-product exports from the Gulf recovered to only about 60 per cent of pre-war levels in September.

That distinction matters politically. More crude moving through

Hormuz does not automatically mean cheaper diesel at American pumps. Crude must be transported, refined and distributed. Diesel prices have a direct effect on inflation and cost of living, a major issue in US domestic politics right now.

The G7's decision, under Trump's pressure, to release 100 million barrels of crude and fuel products from emergency reserves is meant to ease this pressure. But Trump's dilemma remains. Convincing Tehran that it cannot wait him out requires a credible threat of escalation. Reassuring American voters requires avoiding an escalation that sends fuel prices soaring again. Iran's letter seeks to exploit precisely that tension.

Tehran faces pressures of its own. Washington's "Operation Economic Outcast" is tightening the financial noose. The US has expanded sanctions from military procurement networks to Iran's automotive, rail, manufacturing and steel sectors. Washington has now warned foreign financial institutions that doing business with Iran could bring sanctions without prior notice.

Neither side can assume the other will crack first. The October surprise could be another military blow, a diplomatic opening, or another fuel-price shock.

For India, there is a larger lesson from the US and Iranian efforts to influence each other's domestic politics. America's hopes of political change in Iran and Tehran's appeal to American voters underline an old truth: Wars are fought within societies as much as between states. Managing the home front can matter as much as gaining military ground on the battlefield.

The principle applies in peacetime too, especially to democracies such as India. Effective engagement with a turbulent world demands cohesion at home. Political differences are inevitable in a democracy. But a politics of "winner takes all" can turn those differences into debilitating domestic conflicts. That inevitably weakens the nation's capacity to deal with mounting challenges abroad and the growing prospects for external meddling in its domestic affairs.

The writer is contributing editor on international affairs for The Indian Express. He is professor and director at the Motwani Jodeja Institute of American Studies, Jindal Global University, Delhi

The journey from 'chalta hai' to 'badal sakta hai'



M VENKAIAH NAIDU

PRIME MINISTER Narendra Modi belongs to a rare breed of people who refuse to accept inherited challenges. He believes, and his actions show, that no problem in public life is too difficult to solve. I distinctly remember an Independence Day address in which he said that India must move away from the "chalta hai" attitude towards a "badal sakta hai" attitude.

I have known him first as a colleague in the party and later in the government. For those of us who worked in the BJP for decades, Article 370 and Ram Janmabhoomi were matters of profound conviction, for which we made sacrifices. But I would be honest to admit that there were moments when even some of our own *karyakartas* doubted whether they would see these issues resolved in their lifetime. Article 370, described in the Constitution as a temporary provision, had come to be seen as virtually impossible to abrogate. I had the privilege of presiding over the Rajya Sabha when the historic legislation relating to its abrogation was passed. The Ram Janmabhoomi journey was much longer. Generations had lived with the hope that one day a grand temple would stand at the birthplace of Prabhu Shri Ram. On January 22, 2024, that hope became a reality.

Modi became Gujarat Chief Minister a few months after the state had been hit by a terrible earthquake. Kutch, already a region beset by great difficulties, had suffered severe losses. Modi understood that the first task was to restore confidence. He spent his first Diwali as CM with the area's earthquake-affected families. Over the years, his policies helped Kutch reinvent itself, and it came to be known for its tourism potential, industrial growth and agricultural achievements.

Water presented another seemingly permanent challenge to Gujarat. The Sardar Sarovar Project, conceived decades earlier, was mired in complications. Modi pursued it and saw to it that the dam reached completion and Narmada water travelled to water-scarce parts of Gujarat. Other, smaller structures, including check dams, made water conservation a mass movement and helped Gujarat's farmers achieve remarkable results.

Modi became PM at a time when India had been labelled one of the "Fragile Five" economies and its banking system was burdened with serious problems. He initiated a process of resolving these challenges through measures including the Asset Quality Review, banking reforms and the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code. India went on to become the fastest-growing major economy in the world. Many believed that the political consensus required for the GST would prove elusive. Yet it



became possible because Modi was willing to invest political capital and see the reform through.

Today, India is a leader in digital payments. Technology was not a challenge. The seemingly impossible task was to persuade crores across cities, villages, generations and income groups to change a deeply ingrained habit. Experienced political leaders asked how a street vendor could be brought into a digital payments ecosystem. PM Modi made that transformation possible.

Poverty was another problem India had come to accept as permanent. Today, 25 crore Indians have moved out of multidimensional poverty. This happened through the painstaking work of creating a broad safety net and then giving the poor the means — bank accounts, direct benefit transfers, housing, sanitation, electricity, cooking gas, food security, health insurance and economic opportunities — to move out of poverty.

For decades, Naxalism cost our nation thousands of lives. Through a twin approach of security and development, it has now been brought to an end. It is not that every problem has disappeared. But Modi has ensured that the assumption of helplessness in the face of problems has disappeared. During the pandemic, he brought the nation together. The Indian economy bounced back faster than many other major nations.

The West Asia crisis brought another set of challenges involving energy security, shipping and trade. India's approach, involving government and society, has been mature and responsible.

The BJP was once branded as a party restricted to certain areas and social constituencies. PM Modi worked assiduously to change this perception. The BJP's growth in the Northeast and East India, and its deepening support among poor, rural and marginalised sections, have changed the country's political map. For those who have watched his journey closely, it is clear that Narendra Modi begins by asking what the nation needs, and then works to create the circumstances to deliver it. This mindset is extremely important for a country that wants to become Viksit Bharat by 2047.

The writer is former vice president of India

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

SC must act

SUPREME COURT Judge Justice Ujjal Bhuyan observed that wholesale disenfranchisement would be inconsistent with Articles 14 and 326 of the Constitution ("The knock on the Supreme Court's door", *IE*, October 6). If genuine voters are removed without adequate notice, verification and an effective appeal mechanism, the credibility of democracy itself is endangered. The Supreme Court must act expeditiously to safeguard electoral integrity and ensure every eligible citizen can exercise the franchise freely. Moreover, it is the duty of the apex court to conduct a thorough enquiry into the Election Commission of India, led by Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar.

Tharcius S Fernando, Chennai

Delhi's mediation

INDIA'S EFFORT to engage with both sides of the conflict is a constructive diplomatic approach ("From calling for peace in Russia-Ukraine and beyond, Delhi is now working for it", *IE*, October 6). India should continue using its relations with different countries to encourage practical steps towards peace. Its credibility will be strengthened if it remains consistent, balanced and focused on dialogue rather than taking partisan positions.

Abbharna Barathi, Chennai

Migration paradox

GERMANY'S NEED for skilled workers and its political debate over migration present a difficult balancing act ("In Germany, Indian migrant is caught between politics, policy", *IE*, October 6). Indian professionals contribute significantly to advanced sectors and should be judged primarily on their skills and qualifications. At the same time, immigration policies cannot ignore legitimate public concerns about integration and employment. Germany could adopt transparent, predictable rules for skilled migrants while strengthening language and integration support.

S P Suganya Devi, Coimbatore



NALINI SORESENSEN

AS DETAILS surfaced about the reopening of the alleged 2024 gang-rape case at Cornell University, I felt physically ill. I read every horrific detail, and then my thoughts turned to my sons.

I have two sons, aged 18 and 21, both studying at universities in America, including an Ivy League one. That made this feel very real for me. I share a close relationship with both of them, and over the years, we have spoken openly and honestly about pretty much everything — relationships, sex, consent, equality, LGBTQ issues, alcohol, drugs, cigarettes and vaping — but I had never asked them what they would do if another man crossed the line. What is "enough" in this world where the rules change daily? Is a mother's work ever truly done with her children? I wondered if I'd done enough.

Here I was, thousands of miles away in Mumbai, my head swirling with thoughts, while both my sons were living in university dorms where frat parties happen regularly. There was something I needed to ask my sons. I called my older son first. He didn't pick up. My younger one didn't answer my call either.

So, I did the next best thing. I sent each of them a text message: "This Cornell incident has made me feel sick to my stomach, and it has made me ponder. We have never had this kind of a talk, and

Both touched on the fact that the other boys on the chat might not have thought this was really happening. That they might have regarded it as someone typing nonsense while high or drunk, or both. It gave all three of us some pause

so I have to ask... if you were in a text thread with 50 other young men, and they sent violent and explicit messages about a passed-out young woman, what would you do? Because, to me, it's not just about those seven boys. It's also very much about the 50 others who were on that chat. That's what I was calling about."

Both my sons called me back. The conversations went very differently, but on reflection, very similarly. I told each of them that it was the silence of those other boys that bothered me. Only a thin line separates silence from complicity. I asked questions: When is it okay to keep quiet? When must you call for help? When do you take yourself out of a setting? What kind of situations demand what kind of action? Is consent from someone drunk or high valid?

It was interesting to hear their responses and see the difference in their personalities coming through. My younger son was outraged. He could not believe I thought he would keep quiet. It upset him that I had to even ask him what he'd do; that I didn't just know. Young, brash, fiery, principled.

My older son was fuming over what he had read about the case. He wanted consequences that fit the allegations. He hated that Jane Doe had to go through this, that she had had to keep living with it. He wanted justice for her. And yes, he sure as hell wouldn't

look the other way. Compassionate, just, action-driven.

Both touched on the fact that the other boys on the chat might not have thought this was really happening. That they might have regarded it as someone typing nonsense while high or drunk, or both. It gave all three of us some pause and led us to discuss which messages we should question, particularly when someone's safety is at stake. Who should we believe? Who should we give the benefit of doubt to? The language we use and the language we overlook. They weren't easy conversations to have, but I definitely slept better that night.

The truth is, as parents, we are never really done. Our children may grow up and leave home, but the conversations don't have to end. We have to keep asking the difficult, uncomfortable questions. We have to keep reminding our sons that masculinity doesn't require hardness. We have to keep teaching them not just how to avoid doing the wrong thing, but how to recognise when something is wrong, and find the courage to do something about it.

We keep hoping that we have raised boys who will know when to speak up, when to step in, when to ask for help, and when to understand that silence is a choice too.

We owe that to our sons. And we owe it to every girl in the world.

Sorensen is a Mumbai-based children's author

After Cornell, I spoke to my sons of silence, complicity

Higher yields in US test India's macro resilience



SRIRAM BALASUBRAMANIAN AND PRAKASH LOUNGANI

THE DEVELOPMENTS dominating global markets are the 10-year US treasury yields rising above 5 per cent and the US Federal Reserve's rate hike cycle to contain inflation. These matter for India, shaping challenges and policy choices.

First, the 10-year treasury yield has risen to its highest level since 2007. The immediate impact is a narrowing of the India-US yield spread to around 200 basis points, limiting the scope for further inflows compared with periods when spreads were wider. Higher yields also raise fiscal risks by increasing borrowing costs, especially for

long-tenor issuances that lock in elevated costs for decades. Over the longer term, they point both to concerns about US fiscal and debt sustainability and to uncertainty around the AI infrastructure boom. They may also signal a broader "higher for longer" environment, closer to the pre-2000s market setting. India will therefore need to navigate these cross-currents carefully.

On the issue of the Fed's rate hikes, the question now is: How long will this cycle last? Since inflation in the US is closer to the 2 per cent target than in the previous cycle, this one may be shorter. Even so, short-end rates are likely to stay elevated, reinforcing yield pressures through spreads, currency, and liquidity. But, India's economy is much more resilient than in earlier episodes of high yields and rising rates in the US. The 10-year sensitivity has fallen sharply from 1.25 in 2013

to 0.43 in 2026. This points to an economy more resilient to external volatility. What explains this, and why does it matter?

Several factors explain this resilience. India's macro fundamentals are perhaps at their strongest in decades. The fiscal deficit is on a glide path toward 4 per cent, inflation is within the target band, the current account is stable, and reserves remain ample especially after the FCNR (B) scheme. Retail participation has risen sharply, while domestic institutional investors have overtaken foreign institutional investors in

Considering the high yields, the possibility of an AI bubble bursting is a distinct possibility, and therefore an important risk

ownership, deepening India's domestic capital base and therefore reducing the impact on capital flow volatility. There is palpable dynamism in the economy that has been the largest contributor to global growth in the last few years. These strengths provide comfort, though important concerns remain.

First, considering the high yields, the possibility of an AI bubble bursting is a distinct possibility, and therefore an important risk. India's exposure should be analysed carefully. Second, the US-Iran geopolitical conflict remains a major constraint for India, especially with respect to the price of oil and a variety of other goods imported from the Middle East. Each spike in Brent crude oil prices raises imported inflation, weakens the Indian rupee, and pushes yields higher. With the US Fed hiking, India has little room to absorb that pressure. Re-

lief can also come quickly, as when Brent fell to about \$98 per barrel and the 10-year bond yield eased toward 7 per cent. But even then, Fed tightening could keep a floor under yields. Third, state financing through the bond market needs to be monitored carefully, especially given that many of them tend to borrow in the later part of the year. State borrowing costs have risen with recent SDL auctions clearing between roughly 7.3 per cent and 7.9 per cent.

These risks need to be carefully monitored. But with strong macroeconomic fundamentals, India does have the capacity to withstand changes in the global environment, if it plays its cards well.

Balasubramanian is an economist and Loungani is director of the Applied Economics Programme at Johns Hopkins. Views are personal

ED arrests suspended KPSC chief Sahukar over job exam racket

Johnson T A
Bengaluru, October 6

THE ENFORCEMENT Directorate on Tuesday arrested suspended chairman of Karnataka Public Service Commission (KPSC) Shivashankarappa S Sahukar and a member of the Commission, B V Geetha, in connection with its money laundering probe into the recruitment of veterinary officers through KPSC.

The arrests came in the wake of a fresh round of searches on Tuesday at a flat where Sahukar lived in Bengaluru, and statements given to the ED in recent weeks by arrested IAS officer Gyanendra Kumar Gangwar and a middleman, Basavaraj Kannale, about corruption at the KPSC.

A Bengaluru Zone official of the ED confirmed the arrest of Sahukar and Geetha on Tuesday. "Their custody will be sought after production before a special judge," the official said.

The Karnataka HC and a special court for CID cases had earlier rejected anticipatory bail pleas of the suspended KPSC chairman while pointing out that he was the custodian of the KPSC and hence responsible for all illegal activities that occurred under his watch.

Sahukar was suspended by Karnataka Governor Thaaavar Chand Gehlot on August 25 over "illegal" recruitment of his daughter to a state government job through KPSC. He was being investigated by the Karnataka Police in connection with multiple complaints of fraud in KPSC recruitment, but had not been arrested by the state police so far. Sahukar has been accused in two specific cases of fraud: the KPSC recruitment of veterinary officers for 400 vacancies in the state and the recruitment of his daughter as an industrial officer on the basis of a fake income certificate.

Sahukar and KPSC were at the centre of a series of investi-



KPSC chief Shivashankarappa S Sahukar

gative reports by The Indian Express on the recruitment scam during the tenure of Sahukar, who was picked by the BJP for the KPSC chairman post in 2019 and retained by the Congress, which came to power in Karnataka in 2023. The ED's arrest of Sahukar and B V Geetha comes following statements by Gangwar on KPSC officials using preliminary selection lists to extort aspirants during multiple job recruitments done by the Commission in the last two years.

Arrested middleman Basavaraj Kannale also claimed to have given crores of Rupees to KPSC officials after collecting bribes from candidates for various job recruitments, said sources. According to the sources, Gangwar told the ED during questioning that when the 1:3 merit list for the veterinary doctors recruitment was published on February 4, 2026, KPSC officials, including Sahukar, Geetha, Shanta Hosmani, Elfreda D Silva, among others, approached him with candidate names to seek information about their prospects, and he divulged the information.

"Once the merit of a candidate was known, the concerned member, official or middleman contacted the candidate and negotiated the bribe amount; the higher the candidate's chance of selection, the higher the amount demanded," the ED informed a special court last week.

Flat bought in name of arrested IAS officer's family under ED lens

Express News Service
Bengaluru, October 6

AN APARTMENT purchased in the name of family members of arrested IAS officer Gyanendra Kumar Gangwar near Bengaluru airport has come under the scrutiny of the ED, which is probing KPSC recruitment scam.

Gangwar, 41, who served as KPSC's controller of examinations from January 2024 to March 2026, has been suspended by the Karnataka government. He is alleged to have leaked the questions of the KPSC entrance exam for veterinary officers to around 20 candidates who paid Rs 20 lakh to Rs 40 lakh through an arrested middleman, Basavaraj Kannale. During the investigation by the CID unit of the Karnataka police and the ED, Kannale, 36, allegedly revealed that Gangwar received around Rs 1.30 crore of Rs 1.52 crore taken from candidates as bribes, said sources.

While the investigations have tracked Rs 52 lakh in "bribes" being funneled back to Gangwar through bank accounts of associates of the middleman, for purchase of expensive jewellery from Bhima Jewellery showroom in Bengaluru, the remaining amount is still untraced, said the sources.

The CID and the ED have indicated that some of the proceeds of the crime were used for the purchase of an apartment in the name of the officer's brother at Godrej Royal Woods complex in Devanahalli. "The (IAS officer's) brother and family are unaware of the flat purchased in their name. They never visited the property. It was used by the officer for parties and other activities," said a police source.

'India said right things for years... not necessarily lent its weight... It's finally walking the talk'

Shubhajit Roy
New Delhi, October 6

BENEDIKT FRANKE, Vice-Chairman and CEO of the Munich Security Conference (MSC), says he is "absolutely thrilled" that India is ready to put its diplomatic weight and relationship into efforts to bring the Russia-Ukraine war to an end. Excerpts from an expansive interview with Franke, who is in Delhi for the Munich leaders' meeting (a chapter of the MSF held in different locations every year):

India has moved a proposal to end the war in Ukraine, going beyond advocating for dialogue and diplomacy. How do you see this?

I'm absolutely thrilled that India is finally walking the talk. Prime Minister Modi has said the right things for a while on this issue, that there is a need for dialogue, for negotiations... However, India didn't vote accordingly in the UN... Now, not just the Ukrainian foreign minister but also President Putin (have) has said that the proposals received from the Indian side were the only ones he was seriously considering... I hope more countries take note of this development...

We (Europe) believe that our best hope lies with countries like India and China that have a special relationship with Russia... These countries are now finally ready to (use) their diplomatic weight and their relationship to support efforts to



BENEDIKT FRANKE
VICE-CHAIRMAN AND CEO OF THE MSC

bring this war to an end... We hope it doesn't lead to a situation in which the aggressor (Russia) is rewarded and the victim (Ukraine) is punished... I just hope India sort of doubles down on these very promising signs.

Why do you think the needle has moved for India?

The Ukraine-Russia war comes at a cost for everyone. Countries like India need stability in global trade and relations... India needs to continue on its growth trajectory, to pull millions out of poverty... Another (reason) is that multi-alignment is great on paper. It also comes to a natural limit at some point. Civilians are dying every day in Ukraine... How can you be a liberal democracy, position yourself as a leader in this world on inter-State cooperation, development, and not act on breaches of international law? And then, India is becoming more ambi-

tious in a lot of fields, putting stuff in space... But, on the diplomatic front, I don't think India's actions to date matched its self-perception.

Crises in Europe and the West say India is still buying Russian energy. India argues that it is acting in self-interest.

It's perfectly okay to buy Russian oil and gas, but I wish that when you go into the shop to buy it, you don't kiss the shopkeeper... Why do we need selfies at the BRICS summit? Why do we need the embrace between Modi and Putin?... We just hope that this special relationship can be, in a way, used to end the stalemate we are seeing. And by putting a little pressure on its favourite shopkeeper, India could make a major difference in the war.

What do you make of US President Donald Trump's efforts for peace in the

Rajnath stresses self-reliance in aerospace sector as HAL delivers its 2,000th aero-engine

Sujit Bisoyi
Bhubaneswar, October 6

UNION DEFENCE Minister Rajnath Singh on Tuesday called for strengthening "indigenous capabilities" in the design, development, testing, manufacturing and maintenance of advanced aero-engines, stressing that mastery of propulsion technology is essential for self-reliance in the aerospace and defence sector.

Singh, who witnessed the delivery of the 2,000th aero-engine by Hindustan Aeronautics Limited (HAL), Koraput division at Sunabeda, noted that indigenisation of components and reduced turnaround time are contributing to operational readiness and extended service life of critical defence assets.

"Aerospace self-reliance must extend to indigenous aero-engine capability, particularly for the Advanced Medium Combat Aircraft (AMCA) programme. A sovereign aerospace ecosystem requires indigenous capabilities across materials, design, manufacturing, testing and Maintenance, Repair and Overhaul (MRO)," said Singh.

He also highlighted proposed investment of around Rs 5,000 crore, indigenisation of raw materials in partnership with Mishra Dhatu Nigam Limited (MIDHANI), and establishment of India's first indigenous high-thrust engine



Defence Minister Rajnath Singh and Odisha CM Mohan Charan Majhi in Koraput on Tuesday. PTI

testing facility.

Urging the HAL Koraput division to raise standards in quality, productivity, indigenisation, innovation and delivery timelines, Singh described the 2,000th engine as a significant milestone and called for using it as a foundation to build an Indian aerospace industry capable of designing, developing, manufacturing and supporting advanced propulsion systems.

Emphasising the need for reliable indigenous propulsion for India's helicopter ecosystem, the defence minister stated that forces require engines that are available when needed, supported throughout their lifecycle, and upgraded with evolving technology.

"Aero-engine development is

a long-term endeavour requiring sustained investment, specialised testing, skilled manpower and a strong industrial ecosystem, with focus on repeatable, reliable and scalable production, design, critical materials and superalloys," he added.

Singh, on the occasion, hailed HAL's contribution to military aviation, noting that its engines have powered frontline aircraft, including the MiG-21, MiG-27, MiG-29 and Su-30MKI since establishment of the unit in 1964.

The defence minister announced that HAL is enhancing annual AL-31FP engine production capacity from 30 to 50 engines annually with an investment of Rs 335 crore. He also announced a second Shakti engine production line with an investment of Rs 218 crore.

Russia-Ukraine war?

I think trying is better than not trying, and I wish there were a European-led effort, but there is not... I am not 100% sure that President Trump's efforts and the focus on or connection to business interests of the United States in Russian resources was very helpful... (But) At the end of the day, we want a stable, prosperous and constructive Russia. No one wants a tumbling giant like Russia... I could imagine that if you Indians broke the ice now, the US joining such an effort would make a huge difference.

Is it still a stalemate after four-and-a-half-years of the Ukraine war, and what does it mean for European security?

For Ukraine, to be perfectly honest, it's quite a success that they are still there. Europe has not done enough to help Ukraine win. Hence, it has not won. But we have done a lot to help them survive, get their house in order, and become a leader in defence technology...

I don't want to paint a rosy picture. The winter will be terrible... Now the question is, will Europe step up its effort? Will the US realise once again who the actual aggressor is? Will India and other powerhouses put a little pressure on Putin? I have no answer.

How do you see the energy security issue playing out given the war in West Asia, on top of the Russia-Ukraine conflict?

I am quite pessimistic that without a larger alliance of countries working, this conflict will be solved any time soon. I do not believe in some American predictions. I do not believe in the miraculous disappearance of the Houthis. I do not believe in a sudden end to Iranian ambitions... I wish for a stronger European role, a stronger American role, and a stronger Asian role in finding a diplomatic solution...

(The Iran conflict) is also driving up prices in Germany at a time when our domestic politics, our industry are in a difficult place. That increases the chances of the right or the left fringes of the political spectrum to win.

You have been coming to India for at least a decade now. How do you see India's perception about itself, and its perception from where you sit in Germany?

I love coming to this country because the feeling of dynamism, of optimism, is just infectious and great... Indian interlocutors have become more confident. They see their economic growth rate. They see the many Indian success stories... (But) With super-power status come responsibilities. At some point, multi-alignment will come to a natural limit. You will have to choose sides on certain issues... India has said the right things for many years. It hasn't necessarily put its full weight behind these statements.

Over 50 jump into river amid crackdown on illicit liquor in Bihar, 2 drown

Himanshu Harsh
Patna, October 6

IT WAS supposed to be a massive crackdown on alleged illicit liquor trade, coming two days after a police party was allegedly attacked and five liquor traders were freed by local residents.

On Sunday, police came better prepared. Teams from four police stations along with armed police forces descended upon Beherawan Chakia Musahri village, looking to arrest those involved in the case.

What they didn't anticipate was this: In order to evade arrest, around 50-60 people jumped into the Punpun river. Next day, the bodies of two of them were recovered. Locals claimed some of the villagers were still missing.

The incident took place under Pipra police station in Patna district. In a video statement, Masaurhi Sub-divisional police officer-1 (SDPO-01) Raghav Dayal said that on October 1, five alleged liquor traders were freed after a police team conducting an anti-liquor operation in Beherawan Chakia Musahri was attacked. "Three policemen were injured and a case was registered," he said.

According to Dayal, on Sunday, a large-scale search operation was launched during which the police team was again

attacked and several vehicles damaged.

Police said 39 accused, including women, were arrested while around 1,000 litres of illicit country-made liquor were seized, along with equipment allegedly used for liquor production. "About 61,00 litres of mahua-based fermenting mixture was destroyed, and a country-made pistol and three live cartridges were recovered from the house of one accused," Dayal claimed in the video.

For their part, local residents alleged that the police operation triggered panic in the village due to which 50-60 people jumped into the Punpun river while attempting to evade the police.

They alleged that stones and bricks were thrown during the confrontation and that police also hurled stones towards people in the river, making it difficult for some of them to reach the opposite bank. Residents alleged police entered homes and took away belongings.

Repeated calls and messages to SDPO Dayal and Patna SSP Kartikeya K Sharma, seeking their response to the allegations, went unanswered.

The two deceased were identified by local residents as Akash Manjhi, around 25, from Dhibra in Phulwari Sharif, and Ram Manjhi, around 60.

DNA test rules out accused as father, MP HC orders probe into minor's sexual assault

Express News Service
Bhopal, October 6

THE CASE of alleged sexual assault on a 16-year-old girl at Bageshwar Dham in Madhya Pradesh has taken a turn after a forensic examination established the man accused of raping her was not the biological father of the foetus she was carrying.

The MP High Court has now directed the Chhatarpur Superintendent of Police to constitute a special team and conduct a fresh investigation into the case.

However, the court did not treat the forensic finding as sufficient ground to grant bail to the accused. It noted that the girl was a minor and that the material before the court indicated that she had been subjected to sexual harassment.

Justice Ajay Kumar Nirankari, while dismissing the second bail application of the accused, directed the police to identify the person who allegedly sexually assaulted the

minor and establish the identity of the biological father of the foetus. The court ordered that the investigation be completed within two months and appropriate action be taken.

The case came up before the court after the minor, who was found to be around two months pregnant when she was medically examined during probe, subsequently underwent termination of pregnancy. The foetus was preserved and its samples, placenta tissue, and blood were sent to the State Forensic Science Laboratory, Sagor.

The forensic report, dated August 29, 2026, found that the accused was not the biological father of the foetus. The HC took note of the contradiction between forensic evidence and the minor's statements during trial.

While the victim had initially alleged in statements the accused had forcibly raped her at Bageshwar Dham in Chhatarpur, she later did not support the prosecution case when examined.

Plumber stabs elderly couple, house help to death in Dehradun

Press Trust of India
Dehradun, October 6

AN ELDERLY couple and their domestic help were allegedly stabbed to death with a screwdriver by their plumber who broke into their home on Tuesday afternoon here in the Raipur area of Dehradun, officials said.

Police said the accused, who had been doing plumbing work at the elderly couple's home in their Vishnulok Colony residence for the past two years, was arrested hours after the killings.

On Tuesday too, the couple had called the accused to their home for plumbing work. However, after completing the work, a dispute arose regarding payment and the plumber allegedly attacked the elderly couple and the domestic help who intervened with a screwdriver, killing all three people.

The incident came to light when the elderly couple, Ramesh (80) and Rajni Chawla (75) and their domestic help, Sheila (48), were found dead

by neighbours who informed the police at 3:10 pm.

When a police team reached the spot, they found that the man had been detained by locals and upon questioning, he allegedly confessed to attacking the three people.

Upon receiving information about the incident, Pramendra Dobhal, Senior Superintendent of Police (SSP) Dehradun, and other officials reached the spot to gather details. Forensic and field unit teams also reached to collect evidence.

"A review of CCTV footage from the crime scene and the surrounding area shows the accused approached the elderly couple's house alone around 1 pm. In initial interrogation, it has been found that the incident took place due to a dispute over payment.

"The accused initially went and then he came back with the intention of either killing them or carrying out a robbery. We have recovered a gold chain from the accused and

also a screwdriver, which was used in the incident," said Dobhal.

Police officials added that based on a formal complaint lodged by the deceased woman's family, a murder case has been registered at the Raipur Police Station, and the accused, Rajkumar, was formally arrested. A gold chain was recovered from his possession.

When the police team reached the spot on Tuesday afternoon, they found the elderly couple and the woman lying unconscious and covered in blood inside the house.

With the help of locals, the police immediately rushed them to a private hospital for treatment, where doctors declared them dead.

Uttarakhand Congress senior vice president Suryakant Dhasmana, during a media address on Tuesday, slammed the state government, saying that criminals no longer fear the police.

प्रेस विज्ञप्ति

निदेशालय, समाज कल्याण, उत्तर प्रदेश।

पत्रांक- 1242/स०क०/स्था०-4/वै०पत्रा०-552/2026-27, लखनऊ: दिनांक 21 सितम्बर, 2026

श्री शानू प्रताप सिंह, (निमित्त), ग्राम विकास अधिकारी (स०क०), कार्यालय जिला समाज कल्याण अधिकारी (विकास) गाजियाबाद।

विषय:- दिनांक 01.03.2020 से लगातार अनुपस्थित रहने के सम्बन्ध में।

आप द्वारा कार्यालय जिला समाज कल्याण अधिकारी (विकास), गाजियाबाद की तैनाती अवधि में उत्तर प्रदेश सरकारी कर्मचारी सेवक आचरण नियमावली-1956 यथा संशोधित के विरुद्ध कार्य करने, बिना पूर्व सूचना के दिनांक 01.03.2020 से निरन्तर अनाधिकृत रूप से अनुपस्थित रहने के संबंध में उत्तर प्रदेश सरकारी सेवक (अनुशासन एवं अपील) नियमावली, 1999 के अन्तर्गत निलम्बन एवं अनुशासनिक कार्यवाही संस्थित करते हुए निदेशालय आरोप पत्र संख्या-1411/स०क० / स्था०-4/2020-21, दिनांक 22.01.2021 द्वारा 02 (दो) आरोपों से आरोपित किया गया।

जांच अधिकारी द्वारा आरोप पत्र की तामील हेतु कई बार प्रयास किये जाने तथा समाचार पत्रों के माध्यम से सूचना प्रकाशित किये जाने के बावजूद आप द्वारा आरोप पत्र प्राप्त नहीं किया गया और न ही अपना पक्ष प्रस्तुत किया गया।

अतः आपको अन्तिम अवसर प्रदान करते हुए सूचित किया जाता है कि दिनांक 10.10.2026 तक निदेशालय, समाज कल्याण, उ०प्र०, लखनऊ में उपस्थित होकर आरोप पत्र एवं संबंधित अभिलेख प्राप्त कर अपना पक्ष प्रस्तुत करें।

उक्त निर्धारित अवधि में यदि आप कार्यालय में उपस्थित होकर अपना पक्ष प्रस्तुत नहीं करते हैं तो उत्तर प्रदेश सरकारी सेवक (अनुशासन एवं अपील) नियमावली, 1999 में निहित प्राविधानों के अन्तर्गत उपलब्ध अभिलेखों एवं साक्ष्यों के आधार पर दीर्घ शान्तियों के अन्तर्गत सेवा से पदच्युत किये जाने की कार्यवाही की जायेगी। जिसके लिए आप स्वयं उत्तरदायी होंगे।

(संजीव सिंह)

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Andhra govt declares drought in 21 dists; 283 mandals 'severely affected'

Sreenivas Janyala
Bengaluru, October 6

THE ANDHRA Pradesh government has declared 388 of its 688 mandals — across 21 districts — as drought affected with 283 being classified as 'severely affected' and 105 'moderately affected'. A government order was issued to this effect by the Revenue (Disaster Management) Department on October 1 for the South-West Monsoon 2026 Kharif season.

A high-level Committee on Drought, in a meeting held on September 30, recommended early declaration of drought in 21 of the state's 26 districts, instead of waiting for the October 31 deadline for declaration of the 2026 Kharif season drought. The order comes amid a sharp deficit in rainfall across the state, amplified by prevailing El Niño conditions.

"Due to a 53.4% rainfall deficit recorded during the months of June–August, 2026, and the prevailing El

Niño conditions, by taking into consideration the relevant drought indicators based on data available for the period from June to August, 2026, it is proposed to undertake an early declaration of drought for Kharif 2026. An average rainfall of 197.6 mm has been received against the normal rainfall of 424.3 mm from June 1 to August 31," the order states.

The declaration was made as per the Manual for Drought Management, 2016 issued by the Government of India. The 21 districts are Srikakulam, Vizianagaram, Visakhapatnam, Anakapalli, Kakinada, East Godavari, Eluru, Krishna, NTR district, Guntur, Bapatla, Palnadu, Prakasam, Markapuram, Kurnool, Nandyal, Anantapuramu, Sri Satya Sai, YSR Kadapa, Annamayya and Chittoor. The YSRCP slammed the government for not including Nellore district, claiming that several mandals in the district received less rainfall.

Referring to the drought-like con-

ditions in the state, Chief Minister N Chandrababu Naidu on Monday said that interlinking of Godavari and Cauvery rivers systems can make southern states drought-free. "While drought conditions prevail, 2,000 TMC of river water is flowing into the sea. If at least 200 TMC of Godavari floodwater is utilised, the Rayalaseema region will flourish with abundant greenery and crops," he said, while launching the 'Jal Jeevan Mission 2.0 — Amarajeevi Jaladhara' programmes in Proddatur in YSR Kadapa district.

Former Agriculture Minister Kurasala Kannababu and YSRCP State General Secretary Gadikota Srikanth Reddy alleged that government delayed drought declaration despite severe conditions since the first week of September. Kannababu said Rayalaseema region was bearing the brunt of the rainfall deficit with 186 of the 388 drought-declared mandals located in the region and 159 of the 283 severe-drought mandals also situated there.

epaper.indianexpress.com

New Delhi

In 2025, as weight-loss drugs entered the Indian market, clinics began launching pre-wedding packages targeted at young women hoping to rapidly shed kilos before their big day. As leading endocrinologists sound a note of caution, KAUNAIN SHERIFF M & TABSHIR SHAMS trace the journeys of some of the brides who signed up — long and difficult, one that doesn't stop at the wedding

THE 'MOUNJARO BRIDES' A YEAR LATER

DOWN A narrow lane in Lajpat Nagar, South Delhi, half hidden by low tree branches, is a small white door with silver lettering: "Weight Loss Clinic." Behind it is a basement.

A silver aluminium partition divides the space in two. On one side is a small, brightly lit waiting area. On the other is the doctor's desk. Nearby hangs a banner meant to reassure: "Obesity is a chronic disease. It has genetic, lifestyle and environmental components, and it is not a reflection of who you are."

In the waiting area is a woman with her mother, a few others sit on a bench. They have all come for weight-loss consultations, and some have a date by which to do it: an impending wedding.

The clinic is one of a growing number in South Delhi that sell weight-loss programmes built on GLP-1 drugs, a class of medications first developed for diabetes and since approved for obesity. They include semaglutide, which Novo Nordisk sells as Ozempic and Wegovy, and tirzepatide, which Eli Lilly sells as Mounjaro — drugs that entered the Indian market last year.

Since then, despite limited data on its effect on Indian patients, the drugs are among the most sought-after, by value, in India's pharmaceutical market.

There have also been reports of the drug being used for cosmetic reasons, and of clinics offering "Mounjaro bride" packages to those aiming for quick-fix weight-loss before the big day. Now, a year into that trade, there are harder questions to tackle.

Doctors have increasingly been treating obesity as a chronic disease, not something that requires a cosmetic fix. But when the GLP-1 drugs for obesity treatment, which work by altering the body's hunger signals, are used merely for cosmetic reasons, it raises a different set of questions. What happens after the immediate weight goal is reached, say, a wedding? Do the lost kilos stay away, or do appetite and weight bounce back once the three-month package runs its course?

Interviews with clinics offering weight-loss programmes on tight deadlines, leading endocrinologists, and patients who were on GLP-1 drugs ahead of their weddings shine some light on the risks that come with going down the path of quick-fix weight loss packages.

Inside a weight-loss clinic

The Lajpat Nagar clinic's offer is simple. The programme promises "Mounjaro-assisted weight reduction" in three months for Rs 30,000. The price covers consultations with the doctor, a complimentary dietitian, and the injections themselves, which patients take home the day they pay.

"You'll be added to a dietitian group," a staff member explains. "They regulate your diet, and in three months, you'll lose weight."

A senior member of the staff says, "Most of our clients come ahead of their wedding. In the last one year, we have helped close to a hundred brides reach their desired weight."

It's a tidy pitch by the clinic: three months to the wedding, three months to lose weight. Endocrinologists, however, point out that obesity keeps no such calendar.

"None of these is meant to be used for cosmetic, short-term use," says Dr Ambrish Mithal, chairman of endocrinology at Max Hospital. "The drugs are for long-term use. Most, but not all, patients require a maintenance dose to keep the weight off."

On the face of it, many clinics make the pitch sound reassuringly medical. A Hauz Khas clinic promises a supervised weight-loss programme, overseen by an "AIIMS-trained doctor". But there is a catch. The doctor is a dermatologist, not an endocrinologist. A few kilometres away, another clinic, better known for facial aesthetics, makes a similar promise: a "doctor-supervised" Mounjaro package.

Mithal says there is a reason brides are the target. "Brides are the perfect commodity for companies to sell their weight-loss drugs. A bride is the most vulnerable before their wedding, owing to the public scrutiny they go through. When an event like a marriage or a festival gets tied to the use of this drug, it trivialises the drug itself."

Deciding when a patient can safely stop the drug is a slow process, says Dr Mithal, requiring months of monitoring to determine whether weight loss has been sustained, metabolic markers have normalised and lifestyle changes are strong enough to hold without the drug.

He says that even those who start on the drugs with a wedding-date goal in mind would do well to consult an endocrinologist, someone who can monitor the patient's health not only in the run-up to the event, but beyond it.

In their desperation, not many take that route.

Losing more than just kilos

Six months ahead of her September 2025 wedding, the 23-year-old science graduate from Ludhiana decided she needed to shed some of her 108 kg.

"The push came from both social media and a cousin," says a Delhi-based endocrinologist who would eventually

treat her.

The cousin had taken a weight-loss injection before her own wedding and lost 50 kg, a transformation that was the topic of family conversations before the bride decided to try the drug herself. She found a local clinic that was willing to give her a weight-loss package.

"On her very first visit, she was handed Mounjaro in bulk, no questions asked about her medical history, no baseline tests run. She paid Rs 20,000 for a three-month course and walked out with the injections in hand," says the endocrinologist, who works at a health start-up in Delhi and agreed to speak on condition of anonymity.

The Ludhiana clinic had offered the 23-year-old no tests. There was no gradual build-up of the dose, no monitoring, no plan for her and little contact with a doctor.

"The clinic asked her to self-inject Mounjaro and kept escalating the dose until she was at 12.5 mg, close to the maximum. She lost around 20 kg in 40 days," says the doctor.

Through it all, the patient remained unaware of the other half of the treatment: diet and lifestyle changes such as exercise and strength training.

Almost two months before the wedding, she travelled to Delhi for her *lehenga* trials and jewellery appointments. But by then, the side-effects of the drug were severe enough for her to visit the endocrinologist in Delhi.

"When she visited us, she had nausea, exhaustion, hair fall, menstrual changes and mood shifts, and she had lost a massive amount of muscle mass. Acne flared up on her face," the doctor recalls. "During the consultation she looked anxious, jittery."

He says his first concern was not how much weight she had lost.

"We wanted to understand what was happening to her body during the process. Was she eating enough? Was she getting adequate protein? Was she losing muscle along with fat? How was her digestion and energy?" the doctor says. "The bigger conversation was about ensuring that weight loss was not coming at the cost of her metabolic and nutritional health."

A full workup followed, and it found more than a lighter body.

"When we ran a full root-cause analysis, we found her hormones to be completely off, her periods were irregular, she had abnormalities in her metabolism, her thyroid was abnormal. And with all this, she was on unsupervised Mounjaro," says the doctor.

The drug had done what it was sold to do. The weight was gone. But she was left with a lot more to grapple with.

"She visited us twice after her health checkup. We gave her a proper diet chart, exercises to do, and a gradual dosage reduction of Mounjaro, till the maintenance dose, to wean off the drug's effect. She got married, but she never returned for a follow-up," the doctor says.

Three months to February

Akanksha Sadekar Chauhan did most of it right, with her weight loss monitored by an endocrinologist. Yet, the journey sprang constant surprises, not all of it pleasant.

It all began in December 2024, when Chauhan, a petroleum engineer who lives in the UK, turned 35, and "seriously started considering" whether she wanted to be a mother.

Her gynaecologist suggested she freeze her eggs, but he was concerned about her weight. "He told me he wasn't



Akanksha Sadekar Chauhan with her husband Prakhar Narain Singh Chauhan on their wedding day

“When treatment is stopped, appetite generally returns and substantial weight regain is common. A recent analysis of 37 studies has found that cardiometabolic benefits progressively diminish after stopping anti-obesity medication, with GLP-1 drugs associated with relatively rapid weight regain

DR ANOOP MISRA, EXECUTIVE CHAIRMAN OF FORTIS C-DOC HOSPITAL FOR DIABETES AND ALLIED SCIENCES

sure about the quality of the eggs we would retrieve," she says, adding that he advised her to shed some of the 99 kg that she weighed then.

"That was an alarm bell. I didn't want to go into a three-digit number," she says.

The gynaecologist referred her to an endocrinologist, who put her on Ozempic.

Her first dose was on March 25, 2025. Three days later, she met the man who would become her husband on a dating app. He was a practising lawyer, lean and athletic; she recalls being embarrassed about her weight. "I told him that in the next three months I was going to transform. I was almost trying to impress him," she says, laughing at the memory.

But the next few months were difficult as Chauhan lived with the side effects of the drug.

"From April to August, I was in China on work. Suddenly, my appetite dipped, and had become zero. Along with that, I could hardly find anything that I could eat. It was mostly watermelon," she says. Then, in the middle of the trip, nausea took over.

By November, the couple decided to get married and chose a February date for their wedding.

It was around this time that Chauhan decided to stop the drug for a month. She weighed 58 kg then. Within days, the scale began to move the other way. "Suddenly, I could see that there was some weight coming back," she says.

It was also the time she began shopping for her wedding. She recalls walking into a store in Lucknow and settling on two outfits: a deep olive-green *lehenga*, and a green-and-gold silk saree. The outfits

would take three months to arrive. For Chauhan, those months were a count-down, not only to the wedding but to the *lehenga* and its tailored blouse. "The only thing that was constantly running through my head was that I had to fit into that gorgeous *lehenga* and blouse," she recalls.

She consulted her endocrinologist. "Because I was getting married in February and I had only three months, I went back on the highest dose that I had stopped at," she says.

By the time she stood in her olive-green *lehenga*, she had reached the weight she had been aiming for. The *lehenga* fitted. So did the blouse. "I received compliments from everyone that day. They said I looked like I was 30 or 31, not 36. I felt so good that day. It was perfect," she says, smiling.

But the wedding was the start of another chapter. On medical advice, in February, Chauhan stopped the drug again, this time for three months. She conceived, but the pregnancy ended in a miscarriage.

"When I got it tested, my gynaecologist said everything was normal and that my miscarriage was not related to the weight-loss drugs," she says.

In June, she restarted the drug in the United Kingdom. "My Indian doctor was on a holiday," she recalls. She decided to restart the dose herself, without the doctor's advice. "It was a big mistake," she says.

The consequence was swift — severe vomiting and dehydration. She spent three days in the ICU.

Chauhan is now back on Mounjaro, under her doctor's supervision. "I will continue it for the next six months, just to maintain my weight, and then we will try to conceive next year," she says.

From the consultation room

Dr Anoop Misra, executive chairman of Fortis C-DOC Hospital for Diabetes and Allied Sciences, is among the city's leading endocrinologists. He has watched the boom in GLP-1 drugs unfold from his consultation room.

"We are seeing particularly strong demand among urban women, including women with post-pregnancy weight gain, PCOS-associated obesity and metabolic problems around the perimenopausal period. There is also considerable social pressure on women to achieve a particular body shape, and this creates a risk of medicalising cosmetic weight loss," he says.

There is a message he now repeats to his patients.

"The most important message is that obesity is a chronic disease, not simply a temporary excess of weight. GLP-1 drugs should therefore not be viewed like a short course of antibiotics," he says.

For many patients, Dr Misra says, treatment will need to be long term, especially if the underlying tendency to obesity remains.

"When treatment is stopped, appetite generally returns and substantial weight regain is common. A recent analysis of 37 studies has found that cardiometabolic benefits progressively diminish after stopping anti-obesity medication, with GLP-1 drugs associated with relatively rapid weight regain," he says.

That does not mean the drugs can't be stopped. In his experience, some patients can hold on to their weight loss with intensive dietary changes, more protein, physical activity and resistance training.

"The emerging consensus is therefore shifting from the question 'When can I stop the injection?' to 'What is the appropriate long-term treatment strategy for this individual's obesity?'," he says.

But Dr Misra "draws a clear line" at using these drugs mainly for cosmetic weight loss.

While the immediate side effects of the drugs are well recognised — nausea, vomiting, constipation, diarrhoea and reduced appetite — with excessive or rapid weight loss, there are broader concerns, he says, including loss of muscle and lean tissue, nutritional deficiencies, gallbladder disease and potentially loss of bone mass.

Early observational data on bone outcomes need more confirmation, he adds, and should not yet be read as proof of cause.

"For Indian patients, I am particularly concerned about sarcopenia and micronutrient deficiency because a person can become lighter without necessarily becoming metabolically or physically healthier. This is especially relevant to women and older adults," he says.

Dr Misra clarifies that his concern is not about the drugs themselves. "They are a major advance in obesity and metabolic medicine. My concern is using a powerful medical therapy for the wrong indication," he says.

A word of caution

Chauhan has learned that the hard way. Despite the many turns in her weight-loss journey, she has had doctors monitoring her every step of the way.

She has also become an informal adviser to other women weighing GLP-1 drugs before their weddings. In a WhatsApp support community, brides on weight-loss GLP-1 drugs often reach out to her, and she tells them what she wishes more people understood: this is not another item on a pre-wedding checklist.

"I tell them about the reality: this is not like a bridal skin package or a hair package. It's great to start before your wedding, but remember, it's a long-term thing," she says.

• HOW WEIGHT-LOSS DRUGS WORK

• Drugs such as Ozempic and Wegovy contain semaglutide, which mimics a naturally occurring hormone called glucagon-like peptide-1 (GLP-1)

• Semaglutide, like GLP-1, regulates appetite, increasing feelings of fullness and reducing calorie intake

• Unlike GLP-1, which is quickly broken down in the body after it is released by the gut in response to food, semaglutide lasts longer

• Mounjaro, which, instead of semaglutide, contains tirzepatide, mimics both GLP-1 and glucose-dependent insulinotropic polypeptide (GIP), another gut hormone

• Its combination of the GLP-1 and GIP components contributes to a greater weight-loss effect

• These drugs come as once-a-week injections in the abdomen, thigh or upper arm, using pre-filled pens

UPI & govt salaries may be used to gauge health, edu services growth

Siddharth Upasani
New Delhi, October 6

THE STATISTICS ministry is considering using UPI payments data and salaries paid by the government to help measure the growth of education, health, and public administration and defence services. This would increase the services covered by the new Index of Services Production (ISP), the ministry said on Tuesday.

The proposed use of UPI data for the ISP comes despite a sub-committee of the ministry's Advisory Committee on National Accounts Statistics deciding against it as an input in the calculation of India's GDP, noting that payments transaction data is not yet stable, with many people yet to move to UPI from cash.

"Once the UPI transaction data get stabilised, it may be explored for possible inclusion as an indicator in the estimation of PFCE," the report of the sub-committee, released in February, had said.

PFCE is Private Final Consumption Expenditure and the biggest component of GDP when it's measured as the sum of various types of spending.

However, the statistics ministry said on Tuesday the UPI is "entering a new phase of market maturity" and growth in transaction values and volumes is showing a "clear stabilising trend" after several years of "hyper-growth". "Looking forward, the trend strongly suggests that UPI is transitioning into a highly mature and resilient utility. Future growth is likely to flatten into a stable band," the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI) said. FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

UNION CABINET ANNOUNCES A HOST OF MEASURES TO BOOST GROWTH

Small, medium enterprises get Rs 10,000 cr fund boost

Pratyush Deep & Ravi Dutta Mishra
New Delhi, October 6

THE UNION Cabinet on Tuesday approved the Small and Medium Enterprise (SME) Growth Fund (SGF) with an outlay of Rs 10,000 crore.

This fund to provide equity support to small and medium enterprises was first announced in the Union Budget for 2026-27.

According to the government, while several existing funds provide equity support to businesses, most of them focus on early-stage enterprises and largely cater to micro enterprises. This has left a structural gap in the availability of growth-stage equity capital for small and medium enterprises.

"While various initiatives have enhanced access to credit for SMEs, a gap remains in the availability of long-term risk capital required by enterprises seeking to scale, innovate, expand internationally, adopt advanced technologies, undertake acquisitions, and transform into industry leaders," the government said in a statement.

"The SME Growth Fund is designed to address this critical financing gap by providing patient growth equity capital to high-potential SMEs with demonstrated business viability and scalability," it added.

Under the initiative, the government will provide an aggregate commitment of Rs 10,000 crore to the Alternative Investment Fund (AIF) established under the SGF framework. A majority of the fund's investments will be directed towards small and medium manufacturing enterprises, with a focus also on SMEs operating in industrial clusters in Tier-II and Tier-III cities.



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facturers place larger and more consistent orders with smaller suppliers, enabling those businesses to invest in better machinery, improve quality, build skills and create jobs.

"As these capabilities deepen across industrial clusters, more MSMEs can meet the standards required by large domestic buyers and global supply chains. The cumulative outcome can be higher domestic value addition, greater export competitiveness and reduced dependence on imported components and finished products," Kumar said.

Experts said the fund is critical for the MSME as they are facing structural gaps and severe capital gaps and have been over-dependent on debt financing and have weak integration with the global value chain. Sandeep Jain, an auto-component manufacturer and former President of Federation of Indian Micro and Small & Medium Enterprises (FISME) said the growth fund would give motivation to SMEs to grow and not be overtly concerned with the financing. FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

India SME Forum in a note said the fund is critical for the MSME as they are facing structural and severe capital gaps. They have been over-dependent on debt financing and have weak integration with the global value chain, the forum said.

"The SME growth fund could help mobilisation of institutional capital and creation of globally competitive mid-sized champions," it said.

Vinod Kumar, President, India SME Forum said the Rs 10,000 crore SME Growth Fund can set in motion a powerful cycle, where stronger manu-

facturers place larger and more consistent orders with smaller suppliers, enabling those businesses to invest in better machinery, improve quality, build skills and create jobs.

"As these capabilities deepen across industrial clusters, more MSMEs can meet the standards required by large domestic buyers and global supply chains. The cumulative outcome can be higher domestic value addition, greater export competitiveness and reduced dependence on imported components and finished products," Kumar said.

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New apex body for transport and logistics gets nod

New Delhi: The Union Cabinet on Tuesday approved the constitution of an Integrated Transport & Logistics Authority (ITLA) to have a synergy among different transport departments and assess the country's future requirements in infrastructure development.

The authority will be set up in the Ministry of Commerce & Industry, serving as the apex body for project planning and appraisal, research, monitoring and evaluation, among other functions.

Minister of Information and Broadcasting Ashwini Vaishnaw said that all the major sectors such as the railways, highways, aviation, among others, will have representation under the new authority.

"Practically, if GDP increases by 7%, the logistics requirement increases by 10% in the economy. To meet this heavy requirement, Highways, railway lines, waterways, ports, airports are being built. To have a unified planning of these things, Gati Shakti portal was launched. Now, to meet the future requirements in transportation and have a synergy among different departments, the Integrated transport & logistics authority will be set up," said Vaishnaw, as he announced the decision. ENS FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

REJECTION OF TATA SONS PLEA TO SURRENDER NBFC REGISTRATION

RBI letter doesn't mandate listing: Noel Tata & 3 trustees

George Mathew
Mumbai, October 6

THE RESERVE Bank of India's (RBI's) communication on Tata Sons' application to surrender its registration has, rather than weakened, strengthened the position of Tata Trusts and does not ask Tata Sons to pursue a listing, Tata Trusts Chairman Noel Tata and three trustees have said.

In a letter to Trusts Vice-chairmen Venu Srinivasan and Vijay Singh on Monday, Noel Tata and trustees Darius Khambata, Neville N Tata and Bhaskar Bhat argued that the RBI's communication did not overturn decisions taken in 2025, as it merely declined Tata Sons' application and neither mandated a listing nor prescribed any specific course of action.

Neville is the son of Noel Tata. The four trustees said the RBI's communication instead made it more urgent to find a lawful alternative to listing that would meet the "settled objective" of the Trusts and Tata Sons. The proposal outlined in their letter, they said, would, if implemented, take Tata Sons outside the regulatory category on which the RBI's communication was based.

"The Tata Trusts did what the Board of Tata Sons asked of them. The proposal set out in the letter gives effect to the decisions unanimously taken by SDDT and SRTT on May 28, 2025 and July 28, 2025, which both of you joined," the letter said. It was sent to the Chairman of Tata Sons for the consideration of the Board and for submission to the RBI, which is exactly the course the Board itself had agreed, they said.

Far from usurping the functions of the Board of Tata Sons, the Trusts responded to its request, they said. "Whatever

Charity Comm seeks SDDT trustees' response by October 12

Mumbai: Pressure is mounting on the Sir Dorabji Tata Trust (SDDT) as the Maharashtra Charity Commissioner has sought a response to the complaints filed by Tata Sons Director and SDDT Trustees Venu Srinivasan and Vijay Singh, even as a separate order on the Sir Ratan Tata Trust (SRTT) is expected in the coming weeks.

The latest move adds another layer to the increasingly bitter internal dispute within the Tata Trusts, with questions over the governance of the two principal trusts that together hold more than half of

Tata Sons. The Charity Commissioner's proceedings have already had a direct impact on Tata Sons, with the holding company's annual general meeting adjourned after the regulator's restraining order prevented SRTT from conducting its board proceedings.

The Charity Commissioner had earlier issued an ex-parte order restraining SRTT from holding meetings and taking decisions while an inquiry into the composition of its board was pending. ENS FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

view is taken of the resolutions passed at the meeting of September 17, and the Trusts' position on the resolution concerning the Chairman is well known, the request for the Trusts' guidance was made by Tata Sons, not by the Trusts," the letter said.

The four trustees of the Sir Dorabji Tata Trust (SDDT) launched an attack on Srinivasan and Singh, accusing them of abandoning collective decisions, airing personal views in the media, and allegedly breaching their fiduciary duties. They questioned the credibility of Srinivasan and Singh's opposition to the Trusts' stand on Tata Sons.

The four trustees effectively tell the two vice-chairmen: you can't first participate in unanimous decisions to keep Tata Sons unlisted and then champion listing without taking the matter back to the Trusts.

Their accusation is summed up in one caustic phrase. The trustees referred to the two men's changed position in April

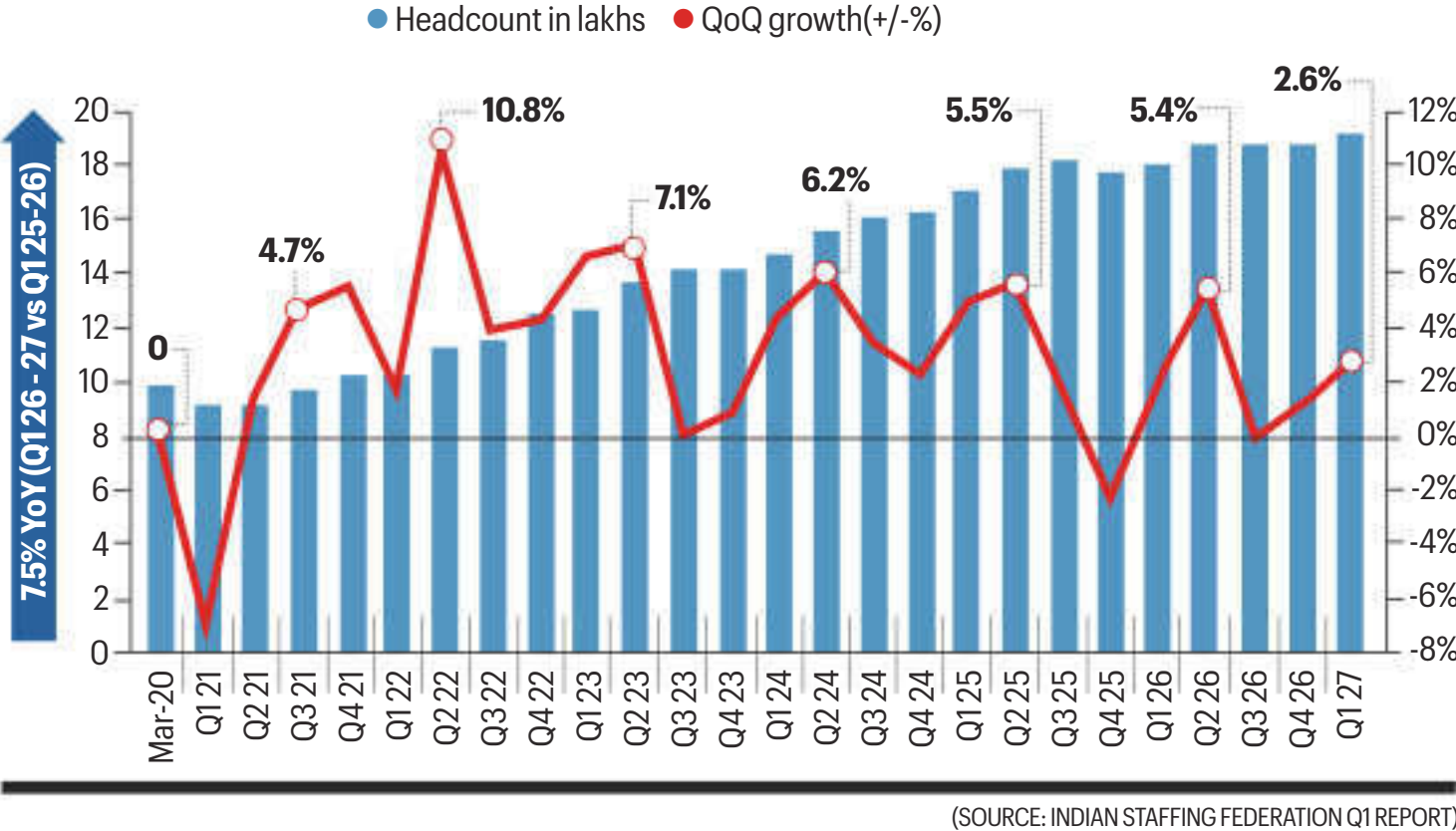
2026 as their "epiphanies", saying they suddenly decided that listing was good for Tata Sons and its minority shareholders.

Singh and Srinivasan had last week questioned Tata Trusts for sending Tata Sons reorganisation proposal without consulting them.

They alleged that the two did not raise their changed position at any of the three SDDT meetings held after April. "You chose not to raise your changed view for collective deliberation with your co-trustees," the trustees said, arguing that the conduct "undermined the Trusts' resolutions, as also the pending application made by Tata Sons to the RBI" and amounted to "a breach of your fiduciary duties". The letter makes clear that for the trustees, the dispute is not a mere difference of opinion. They are questioning whether Srinivasan and Singh acted consistently with their responsibilities as trustees. FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

FLEXI STAFFING INDUSTRY NET EMPLOYMENT GROWTH

Staffing industry's net employment growth in the first quarter of FY27 (Apr-Jun 2026) made a sequential recovery of 2.6%. On year-on-year basis, it was a rise of 7.5%. The growth was broad-based across consumption, manufacturing and technology amid 7.8% growth seen in GDP in the same quarter.



(SOURCE: INDIAN STAFFING FEDERATION Q1 REPORT)

Govt may look at reviving jet fuel price stabilisation fund

Sukalp Sharma
New Delhi, October 6

WITH A surge in jet fuel prices in recent months hitting airlines, the government could consider a revival of the Price Stabilisation Fund (PSF) scheme to provide stable fuel pricing to airlines amid extreme price volatility in the international market, a senior government official said Tuesday.

The Rs 10,000-crore PSF scheme was first announced in June amid soaring jet fuel prices, but lapsed after it failed to attract any airline at the time as prices moderated shortly afterwards on hopes of truce in

the West Asia conflict.

However, jet fuel prices have surged again as the conflict drags on, leading to major disruptions in global energy flows. Separately, Civil Aviation Minister K Rammo-han Naidu told reporters that the government is in discussion with airlines as well as the public sector oil marketing companies (OMCs) on jet fuel prices, but didn't elaborate further.

The recent hike in jet fuel prices has prompted India's largest airline IndiGo to hike fuel surcharge on flight tickets after six months, and other airlines might follow suit.

BRIEFLY

GST Council to consider rate rejig proposals yearly

New Delhi: The GST Council will take up any proposal for tax rate changes only once a year and henceforth, all GST rate changes will be implemented from April 1 — the beginning of a fiscal year, Finance Ministry sources said. PTI

Manufacturing sentiment improved: FICCI

New Delhi: India's manufacturing sentiment improved in the July-September quarter as factories reported higher capacity utilisation and higher or same levels of production as compared to

the previous quarter, according to the latest edition of the FICCI Manufacturing Survey released on Tuesday. The survey, which covered around 225 firms, assessed the performance and sentiment of manufacturers for nine major sectors. The survey covered respondents from manufacturing units from both large and SME segments. PTI

Services sector growth touches 3-mth high in Sep

New Delhi: India's services sector growth touched a three-month high in September, as new orders increased sharply, supported by strengthening domestic demand, a monthly report said on Tuesday. PTI

MARKETS

Sensex	NIFTY	Gold	US Dollar
73,067.81	22,776.10	₹1,48,473	₹96.43
685.34	220.35		
0.95%	0.98%	Silver	Oil
		₹2,22,820	\$121.95

NOTE: GOLD, SILVER RATES AS PER INDIA BULLION AND JEWELLERS ASSOCIATION GOLD PER 100, SILVER PER 1 KG; CRUDE OIL (INDIAN BASKET) AS OF OCTOBER 05, 2026

India's bullet train not delayed, even Japan can't make it in 10 yrs

Dheeraj Mishra & Siddharth Upasani
New Delhi, October 6

AMID ALLEGATIONS over delays in India's first bullet train project between Mumbai and Ahmedabad, the head of the international high-speed rail body said it should not be said that the project is delayed given the many unforeseen problems India encountered, such as the Covid-19 pandemic and land acquisition.

Speaking to The Indian Express on the sidelines of the Kautilya Economic Conclave, Masafumi Shukuri, Chairman of the Japan Transport and Tourism Research Institute (JTTRI) and International High-Speed Rail Association (IHRA), defended the Indian government, saying that even though Japan has 62 years of experience in building and operating bullet trains, it cannot complete a 500-km long stretch in 10 years.

"The first high-speed rail (project) in Japan was launched in 1964, which means Japan has 62 years of experience of constructing and operating the high-speed train. Now, let us just say today Japan decides to make a high-speed rail track of 500 km. It is not possible to complete it in 10 years.

Even today's Japan cannot do it... I think from this perspective, given the different conditions, building a high-speed rail of 500 km long in India is a big deal" Shukuri said.

"We also have to remember that initially when any project starts, there are many unforeseen problems. I know that there was a delay in land acquisition and many other things which have to be factored in," the IHRA Chairman added. Shukuri's comments come after Hideki Makihara, a former justice minister and a member of Japan's ruling Liberal Democratic Party, who alleged in July that India had displayed "sheer recklessness" in its bullet train project that stalled its progress. The Mumbai-Ahmedabad High-Speed Rail (MAHSR), India's first ever bullet train project, was initially expected to be completed in 2022. "I do not think there is a delay really, because you have to look at the size of this project. It is a 500-km long alignment. It is being done for the first time in India. With all of this together, it is a humongous, massive project. It is not a project which is expected to be wrapped up and completed in a matter of just a few years. It is just not possible," Shukuri said. FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

World Bank raises India's FY27 growth outlook to 7.1%

Siddharth Upasani
New Delhi, October 6

THE WORLD Bank has raised its GDP growth forecast for India for the current fiscal by half a percentage point to 7.1%, with this rapid expansion seen driving the broader South Asia region. According to the multi-lateral organisation's twice-yearly South Asia Economic Update, released on Tuesday, the South Asia region's GDP in 2026 is seen expanding by 6.9%, up from the previous forecast of 6.3%.

However, excluding India, regional growth is seen 3.6%, down from 4.1% earlier, mostly because of a large downward revision for Bangladesh. The World Bank expects the "strong" momentum in industry and services to continue, with the reforms that have been undertaken — consolidation of labour codes, GST reforms, rationalisation of tariffs, the bankruptcy and insolvency act, and physical and digital infrastructure investments — keeping the growth potential strong. "Strength in the rest of the economy is expected to make up for agricultural weakness," the World Bank said, adding that the sub-par monsoons will likely reduce agricultural output.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

CENTRAL ELECTRICITY REGULATORY COMMISSION
6th, 7th, & 8th Floor, Tower-B, World Trade Centre, Nauroji Nagar, New Delhi-110029

Petition No. 220/TL/2026

Dated: 29.9.2026

NOTICE UNDER CLAUSE (a) OF SUB-SECTION (5) OF SECTION 15 OF THE ELECTRICITY ACT, 2003

An application under Sections 14, 15 and 79 (1) (e) of the Electricity Act, 2003 (the Act) has been made by **South Kalamb Power Transmission Limited**, Adani Corporate House, Shantigram Near Vaishno Devi Circle, S. G. Highway, Khodiyar, Ahmedabad - 382421, Delhi for the grant of a Transmission Licence to establish the "Network Expansion Scheme for drawal of power at South Kalamb S/s: Part A" (hereinafter referred to as "the Project) on Build, Own, Operate and Transfer Basis consisting of the following elements:

Sl. No.	Name of the Transmission Element	Capacity / km	Scheduled COD in months from Effective Date
1.	Creation of New 765 kV Bus Sections-II & III & 400 kV Bus Sections-II & III through 765 kV Sectionalization bay: 2 set & 400 kV Sectionalization bay: 2 set along with 2x330 MVAR, 765 kV bus reactor & 2x125 MVAR, 420 kV bus reactor on Section-III. 400 kV Sectionalizer between Sections-I & II & between sections-II & III to be normally open. Further, 765 kV sectionaliser between Sections-I & 11 & between II & III shall be kept normally closed. The 400 kV sectionalisers can be closed under contingency conditions. Installation of 3x1500 MVA, 765/400 kV ICTs at South Kalamb S/s (400 kV Sec-III & 765 kV Section-III) All space provisions on 400 kV & 765 kV Bus Sections-I & II of South Kalamb S/s as per RFP document of "Network Expansion scheme in Western Region to cater to Pumped storage potential near Talegaon (Pune)" scheme shall be kept while implementing this scheme. TSP of "Network Expansion scheme in Western Region to cater to Pumped storage potential near Talegaon (Pune)" scheme shall provide necessary space free of cost for above bus extension / sectionalisation / augmentation works.	• 765/400 kV, 1500 MVA ICTs- 3 Nos. • 765 kV ICT bays- 3 No. (at bus section-III) • 400 kV ICT bays- 3 No. (at bus section-III) • 330 MVar Bus Reactor- 2 Nos. (at bus section- III) • 765 kV bus reactor bays- 2 Nos. (at bus section-III) • 125 MVar Bus Reactor- 2 Nos. (at bus section-III) • 400 kV Bus reactor bays- 2 Nos. (at bus section-III) • 765 kV Sectionalization bay: 2 sets • 400 kV Sectionalization bay: 2 sets	24 months (30.03.2028)
2.	LILO of Nagothane - Padghe 400 kV D/C line at South Kalamb with Quad ACSR/AAAC/AL59 moose equivalent conductor		
3.	LILO of Pune (AIS) - Navi Mumbai 400 kV line at South Kalamb with Quad ACSR/AAAC/AL59 moose equivalent conductor		
4.	LILO of Pune (AIS) -Vikhroli 400 kV line at South Kalamb with Quad ACSR/AAAC/AL59 moose equivalent conductor		
5.	8 Nos. 400 kV bays at South Kalamb S/s for LILO lines at Sl. 2, 3 & 4	• 400 kV line bays - 8 Nos. (Sec-III)	

Note: TSP of South Kalamb S/s shall provide space for above scope of work at South Kalamb S/s free of cost.

2. The Central Transmission Utility of India Limited, vide its letter dated 17.4.2026, has recommended for the grant of a transmission licence to the applicant to establish the proposed transmission system.

3. Based on the material available on the record, the Commission vide order dated 29.9.2026 in Petition No. 220/TL/2026, has proposed to issue a transmission licence to the applicant for the establishment of the transmission scheme as noted in para 1 above.

4. A copy of the application, along with its annexures and enclosures, made by the applicant for the grant of an inter-State transmission licence to **South Kalamb Power Transmission Limited**, before the Commission can be accessed at the **www.adanienergysolutions.com** or inspected by any person in the Commission's office by following the laid down procedure.

5. Notice is hereby given in pursuance of clause (a) of sub-section (5) of Section 15 of the Act that suggestions or objections, if any, to the Commission's proposal to grant a transmission licence to the applicant, as aforesaid, be sent to the undersigned by **12.10.2026** at the above noted address. The suggestions or objections received after the specified date shall not be considered.

6. The application shall be taken up for the further hearing by the Commission on **13.10.2026**. Any person who files suggestions or objections may in his/her discretion attend the hearing, for which no TA/DA shall be paid by the Commission.

Sd/-
(Harpreet Singh Pruthi)
Secretary

Classifieds

PERSONAL

I, LEKHARAJ PATIDAR S/o Mukesh R/o MN-929, Waard N-12, Teh Ratlam, PO: Dhamond, Madhya Pradesh-457001, Have Changed My Name to LEKHRAJ PATIDAR.

0071064181-1

I, Jasoda, D/O Govind Ram, r/o- Plot no. 1 and 2, Hooda House, Rajendra Park, Nangloi Delhi 110041. Have changed my name to Jasoda Batra for all purposes

0040882081-5

I, KHEM SINGH S/o Jaman Singh Negi R/o S-9 Princes Park Copernicus Marg New Delhi-110001, have changed my name to KHEM SINGH NEGI

0040882044-8

I, Vikas Bhatnagar Residing at B-102, GH 8-9, Swabhman Apartment Sector 48, Faridabad - 121001. I have changed my son name from Sahaj Bhatnagar to Sahhaj Bhatnagar

0071064129-1

I, VIDHYA BHUSHAN, S/o- Sat Ram Pahuja, R/o- H.No.669, Near Huda Market, Sector-04, Gurgaon, Haryana-122001, have changed my name to VIDYA BHUSHAN for all future purpose.

0040882048-5

I, Vinod Kumar S/o Sukhbir, Father of Abhi Phougat R/o V.P.O.Kailana, Tehsil: Ganaur, District: Sonipat, Haryana-131102 have changed my minor Son's name from Abhi Phougat to Lavish Phogat.

0020521391-1

I, Manish Yadav, R/o- H.No.-395, Ground Floor, Sector -45, Kanahi, Gurgaon (Haryana), have changed my Minor Son name from Tejas to Tejas Yadav for all Purposes.

0040882072-9

I, Parmender Kumar Badas, S/o- Som Dutt Dabas, R/O Prop No-A-28, First Floor, A-Block, Road No.-2, Mahipalpur, Gurgaon Road, Delhi-110037, have changed my name to Parminder Dabas for all future purposes

0040882044-1

I Manju, W/o Vikas Chaurasia, R/o JU 18-C, Pitam Pura , Delhi-110034, have change my sir name to Manju Devi, for all future purposes.

0040882038-1

Ijitender Singh alias Jitender Kumar S/o Om Pal Singh, R/o Ward No. 06, Gram Nandha Post Balwari, Nandha(34) Teh and Distt Rewari Haryana 123103 have changed my name to Jitender Kumar for all purposes.

0040881943-3

It is for general information that I, Abhey Kumar Anand, S/o- Chhotey Lal, Residing at L-47, L-Block, Laxmi Nagar, Shakarpur, East Delhi-110092, declare that name of mine has been wrongly written as, Abhey Kumar in my Educational- Documents, and Passport- No. P1912479. The actual name of mine is, Abhey Kumar Anand, which may be amended accordingly

0040882049-4

I, Nareshpal Singh Rathsi, S/o Dharam Pal Singh Rathsi, R/o House No. 12, Gali No. 1, near G.S. Garden, Sai Enclave, Chipiyana Buzurg, G.B Nagar, U.P have changed my minor daughter name from Priyanka Choudhary to Priyanka Rathsi for all future purposes.

0071064170-1

I, GURMEET BEDI, W/O, RAJINDER SINGH KWATRA, R/O E-457, Ground Floor, GREATER KAILASH PART-II, SOUTH DELHI-110057 Have Changed My Name To GURMEET KAUR KWATRA.

0040882081-7

I, Gurleen Kaur D/O Ravinder Pal Singh Walia R/O 6 Amba Enclave, Sector-9, Rohini Delhi-110085, have changed my name to Gurleen Walia.

0040882045-1

I, BABU LAL GUPTA S/O BINDA PRASAD, H-17/242, STRRET NO-17, SANGAM VIHAR, DELHI-62 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO BABU LAL.

0071064163-1

I, Vineet Kumar Rai S/o Paras Nath Rai R/o SA-6/186, F-1, Srinagar Colony, Pahariya, Varanasi (U.P.- 221007) have changed my minor daughter's name from Anushka Rai to Nitara Rai for all future purposes.

0040881965-1

I, JYOTI KUMARI W/O MANOJ R/O 4526/12 JAI MATA MARKET TRINAGAR DELHI-110035, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO JYOTI FOR ALL PURPOSES.

0040882048-7

I, SUDESH KUMAR YADAV, S/O INDAL SINGH R/O C-088 POCKET P-7, MITRA SAS LTD GREATER-NOIDA UP, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO SUDESH KUMAR.

0040882072-2

I, RAJIV KUMAR KAPOOR S/o Late Sh. V.K. KAPOOR R/o C-68, Sector-33, Noida, G.B.Nagar, U.P.-201301, have changed my name to RAJIV KAPOOR for all purposes.

0071064096-1

I Akash S/o Dinesh R/o 266-A Paschim vihar extension, Delhi-110063, have changed my name & DoB to Akash Sonkar 17 april 1992 Permanently.

0071064176-1

I, GOPAL S/O HARISH CHANDER R/O RZ-50 RAGHUBIR BLOCK PREM NAGAR NAJAFGARH DELHI-110043. HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO SHRI GOPAL.

0040882049-1

I, Kanika Mehra D/o Sanjay Mehra R/o G-2/A, South Extension Part-2, Andrews Ganj, Andrewsganj, South Delhi-110049 have changed my name to Kanika Srav

0071064177-1

I, Divya Dutt, W/o Rajesh Dutt R/o New T-65, Shukra Bazar, Uttam Nagar, New Delhi-110059, have changed my name to Chander Kiran

0040882081-4

I, MAHENDER SINGH S/o Khem Singh Negi R/o S-9 Princes Park Copernicus Marg New Delhi-110001, have changed my name to MAHENDER SINGH NEGI.

0040882044-7

I, HABIBULLAH S/o MOHD YUNUS R/o 46, Gali KABABIYAN JAMA MASJID, JAMA MASJID, DELHI G.P.O., NORTH DELHI, DELHI, 110006 have changed my name to HABIBULLAH YUNUS for all purposes.

0071064128-1

I, Saleem Mohd, S/o- Chhotu, R/o H No J-167, Jhuggi Park, Vishal Enclave Near, Four Storey Tagore, Garden Near Delhi-110027 I have change my name Saleem.

0040882048-4

I, Charu Rustagi Alias Leela Wati D/o Om Parkash and W/o Krishan Kumar R/o F-6/34, First Floor, Krishna Nagar, East Delhi, Delhi-110051, have changed my name to Leela Wati.

0071064140-1

I, Leena Khurana W/O Nikhil Kurra R/O H-1/66-67, Sector-11, Rohini, Delhi-110085, have changed my name to Leena Kurra.

0040882057-1

I, Manish, S/o- Tilak Raj Yadav, R/o- H.No.-395, Ground Floor, Sector-45, Kanahi, Gurgaon (Haryana), have changed my name to Manish Yadav for all Purposes.

0040882072-8

I, NAVEEN S/O SATISH KUMAR R/O 3252 4TH-FLOOR RANJEET NAGAR DELHI-110008. HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO NAVEEN KUMAR FOR ALL PURPOSES.

0040882081-1

I, SIMRAN KAUR KOHLI w/o GURPREET SINGH KOHLI r/o GH-14/927 MIG Flats, Paschim Vihar, Delhi-110087 have changed my name as SIMRAN KAUR permanently.

0040881995-2

I Shavantrevva P. Gaddigoudra D/o Pithambaragoud and W/o Bhimappa Ganiger R/o Hebballi, Bagalkot, Karnataka-587201, have changed my name to Shavantrevva Bhimappa Ganiger

0071064188-1

I, VERONICA ARORA, W/O, VAIBHAV TIWARI, R/O, Y-172, DLF CAPITAL GREENS, MOTI NAGAR, Delhi-110015, have changed the name of my minor SON from KRISHNA ARORA TIWARI to KRISHNA TIWARI.

0040882081-6

It is for general information that I, KAMLESH SHARDA, S/o- MAHADEV SHARDA, R/o- 589, Janta Quarters, Pocket-3, Paschim Puri, Paschim Vihar, West Delhi, Delhi-110063, declare that name of my father name MAHADEV MAL, as wife name, RUKHMANI SHARDA, has been wrongly written, in my PASSPORT DOCUMENT NO- BB413005. The actual name of my father is MAHADEV SHARDA, as my wife name is RUKMANI SHARDA respectively, which may be amended accordingly

0040882044-9

I, JYOTI KUMARI W/O MANOJ R/O 4526/12 JAI MATA MARKET TRINAGAR DELHI-110035, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO JYOTI FOR ALL PURPOSES.

0040882048-6

I, Ajay, S/O- Bhagat Ram, R/O- House no- F-542, Dakshin Puri, Ambedkar Nagar New Delhi-110062, have changed my name to AJAY KUMAR Permanently

0040882072-1

I, SONIA MEHTA, W/O- NISHANT MEHTA, R/O- HOUSE, NO.-A/18/15A, VARIENDAR VATIKA RANA, PRATAP BAGH, MALKA GANJ, NORTH DELHI-110007, have changed my name from SONIA KAPOOR to SONIA MEHTA, after marriage for all, future purposes.

0040882072-10

I, CHESHTHA GARG, D/O, SOMESH KUMAR, R/O, 12, MAHOLI ROAD, ANAND VIHAR, MATHURA BANGAR, MATHURA, UTTAR PRADESH-281004, have changed my name to CHESTHA GARG.

0040882044-2

I, RAJANI VARSHNEY W/O SHIV NARAYAN R/O H-3/34, THIRD FLOOR, ROHINI, SECTOR-18, DELHI-110089 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO RAJNI DEVI FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSES.

0071064135-1

I, Shubh Singhal, S/o- Gaurav Singhal, R/o-A-36, Vivek Vihar, Phase-2, Delhi-110095, declare that in, my Passport, No. P6610920, my DOB is written 04-11-1999, my actual, DOB is 04-11-1998, as in my Aadhar- No. which may be amended accordingly

0040882049-5

I, Jagbhushan R/o Flat No 27 E Block Sector Xu 1 Greater Noida Uttar Pradesh have changed my minor son's name from Arya Yashwardhan Jagbhushan to Yashvardhan.

0040882008-1

It is for general information that I, Harsh Raj S/o Dharmvir Kumar Azad R/o Mahavir Nagar, Adarsh Vikramshila Colony, Hanuman Nagar, Kankarbagh, Sampatchak, PO- Lohia Nagar, Dist- Patna, Bihar-800020, declare that name of my Father has been wrongly written as Dharmvir Azad in my 10th class School Certificate Cum Marksheet. The actual name of my father is Dharmvir Kumar Azad, which may be amended accordingly.

0071064190-1

I, Kesar Singh Oberoi S/o Late Jawahar Singh R/o L-18, Jalvayu Vihar, Sector-25, Noida, Dist- Gautam Budh Nagar, U.P.-201301 inform that Kesar Singh Oberoi & K.S. Oberoi both are one & the same person i.e. both are my names.

0040882016-1

I, MOHAMMAD TAHIR, s/o- MOHD ILYAS, r/o- H no- 496, Bagowali, Bagowali, Muzaffarnagar, Uttar Pradesh-251001, has changed my name to MOHD TAHIR permanently for all future purpose

0040882081-8

I, Ritika D/O Giriraj Prasad Sharma R/O House No.65, Shiv Mandir, Govind Mohalla, Haidar Pur, Delhi-110088, have changed my name to Ritika Sharma.

0040882045-2

I, RITA W/O PARDEEP KUMAR R/O HNO.3 RAMESH NAGAR BAWANA DELHI-110039. HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO RITA KUMARI FOR ALL PURPOSES.

0040882048-8

I, MADIHA, D/O- MOHAMMAD SALEEM, R/O- H-0 E-19, STREET NO-1, SHASTRI PARK, PO SEELAMPUR DIST, NORTH EAST DELHI-110053, HAVE CHANGE MY NAME TO MADIHA SALEEM FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSE.

0040882072-3

I, hitherto known as, komal, W/o- Girish Kumar, R/o- House No-53, Satya Niketan, Moti Bagh 2, South Delhi-110021, Have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Komal walia

0040882081-1

I, Amrit Kaur, D/o Anokh Singh, R/o 63-A, Masjid Moth Phase-2, Delhi, 110048, have changed my name to Amit Kaur, for all purposes.

0071064127-1

I, SEEMA KUMARI W/O SH SIDDHARTHA RAJORA R/O B-202, 2nd Floor, Plot No- GH-1, Jansatta Apartment, Sector-9, Vasundhara Ghaziabad up-201012, have changed my name KM SEEMA to Seema Kumari For All Future Purposes.

0040881961-1

I, ABHISHEK KUMAR MANJHI, S/O- BASANT MANJHI, R/O- SALARPUR, SUBZI MANDI, BHANGAL NOIDA, PHASE-2, NOIDA, G.B NAGAR, UP-201301, have changed my name to ABHISHEK KUMAR

0040882048-1

I, Vipinkumar Singh S/o Girjashankar Singh R/o Flat -1503, Tower-4, Lotus Panache, Sector 110, Noida U.P have Changed my name from Vipinkumar Girjashankar Singh to Vipinkumar Singh for all future purposes.

0071064137-1

I, Baljeet Kaur, D/o Jasmer Singh, W/o Rahul Dhawan, R/o- 214-A, New Layalpur Colony, Krishna Nagar, Delhi-110051, have changed my name to Baljeet Kaur Dhawan permanently.

0040882049-7

I, Chatar Singh, F/O- JC-481962P, Subedar Major Dayanand, R/O- Katesra (118), Tehsil- Kalanaur, District- Rohtak, Haryana-124113. In my son's service records my name and D o B has been wrongly mentioned as Chhatar Singh, 01-07-1945, instead of Chatar Singh, 01-01-1955 vide affidavit no- IN- JK 53937359368258Y. Dated 03-10-2026 before public notary shopian Kashmir.

0020521395-1

I, hitherto known as HARSHVARDHAN SARMAH S/o Jayanta Sarma, R/o H. No. 71, West Jyoti Nagar, Guwahati, Assam, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as UDIT SARMAH for all future purposes. It is certified that I have complied with other legal requirements in this connection.

0040882045-6

Ihitherto known as Janardhanam Keshav S/o J Krishna R/o F-29, Peepal Wala Road, Mohan Garden, Uttam Nagar, West Delhi, Delhi-110059 have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as J Keshav

0040882030-1

I, Umesh Kumar Tyagi, S/o- Jogendra Singh, R/o- H.No.-6, Bhanna Taga, Gautam Buddha Nagar (Uttar Pradesh), have changed my name to Umesh Tyagi for all Purposes.

0040882072-7

I, KHUSHBOO, W/O- THAN SINGH, R/O- C-78, Gali No-13, Gokalpur Tukmipur, North East, Delhi-110094, have changed the name of my minor son, DABBU aged-13 years, and he shall hereafter be known as, NAKSH THAKUR.

0040882048-3

I, Manjeet S/o Subhash R/o Village -Baghania (4), Gurgaon (Haryana) -122105, have changed my name to Manjeet Yadav for all Purposes.

0040882072-5

Ihitherto known as S. Raja Raman Alias Sundara Raman Raja Raman S/o S. Sundara Raman residing at C8/8529, Vasant Kunj, South West, Delhi -110070, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Raja Raman.

0071064197-1

I, Aalok S/O Shri Ram Ji R/O Jhuggi No. N-49/220, J.J. Camp, Haidarpur, Shalimar Bagh, Delhi-110088, have changed my name to Alok.

0040882045-4

I, PINKY C/O KISHAN KUMAR, 852/B2, SF, Gali No-7, GOVINDPURI, KALKAJI, DELHI-19 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO PINKY GOLLA.

0071064161-1

I, Gurmeet Kaur, W/o- Gurpreet Singh, R/o B-3/253, 2nd Floor, Paschim Vihar, West Delhi-110063, have changed the name of my minor Son namely Angad Raheja, aged 13 years, to Angad Singh Raheja.

0040882048-10

I, Virender Singh Bisla S/o Padam Singh R/o Maojpur (88) Atali, Faridabad, Haryana have changed my name to Virender Singh.

0071064164-1

I, Mohir Alam S/o Sayad Alam R/o B-64/A-1, Near S.N. Giri Public School, Punjabi Bagh, Baljeet Nagar, Delhi-110018, have changed my name to Musheer Alam for all purposes.

0040882011-1

I, MOOSA AZRA, W/O- MOHD MOOSA, R/O- 1098 Gali NEEM WALI KISHAN GANJ AZAD MARKET DELHI-110006 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO AZRA MOOSA FOR FUTURE.

0040882081-3

I, Mohammad Sadiq hussain, S/O- Mohammad Anwar Husain, R/O 165/A kh.No.132, second Floor, Gali no.9, village wazirabad, DELHI 110084, have changed My Name to Sadiq hussain for all purposes

0040882044-6

I, ABDULLAH S/O MOHD YUNUS R/o 46, GALI KABABIYAN KAREEM HOTAL, JAMA MASJID, DELHI G.P.O., NORTH DELHI, DELHI, 110006 have changed my name to ABDULLAH YUNUS for all purposes.

0071064127-1

I, Neesha Vipin Singh W/o Vipinkumar Singh R/o Flat -1503, Tower-4, Lotus Panache, Sector 110, Noida U.P have Changed my name from Neesha Singh to Neesha Vipin Singh for all future purposes.

0071064138-1

I, MOHAMMAD BASIT S/o. RAIS AHMED R/O. 502 Choori Walan Jama Masjid Delhi-110006, have changed my name to MOHD BASIT permanently

0040882049-9

I, SUNIL KUMAR SINGAL S/O JAGDISH MITTER SINGAL R/O 24 SHARDA NIKETAN PITAMPURA DELHI-110034. HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO SUNIL SINGAL.

0040882049-2

I Babli alias Tirath Kaur w/o Janak Rai r/o A-24, Gali No.-7, New Govind Pura, Delhi-110051 have changed my name TIRATH KAUR permanently.

TIRATH KAUR and BABLI both are same and one person.

0040881995-1

LOST & FOUND

Original DDA Possession Letter of Flat No. 64-A, 1st Floor, New DDA Janta Flats, Chilla Village, Mayur Vihar Phase-1, Delhi-110091 has been lost. Delhi Police Lost Report (LR No. 699554/2026 dated 06/10/2026, P.S. Mayur Vihar Ph-1) has been lodged. Finder please contact/Return- Regi Santhosh, Mob: 9971497361, Email: regisanthosh77@gmail.com.

0040882057-2

I, Rahul Surana, S/o Rakesh Surana, R/o-A-2, Marble Arch- Apartments-9, Prithviraj-Road, Delhi-110003, have lost the property- documents of Everytime Food Industries Pvt.Ltd, including Indemnity Bond, and Affidavit-dated November-1998, along with Memorandum of Settlement dated-04.04.1987. Finder may contact-9491129700

0040881949-1

I, KRIPA SHANKAR JAISWAL, S/O MOHAN RAM JAISWAL, R/O- E-95, Shastri Nagar, Delhi-110052, mobile- No.9818175185, inform the general public that the original Transfer-Letter, dated-26.06.1999, Allotment- No.R0140399, for property, B-10, Sector-P-3, GREATER Noida, has been lost. Anyone claiming any right, may contact-through registered post.

0040882027-1

I Rama W/o Sh. Prem Nath, R/o 220, First Floor, Near LPS School, New Layal Pur Colony, East Delhi-110051 have lost my Agreement to Sell and Receipt executed on 25.03.1974 by Girja Ram Bhatia in favour of Kahariti Lal & Kharaiti Lal and Agreement to Sell and Receipt executed on 30.04.1974 by Kahariti Lal in favour of Manohar Lal both W.R.T. Property No 220, New Layal Pur Colony, Delhi-110051. Finders may contact at above address.

0040881943-2

I, Pinki Chhari W/o Vinod Kumar Chhari R/o Flat No G 0703 Park Avenue Block G2 Plot GH 01 Greater Noida West have lost my Allotment Letter Flat No. G-0703, Park Avenue, Block-G2, OF Plot No. GH 01, Gaur City 1, Sector 04, Greater Noida West, G.B Nagar, U.P

0071064132-1

I, Raj Kumari, W/o- Late Ravinder Kumar, R/O.-A-60, Vikas Kunj, Loni, Dehat Gaziabad, U.P.-201102, declare that have lost last page, of conveyance deed registered on, 31/10/2007, SR-VII, Delhi of DDA, Flat No.-392, IIInd Floor, Pocket-9, Phase-1, Nasirpur, Dwarka, Delhi in favour of me and my husband Late Ravinder Kumar.

0040882048-9

I, Raj Kumar Garg, S/o- Dharampal Garg, have lost my allotment letter Property Papers of 1222, Neelkanth Appt. Sec-13, Rohini, Delhi-110085, Finder Contact: 9212000687

0040882081-9

PUBLIC NOTICE

सर्वजनिक सूचना
श्रीमती कुमारी प



POST GRADUATE INSTITUTE OF MEDICAL EDUCATION & RESEARCH CHANDIGARH

E-Tender Notice No. PJE/EP/26-27/01

Tender applications are invited for purchase of various items against E-tender No. 1-10 from the Manufacturers or their sole authorized distributors/agents. The bidders can place their bids as per terms & conditions contained at <https://eprocure.gov.in/eprocure/app>.

Phone No. 0172-2756469

S. No	Equipment/Item Name	Qty.	EMD (Rs.)	Bid submission Date	Bid Opening Date	Deptt Name
Non-Pre Bid case						
1	Q/LF System	03Nos	Rs. 1,00,000/-	21-10-2026	22-10-2026	OHSC
2	Dental Air Rotor Lubricating Machine	07 Nos	Rs. 70,000/-	-do-	-do-	OHSC
3	Transport Ventilators	04Nos	Rs. 80,000/-	-do-	-do-	Pediatrics Medicine
4	Complete Shockwave Therapy System	01No	Rs. 96,000/-	22-10-2026	23-10-2026	Physiotherapy
5	Indirect Colorimeter (Buy Back)	01No.	Rs. 80,000/-	-do-	-do-	Pediatrics Medicine
6	Lower Tract Endoscopy Set	01No.	Rs. 80,000/-	-do-	-do-	Urology
Pre Bid case						
7	Laser Capture Micro Dissection	01No.	Rs. 4,00,000/-	26-10-2026	27-10-2026	Histopathology
8	Fully Automated Immunoassay: Enzyme Linked Fluorescent Assay (ELFA)/Chemiluminescence enzyme Immunoassay (CLEIA)/Electrochemiluminescence Immunoassay (ECLIA)	01No.	Rs. 3,00,000/-	-do-	-do-	Pediatrics Medicine
9	Lower Tract Endoscopy Set for Emg. OT	01No.	Rs. 1,58,000/-	-do-	-do-	Urology
10	Lower Tract Endoscopy Set for TURP, TURBT, OIU, Cystoscopy	01 Set	Rs. 1,98,000/-	-do-	-do-	Urology

Tender document can also be downloaded from website www.pgimer.edu.in and can be applied on website www.eprocure.gov.in. Bid Security (EMD) should be for the amount as per the instruments defined in tender documents having its validity at least for one year & duly pledged in favour of Postgraduate Institute of Medical Education and Research, Chandigarh. The tenders will be opened on the dates given above at 12:00 PM in the presence of the authorized intending tenders. Tenders not submitted on the prescribed form, not accompanied with Bid Security shall be summarily rejected. The undersigned reserves the right to accept or reject any or all the tenders received without assigning any reason thereof. **"PRE-BID CONFERENCE" WITH INTENDING BIDDERS FOR ITEM Ss. No. 07 to 10 shall be held on 07.10.2026 from 02:30 PM. ONWARDS in THE PJE/EP, OFFICE, PGIMER, CHANDIGARH.** The intending bidders are free to join Prebid Conference through video conference. For more details contact: 0172-2756469 at Procurement Branch (Import).

NOTE 1. The terms and Conditions of the original Notice Inviting Tender (NTI) available on PGIMER Website will remain same. However on switching over to e-tendering on e-Procurement, the bids will be received in electronic form or e-Procurement website and no bid will be received in Physical form. The EMD will be received in Physical form in Procurement Branch (Import) and scan copy is to be uploaded in electronic form on e-procurement website, CPPP Portal (Central Public Procurement Portal)

NOTE 2. If any of the tender opening dates happens to be a holiday in PGIMER, Chandigarh, then the same shall be opened on next full working day.

Additional Terms and Conditions.



OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER

PWD (R&B) DIVISION NAGROTA

SHORT NOTICE INVITING TENDER

Short e-NIT No. 81 of 2026-2027/Nagrota Dated 05.10.2026

For and on behalf of the Lieutenant Governor, Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir e-tenders are invited on percentage basis from approved and eligible Contractors registered with Union Territory of J&K, CPWD, Railways, MES and other State/Central Governments for each of the following works :-

S. No	Name of Work	Name of Division	Advertised cost (Rs. In lakh.)	Cost of document (In Rs.)	Earnest Money (In Rs.)	Time allowed for completion	Time and date of opening of tender	Class of Contractor
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
1.	Upgradation/Renovation of Dalh Bungalow at Surinsar, Jammu.	PWD (R&B) Division Nagrota	150.00	3000	2% of Advertised Cost	06 Months	(1300 Hrs) on or after 15-10-2026	A Class
2.	Stage Contract for Day Mastr/General Upkeeping during the Financial Year 2026-26 Upto March 2026 of Old National Highway.	PWD (R&B) Division Nagrota	4.99	600	2% of Advertised Cost	Upto March 2027	(1300 Hrs) on or after 15-10-2026	A,B,C&D Class
3.	Construction of 4 Nos ACRs At GHS Kanyala (Under Capex Budget 2026-27)	PWD (R&B) Division Nagrota	90.61	1500	2% of Advertised Cost	046 Months	(1300 Hrs) on or after 15-10-2026	A Class

Position of AAA : Accorded.

The Bidding documents Consisting of qualifying information, eligibility criteria, specifications, Drawings, bill of quantities (B.O.Q), Set of terms and conditions of contract and other details can be seen/downloaded from the departmental website <http://jktenders.gov.in> as per below schedule :-

1 Date of Issue of Tender Notice	05.10.2026
2 Period of downloading of bidding documents	From 06.10.2026 to 14.10.2026 upto 1800 Hrs
3 Date, Time and place of pre-bid meeting	XXXXXXXXX at XXXXX Hrs. in the Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division Nagrota
4 Bid submission Start Date	06.10.2026
5 Bid Submission End Date	14.10.2026 upto 1800 Hrs
6 Date & time of opening of Technical Bids (Online)	15.10.2026 on or after 1300 Hrs in the Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division Nagrota
7 Date & time of opening of Financial Bids (Online)	To be notified after technical bid evaluation is completed

No. EE/ND/2026-27/7063-72

Dated :- 05.10.2026

DIP No. DIP/J-11804/26-DATE 06.10.2026

Sd/-

Executive Engineer

PWD (R&B) Division

Nagrota

নিবন্ধ

জনা জয় জোড়, বারাসাচ, উত্তর ২৪ পরগণা
 নিমি (একটি হাট) নং ৮১/২০০৫

নবাবজাহাঙ্গীর : শ্রীমতী ব্রজ কুমার, বিদ্যা
 অনিন্দ বসু, নার-রসকবচান, বন্যাবশ
 ছি আই পি জেড, এমআরপি, নার
 বাক্তাইয়া, রাজাবাহাঙ্গী, জেলা উত্তর ২৪
 পর্ণণা, কাকোতা ৭৪০০০২, পশ্চিমবঙ্গ
 বিবাদী : শ্রী মিলি কুমার বসু, পিতা -
 অনিন্দ কুমার বসু, নার - ৭০০, নার
 কলসায়ী, মাদার কলসায়ী এর নিকটে, অগ্রা
 সাদা মিডলি, পি. ১০০০৪৪

এমআরপি সনসারকবচ জ্ঞানোনা যাচ্ছে
 এমআরপি নারনিকা "যা হাট" জ্ঞান
 এমআরপি হাট হাটের জনা উক্ত নার
 হাটের নার এতে নার কোনো জ্ঞান
 জ্ঞান প্রকাশে ৩০ দিনের মধ্যে তা জ্ঞান
 মিলি কবচ, অন্যথায় অনিন্দ কবচের

অনুমতিপূর্বক
 সন্যাসীনা পি, সেরেস্তা
 জেলা জজ কোর্ট বারাসাচ
 উত্তর ২৪ পরগণা

OFFICE of the Executive Engineer Mechanical Division bhep,Chanderkote <u>GIST OF e-TENDER NOTICE</u>				
For and on behalf of Managing Director JKPDC, e-tenders are invited from Reputed Firms/Contractors having relevant experience for the below mentioned work:				
S. No	Name of Work	e-NIT No. & Date	Due Date	Tenders receiving Authority
1.	SITC of new booster pump (2 no along with motors and valves and accessories and GI pipeline from ventilation tunnel to collection gallery approximate length 400 mtrs at BHEP-I.	19-MECH of 2026-27 Dated 05-10-2026	27-10-2026 at 16:00 Hrs	Executive Engineer, Mechanical Division, BHEP, Chanderkote

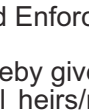
For details of work, terms and conditions and any other clarifications, kindly visit www.jktenders.gov.in, you can also contact the Office of the undersigned on any working day up to 27.10.2026 till 14:00 Hrs.

**Executive Engineer,
Mechanical Division,
BHEP, Chanderkote.**

DIP NO. : DIP/IJ-2447-P/26 DATE 06.10.2026

रजिस्ट्री सं.डी. एल - 33004/99	 भारत का राजपत्र The Gazette of India सी.जी.-डी.एल.-अ.-01102026-276686 CG-DL-E-01102026-276686 असाधारण EXTRAORDINARY भाग II--खण्ड 3- उप-खण्ड(ii) PART II--Section 3- Sub-section(ii) प्राधिकार से प्रकाशित PUBLISHED BY AUTHORITY	REGD. No. D.L.- 33004/99
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सं. 4940] No. 4940]	नई दिल्ली, शुक्रवार, सितम्बर 18, 2026/भाद्र 27, 1948 NEW DELHI, FRIDAY, SEPTEMBER 18, 2026/BHADRA 27, 1948 सड़क परिवहन और राजमार्ग मंत्रालय अधिसूचना नई दिल्ली, 18 सितम्बर 2026
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AXIS FINANCE

AXIS FINANCE LIMITED

(CIN U65921MH1995PLC212675)

Axis House, C-2, Wadia International Centre, Pandurang Budhkar Marg, Worli, Mumbai - 400 025

NOTICE FOR SALE OF IMMOVABLE PROPERTY
(Under Rule 8(6) read with Rule 9(1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002)

E-Auction Notice of **30 days** for Sale of Immovable Assets under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with Rule 8(6) and Rule 9(1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002

Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the below mentioned Borrower and/ Co- Borrower, or their legal heirs/representatives (Borrowers) that the below described immovable property mortgaged to Axis Finance Ltd. (AFL), the Possession of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of AFL, will be sold on **13-11-2026** on "As is where is" & "As is what is" and "Whatever there is" and without any recourse basis" for recovery of outstanding dues from below mentioned Borrower and Co-Borrowers. The Reserve Price and the Earnest Money Deposit is mentioned below. Notice is hereby given that, in the absence of any postponement/ discontinuance of the sale, the said secured asset / property shall be sold by E- Auction from 11:00 AM on the said **13-11-2026**. The sealed envelope containing Demand Draft of EMD for participating in E- Auction shall be submitted to the Authorised Officer of the AFL on or before **11-11-2026** till 4.00 PM.

The sale of the Secured Asset/ Immovable Property will be on "as is where condition is" as per brief particulars described herein below;

Sr. No	Name of Borrower(s) / Co-borrower(s) / Legal Heir(s) / Legal Representative/ Guarantor(s)	Date of Demand Notice and amount mentioned in demand notice	Type of possession	Reserve Price	Outstanding as on 04.06.2026
1.	Tanpreet Singh, Tera Hi Tera Pharma & Davinder Kaur	03.07.2026 INR. 2,37,32,153/- (Rupees Two Crores Thirty Seven Lakhs Thirty Two Thousand One Hundred and Fifty Three Only) as on 05.06.2026	Symbolic	INR. 3,60,80,640/- (Rupees Three Crores Sixty Lakhs Eighty Thousand Six Hundred and Forty)	Rs. 2,46,37,950/- (Rupees Two Crores Forty Six Lakhs Thirty Seven Thousand and Nine Hundred and Fifty Only) due as on 06.10.2026
GROUND FLOOR RHS AND ENTIRE FIRST FLOOR WITHOUT ROOF RIGHTS, BUILT UP ON PROPERTY BEARING NO. B-1/34 LAND AREA MEASURING 200 SQ. YDS. SITUATED AT LAJPAT NAGAR NEW DELHI - 110024 THE PROPERTY IS BOUNDED AS UNDER:- EAST – PORTION OF PROPERTY NO. B-1/34 WEST – SIDE ROAD NORTH – ROAD SOUTH – SHOP BEARING PRIVATE NO. 2					

Note :- The bidders are advised to conduct due diligence before submitting the bid. The auction shall be subject to the outcome of the litigation, Dispute if any

At the Auction, the public generally is invited to submit their bid(s) personally. No officer or other person, having any duty to perform in connection with this sale shall, however, directly or indirectly bid for, acquire or attempt to acquire any interest in the Immovable Property sold.

The sale shall be subject to the conditions prescribed in the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 and the terms and conditions prescribed.

The E-auction of the properties will take place through portal <https://sarfaesi.auctiontiger.net/EPROC/> on **13.11.2026 11:00 a.m. onwards**. For further details please refer to the notice published in the newspapers and at website: www.axisfinance.com.

Contact Person Details & Mob. Nos.:
Mr. Ashish Dhawan : 919899970571
Place:- New Delhi

Sd/-
Authorised Officer
Axis Finance Ltd.

Registered Address: At C-2, Wadia International Centre, Pandurang Budhkar Marg, Worli, Mumbai-400025.
CIN No. U65921MH1995PLC212675.

	GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA OFFICE OF THE SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER R.W.S&S DIVISION, SAMBALPUR. E.mail- eerwsssbp@gmail.com
“e” PROCUREMENT NOTICE Bid Identification No. RWSS (SBP):- 08/2026-27	
1. Name of the Work	: Execution of RPWS Scheme to left out village 1) Banmal, 2) Nunvet, 3) Badalundeswar, 4) Sarenci & Balaram, 5) Budhikuntum and 6) Kundankhol out Jamsankira block of Sambalpur District.
2. Total Number of Work	: 06 Nos. (Six)
3. Estimated Cost	: Rs. 91.76 Lakhs to Rs. 131.19 Lakhs
4. Class of contractor	: B & A
5. Period of Completion	: Nine Months

Procurement Officer	Bid Identification No	Availability of tender online for bidding	
		From	To
1	2	3	4
Superintending Engineer RWSS Division Sambalpur	RWSS (SBP) :- 08/2026-27	08.10.2026	up to 5.00 PM of 23.10.2026

Further details can be seen from the e-procurement portal "www.tendersodisha.gov.in" Subsequent corrigendum if required shall be appeared in the website only.

Sd/-
Superintending Engineer,
R.W.S&S. Division, Sambalpur.

OIPR-25001/25015/1/26-27/0006

का.आ- 5146(E)(अ) केन्द्रीय सरकार ने, राष्ट्रीय राजमार्ग अन्वयित, 1956 (1956 का 48) (जिसे इसमें इसके पश्चात् उक्त अधिनियम कहा गया है) की धारा 3क की उपधारा (1) के अधीन जारी की गई भारत सरकार के सड़क परिवहन और राजमार्ग मंत्रालय की अधिसूचना संख्या का.आ 3561 (E) तारीख 1 July 2026, जो भारत के राजपत्र, असाधारण, भाग II, खण्ड 3, उपखंड (ii) में प्रकाशित की गई थी, द्वारा उत्तर प्रदेश राज्य के मथुरा जिले के गाँव-तालुक-छाता और गाँव- जहांगीरपुर खादर, तालुक-मांट और गाँव- आटस खादर, तालुक-सदर में NH 44 के कि.मी. 0 से कि.मी. 15.34 तक के भूखण्ड पर टोल प्लाज के निर्माण, अनुसूचन, प्रबंधन और प्रचालन के लिए उस अधिसूचना से उपानुद्ध अनुसूची में विनिर्दिष्ट भूमि का अर्जन करने के अपने आशय की घोषणा की थी और उक्त अधिसूचना का सार उक्त अधिनियम की धारा 3क की उपधारा (3) के अधीन तारीख 09.07.2026 को 'दैनिक जागरण (हिंदी)' और 'द इंडियन एक्सप्रेस' (अंग्रेजी) दोनों में प्रकाशित किया गया था, जबकि सक्षम प्राधिकारी की धारा 3-ग के तहत दायर आपत्ति प्राप्त हुई है, जिस पर विचार किया गया है और उसका उचित रूप से निपटारा किया गया है। और सक्षम प्राधिकारी ने उक्त अधिनियम की धारा 3क की उपधारा (1) के अनुसूचन में, केन्द्रीय सरकार को अपनी रिपोर्ट दे दी है, अतः अब, केन्द्रीय सरकार, सक्षम प्राधिकारी की उक्त रिपोर्ट प्राप्त हो जाने पर और उक्त अधिनियम की धारा 3क की उपधारा (1) द्वारा प्रदत्त शक्तियों का प्रयोग करते हुए, यह घोषणा करती है कि उक्त अनुसूची में विनिर्दिष्ट भूमि का पूर्वोक्त प्रयोजन के लिए अर्जन किया जाना चाहिए और अब केन्द्रीय सरकार धारा 3क की उपधारा (2) के अनुसूचन में यह घोषणा करती है कि इस अधिसूचना के राजपत्र में प्रकाशन पर उक्त अनुसूची में विनिर्दिष्ट भूमि सभी विलिंगमों से मुक्त होकर केन्द्रीय सरकार में निहित हो जाएगी।

अनुसूची

उत्तर प्रदेश राज्य के मथुरा जिले के गाँव- तालुक-छाता और गाँव- जहांगीरपुर खादर, तालुक-मांट और गाँव- आटस खादर, तालुक-सदर में NH44 के कि.मी. 0 से कि.मी. 15.34 के लिए अर्जन की जाने वाली संरचना सहित अथवा संरचना रहित विवरण। 7170G/2026

फाइल नंबर: CE-RO/LKO/NH-19/2024-25/754/3D
शेख अमीन खान, निदेशक

जिला: मथुरा, <https://egazette.gov.in>, प्रकाशन तिथि: 18/09/2026, <https://egazette.gov.in>, <https://bhoomirashi.gov.in>

नोट: इस अधिसूचना की वास्तविक प्रति सीएलएल/पीआईएल/पीएमयू/आरओ/ईडी के कार्यालय में भी उपलब्ध है और भूमि मालिक वहां भी अधिसूचना देख सकते हैं।

MINISTRY OF ROAD TRANSPORT AND HIGHWAYS
Notification
New Delhi, the 18 September 2026

S.O. 5146(E) (E). Whereas by the notification of the Government of India in the Extraordinary, S.O. 3561(E) Dated: 1 July 2026 published in Gazette of India, Extraordinary, Part II, Section 3, Sub-section (ii) issued under sub-section (1) of section 3A of the National Highway Act, 1956 (48 of 1956) (hereinafter referred to as the said Act), the Central Government declared its intention to acquire the land specified in the Schedule annexed to the said notification for building (widening /four-laning, etc.), maintenance, management and operation of NH44 in the stretch of land from Km. 0 to Km. 15.34 in the village(s) namely- Taluk- Chhata and in the village(s) namely- Jahangirpur Khadar Taluk- Mant and in the village(s) namely- Atas Khadar Taluk- sadar in the district of MATHURA in the state of UTTAR PRADESH And whereas the substance of the said notification has been published in "Dainik Jagaran (Hindi)" and "The Indian Express(English)" both dated 09/07/2026 under sub-section (3) of section 3A of the said Act; And whereas the Competent Authority has received objections filed under Section 3-C, considered and settled the same appropriately; And whereas, in pursuance of sub-section (1) of section 3D of the said Act, the Competent Authority has submitted its report to the Central Government; Now, therefore, upon receipt of the said report of the Competent Authority and in exercise of the powers conferred by the sub-section (1) of section 3D of the said Act, the Central Government hereby declares that the land specified in the said Schedule should be acquired for the aforesaid purpose; And further, in pursuance of sub-section (2) of section 3D of the said Act, the Central Government hereby declares that on publication of this notification in the Official Gazette, the land specified in the said Schedule shall vest absolutely in the Central Government, free from all encumbrances.

SCHEDULE

Brief Description of the land to be acquired with or without structures falling NH44 in the stretch of land from Km. 0 to Km. 15.34 in the village(s) namely- Taluk-Chhata and in the village(s) namely- Jahangirpur Khadar Taluk-Mant and in the village(s) namely- Atas Khadar Taluk-sadar in the district of MATHURA in the state of UTTAR PRADESH 7170G/2026)

File Number: CE-RO/LKO/NH-19/2024-25/754/3D
Shaikh Amin Khan , Director.
District: MATHURA, <https://egazette.gov.in>, Publication Date: 18/09/2026
<https://egazette.gov.in>, <https://bhoomirashi.gov.in>

Note : The physical copy of this notification is also available at the office of
CALA/PIU/PMU/RO/ED and Landowners may also see the notification there.

पत्रांक 485/12/डी०, दिनांक 5.10.2026

कार्यालय मेलाधिकारी, कुम्भ मेला-2027, हरिद्वार।

फोन नं० 01334-224457

Email: procure.kumbhmela2027@gmail.com

Letter No-1522/Km/2027

Date-06/10/2026

मेलाधिकारी, कुम्भ मेला 2027, हरिद्वार द्वारा निम्नलिखित कार्य हेतु ई-टेंडरिंग (ट्रेंडिंग सिस्टम) के अन्तर्गत निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है। निविदा से सम्बन्धित सभी सूचना <https://uktenders.gov.in> पर दिनांक 07.10.2026 से उपलब्ध होगी। कार्य का विवरण निम्नानुसार है:-

- Selection of Service Provider to operate and Maintain core Parking Developed at Identified Locations during Kumbh Mela-2027.
- Selection Of Service Provider for Development, Operation and Maintenance of Temporary Way Side Amenities and Parking Infrastructure in The Identified Peripheral Land Units During Kumbh Mela 2027 In Haridwar
- Providing Liability and Accidental Insurance Coverage during Kumbh Mela 2027.

ई-निविदा की विस्तृत शर्तें एवं ई-निविदा प्रपत्र वेबसाइट www.uktenders.gov.in पर उपलब्ध है।

उप मेलाधिकारी,
कुम्भ मेला-2027, हरिद्वार

**PUNJAB STATE POWER CORPORATION LTD.**
(Regd. Office: PSEB Head Office, The Mall, Patiala-147001)
Corporate Identity Number U410PB2010SGC33813
Website www.pspcl.in, Contact No. -919646107151

Tender Enquiry No. 694/GHTP/EMCS/GMC-WA/Vol-40 Dated: 05/10/2026
Superintending Engineer, Elect. Mtc. Circle, O&M. GHTP, Lehra Mohabbat invites E-Tender for the supply of manpower, T&P, consumables and transportation for periodical, preventive, breakdown & shutdown maintenance and annual overhauling of 6.6KV & 415V AC Switchgears, 220V & 24V DC power supply systems. ESP Control Panels and other local control panels and associated equipments, battery banks, battery chargers, local push button stations and power receptacles, HT & LT Power and control cables installed at various locations under Switchgear Mtc. Cell of 2X210MW Stage-I and 2X250MW Stage-II, Guru Hargobind Thermal Plant, Lehra Mohabbat, District Bathinda, Punjab as per details given in the tender specifications for a period of six months. For detailed NIT & tender specifications, please refer to <https://eproc.punjab.gov.in> from //2026, 11:00AM onwards.
Note: Corrigendum and addendum, if any, will be published online at <https://eproc.punjab.gov.in>
No. 15909/PB GHTP-76/26

**कार्यपालक अभियन्ता का कार्यालय**
जलपथ प्रमण्डल, चाईबासा

शुद्धि-पत्र
ई० निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना संख्या- 01EE/WRD/WWD/CBSA/F2-01/26-27 पी.आर संख्या- 390068 (West Singhbhum) 26-27 D है, के माध्यम से प्रकाशित की गई को निम्न प्रकार संशोधित किया जाता है:-

विवरण	पूर्व की तिथि	संशोधित तिथि
वेबसाइट पर निविदा प्रकाशन की तिथि एवं समय	08.10.2026 के 03:00 बजे पूर्वह्न।	28.10.2026 के 11:00 बजे पूर्वह्न।
निविदा में भाग लेने की अंतिम तिथि एवं समय	21.10.2026 अपराह्न 03:00 बजे तक।	03.11.2026 अपराह्न 03:00 बजे तक
निविदा खोलने की तिथि एवं समय	22.10.2026 को 05:00 बजे अपराह्न।	05.11.2026 को 11:00 बजे पूर्वह्न।

अन्य सभी शर्तें पूर्ववत् रहेगी।

कार्यपालक अभियन्ता
PR 391176 West Singhbhum (26-27)_D जलपथ प्रमण्डल, चाईबासा

**GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE**

Sr. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	GHDA,GURUGRAH	SUPPLY, INSTALLATION AND COMMISSIONING OF RETROFIT EMERGENCY CONTROL DEVICE (RECED) FOR 0.4 SET OF CAPACITY 160 KVA AT TEMPORARY DISPOSAL, SECTOR - 65/06 AND 400 KVA AND 308 KVA AT STPS BEHRAMPUR, GURUGRAH AND ALL OTHER WORKS CONTINGENT THEREON, INCLUDING 1 YEAR DEFECT LIABILITY PERIOD FREE OF COST)	05.10.2026 15.10.2026	68,44,000/-	https://www.ghda.gov.in	9541281407 senbhatia.ghda@gmail.com
2	GHDA,GURUGRAH	SUPPLY, ERECTION, TESTING AND COMMISSIONING OF SEWAGE SUSPENSION PUMP OF CAPACITY 300 HP (2 NOS) AND 125 HP (3 NOS) AND 2 NO. 3200 AMP ACS WITH ALUMINIUM ANCHORED CABLE AT 168 PWD MPS IN SEC. -9A, GURUGRAH INCLUDING 1 YEAR DEFECT LIABILITY PERIOD FREE OF COST.	01.10.2026 12.10.2026	1,47,21,241/-	https://www.ghda.gov.in	977972790 senbhatia.ghda@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in

No. 49973/HRY

**GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE**

Sr. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	CHBNV	SUPPLY OF MATERIAL, ERECTION, TESTING & COMMISSIONING OF 33 KV FEEDER TO PWS HSEDC FOR GLOBAL CITY PROJECT FROM 220 KV SUB-STATION, SECTOR 85, GURUGRAH UNDER OPERATION CIRCLE-1, DHRIWAL, GURUGRAH ON TURKEY BASIS AGAINST TENDER ENQUIRY NO. TSGP-63/2026-27.	03.10.2026 27.10.2026	4.54 CRORES	www.chbvn.org.in	7840087603 SESHARTICITY@CHBVN.ORG.IN
2	CHBNV	SUPPLY OF MATERIAL, ERECTION, TESTING & COMMISSIONING OF 33 KV FEEDER TO PWS HSEDC FOR SECTOR 80 FROM 220 KV SUBSTATION, SECTOR 89, GURUGRAH UNDER OPERATION CIRCLE-1, DHRIWAL, GURUGRAH ON TURKEY BASIS AGAINST TENDER ENQUIRY NO. TSGP-63/2026-27.	03.10.2026 27.10.2026	14.11 CRORES	www.chbvn.org.in	7840087603 SESHARTICITY@CHBVN.ORG.IN

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in

No. 49955/HRY

**GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE**

Sr No	NAME OF DEPARTMENT	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE DEPARTMENT	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	PWD BAR, FATEHABAD	IMPROVEMENT OF ROAD FROM BEGHAR TO FATEHABAD BHATTU ROAD VIA. BANBARAN KVI. 1.19 TO 3.12 AND 4.20 TO 7.40 (ROAD ID 9046 AND 5601) IN FATEHABAD DISTT. UNDER NABARD SCHEME WITHOUT GST + 3 WORKS	05.10.2026 15.10.2026	1908.04 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	91667-220120 pawd-esp@fatehabad@hry.nic.in
2	PWD BAR, FATEHABAD	IMPROVEMENT OF ROAD FROM JARHAL DHARSLU ROAD TO KALJA VIA SADHANWAS SIDHANI KM 0.33 TO 7.10 AND 8.40 TO 10.00 BY WGL AND STG. AND PBI (ROAD ID 5325 AND 5649) IN FATEHABAD DISTT (UNDER NABARD SCHEME RBP-30501) WITHOUT GST + 3 WORKS	05.10.2026 21.10.2026	2121.37 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	91667-220120 pawd-esp@fatehabad@hry.nic.in
3	IRRIGATION & WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT HARYANA, FATEHABAD	REPAIR OF DAMAGED LIVING PATCHES OF FATEHABAD BRANCH FROM RD -16040B-21999A	CLOSING DATE 12.10.2026	33.48 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9466713154 www.waterresources@hry.nic.in

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT www.etenders.hry.nic.in

No. 49961/HRY

**TAMIL NADU LIVESTOCK DEVELOPMENT CORPORATION**
IV Floor, Integrated Office Complex for Animal Husbandry and Fisheries Department, 571, Anna Salai, Saidapet Veterinary Polyclinic Campus, Nandanam P.O., Chennai-35. e-mail: tnlida2016@gmail.com

e-TENDER NOTICE
E-Tenders are invited from eligible tenderers online through <https://tntenders.gov.in> for the following item under "Two part System"

e-tender Ref No	Name of the Item	Total quantity	Last date for the submission of tenders
2026/85	Bluetongue Vaccine, Inactivated – Multivalent, Adjuvanted, for Veterinary Use	2,48,400 doses	29.10.2026-11.00 am
2026/86	Supply of customised Mobile Veterinary Units to the Department of Animal Husbandry	100 Nos.	6.11.2026-11.00 am
2026/87	Supply of customised Mobile Veterinary Units -four-wheel drive to the Department of Animal Husbandry	43 Nos.	6.11.2026-11.00 am
2026/88	Stereo zoom microscope	1 No.	29.10.2026-11.00 am
2026/89	Transportable mixed gas incubator	1 No.	29.10.2026-11.00 am

Individual tender documents with full details can be downloaded free of cost from <https://tntenders.gov.in> up to the last date and time of submission of tenders as indicated above.
Corrigendum/Addendum to this publication, if any, would appear only on the above website
DIPR/3047/TENDER/2026

Chief Executive Officer

**JHARKHAND STATE FACULTY DEVELOPMENT ACADEMY**
(CIN: U85500JH2025NPL024352)
Regd. Office:- 2nd Floor, JCSTI, Coordinating Building, Namkum, Ranchi 834101, Jharkhand | Email- jsfda2025@gmail.com
Letter No. JSFDA/estb-02/2025-264 Ranchi/Dated 28.09.2026

Deputation Notice
The Department of Higher and Technical Education, Government of Jharkhand, has established **Jharkhand State Faculty Development Academy (JSFDA)** as a Section 8 company of the Companies Act 2013 under Jharkhand State Higher Education Council (JSHEC) to build the capacity of teachers, officers, staff, Academic leaders, support staff and students of Higher and Technical Education Institutions of Jharkhand. The academy will act as a facilitator for reforms in higher education, the formulation of policies and schemes, the monitoring and evaluation of schemes, and any other work assigned by the Department of Higher and Technical Education.
The Jharkhand State Faculty Development Academy (JSFDA) invites applications from suitable officers for deputation to various posts to support its vision and objectives.
Applications are invited from eligible candidates in the prescribed format for rendering services to the positions as detailed and described below:-

Sl. No.	Name of the Post	No. of Post	Qualification & Experience
A	B	C	D
1.	Joint Director	01	Professor in State Public University/ Constituent College
	General Manager, Academics, Training and Outreach	01	Associate Professor in a State Public University/ Constituent College.
3.	Centre Coordinators	02	Assistant Professor in a State Public University/ Constituent College with 4 years of teaching experience.

- Qualification and Experience:**
 - As per column 'D' of the table indicated above.
- Mode of Recruitment:**
 - Based on the Interview.
- Terms of Engagement:**
 - For the posts mentioned above, the deputation period will be of 03 years from the date of appointment. However, deputation may be extended based on satisfactory performance.
 - During the deputation period, salary, etc., will be provided by the parent institution.
- Mode of Application:**
 - Interested candidates may apply to the above mentioned posts through the official recruitment portal of JSFDA (<https://recruitment.jsfda.ac.in>) along with all required certificates. The last date of submitting the online applications is 21.10.2026.
 - All self-certified supporting documents in terms of qualifications, Work Experience etc. must be attached along with the application.
 - The list of shortlisted candidates will be uploaded on the website <https://jsfda.ac.in>.
 - The shortlisted candidates would be called for a personal interview in Ranchi. The date and time shall be separately communicated through email.
 - No claim shall be admissible in the case of transport and logistics.
 - JSFDA reserves the right to cancel or postpone this deputation notice at any time.

Sd/-
(Sudhir Bara) Executive Director, JSFDA

PR 391162 Higher Education Directorate (26-27 D)

**POSTGRADUATE INSTITUTE OF MEDICAL EDUCATION & RESEARCH, CHANDIGARH**
CORRIGENDUM
Tender inquiry No.407 due on 08.10.2026
Website: www.pgimer.edu.in and www.eprocure.gov.in

The tender inquiry No.407 due on 08.10.2026 issued vide No. Proc. Indga. (HPD)/2026/407 is hereby extended upto 22.10.2026 at 12.30 PM due to certain modifications in the specifications of the tender documents. For further details and the revised specifications of the tender documents, which will be uploaded on the websites after 06.10.2026, bidders are requested to visit the official websites www.pgimer.edu.in and www.eprocure.gov.in
Officer In-charge (HPD)

**Tamil Nadu Power Distribution Corporation Ltd.**
Notice Inviting Tenders (E-Tendering Process)
SHORT/ PP-45/2026-2027
TNPDCL invites E-Tender for Emergency procurement of power of 1500MW during morning peak hours (00 - 02 hrs) and 3000MW for evening peak hours (18-24 hrs) for the period from 12.10.2026 to 31.10.2026 from both Interstate and Intrastate generators on firm basis from CERC/TNERC approved Traders/ Generators. Bidding will be done as per the revised guidelines for short term procurement of power notified by the Ministry of Power vide resolution dated 30.03.2016 and as per amendments dated:21.02.2022 through e-Bidding portal (DEEP) only and subsequent amendments thereof are applicable to this tender specification. The link for the e-Bidding portal is www.mstcecommerce.com and is also available on the website of Ministry of Power (www.powermin.nic.in) and PFC Consulting Ltd (www.pfcindia.com). Specification is available in TNPDCL website and MSTC DEEP E-Bidding portal. Sd..06.10.26
DIPR/3041/Tender/2026 Chief Engineer/PPP, TNPDCL

**AP POWER GENERATION CORPORATION Ltd.,**
VS, VIJAYAWADA - 520004
(A Govt. of A.P. Undertaking)
NIT No.-01/CE/Civil/Thermal/APGENCO/2026-27 Tender ID.No.990288
Name of the work: "Dr. NTPPS Stage-V (1X800MW) Township Providing Civil works for installation of additional lifts at E&F type blocks at Dr.NTPPS, Ibrahimpatnam" through e-procurement.
Schedule available Date & Time : 06.10.2026-10.00 AM onwards
Bid submission Closing Date & Time: 14.10.2026 - 03.00 PM
For other details visit the website, viz: <https://tender.approcurement.gov.in>
Contact No: (0866) 2526813,2526432
R.No.- 5482PP/CL/ADVT/1/1/2021-22 Dt: 06.10.2026

**Government of Jharkhand**
Department of Mines & Geology
Directorate of Geology
Engineer's Hostel No-2,
2nd Floor, Dhurwa, Ranchi
CORRIGENDUM
Short Tender Notice No. 02/2026-27 was published on 20.09.2026 in different News Papers vide PR. No.- 390083. The following changes are hereby made in the said tender:-

Sl.No.	Particulars	
1	Last date of submission of Bid/NIT	13.10.2026 till 3.00 P.M.
2	Bid/NIT opening date	13.10.2026 at 4.00 P.M.

All other terms and conditions of the above-mentioned NIT shall remain unchanged. All prospective bidders are advised to visit the official website of the Government of Jharkhand, www.jharkhand.gov.in, for further updates and to submit their bids accordingly.

Sd/-
Directorate of Geology,
Department of Mines & Geology,
Government of Jharkhand.
PR 391211 Mines and Geology (26-27) D"

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.PC.
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Saurabh Jindal, S/o: Purushottam Jindal, R/o: D-17/297, Sec-3, Rohini (Prop. of M/s Tejaswini Packaging), Plot-9, Block-I, Sector-1, DSIIIC Industrial Area Bawana, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **CT Case/ CC NI Act: 4368/2023, U/s: 138 NI ACT, P.S. Punjabi Bagh, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Saurabh Jindal** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Saurabh Jindal** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Saurabh Jindal of P.S. Punjabi Bagh, New Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **17.11.2026**.
By Order
Sh. Gaurav Singal
JMFC (West) NI Act, Room No. 04, Annexe-1,
DP/14207/WD/2026 Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

Government of Rajasthan
Office of the DSO Chittorgarh
Email:- dsfood-chi-rj@nic.in Phone No.: 01472-240951
F0/PDS/Tender/2026-27/ Date: 29.09.2026
NOTICE INVITING BID
e-Bids for selection of Handling and Transportation of Food grains Under PDS from FCI Depots in District Chittorgarh are invited from interested bidders up to 26.10.2026 up to 06:00 PM. Other particulars of the bid may be visited on the procurement portal <http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in> or <http://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in> of the state, The approximate value of the procurement is Rupees 3.9 Crore for One year.
NIB No.: FCC2627A0115
UBN No. :- FCC2627SLOB00117
Sd/-
District Supply Officer
Chittorgarh
DIPR/C/17081/2026

**भारतीय कंटेनर निगम लिमिटेड**
CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA LTD.
(एक सार्वजनिक व निर्यात निगम) (A Navratna Undertaking of Govt. of India)
Open Tender Notice (e-Tendering mode only)
Online E-bids are invited for Supply, Installation, Testing & Commissioning (SITC) 17 nos. of Automatic Fire Suppression System in (MAKE: TIL HYSTER) Reach Stackers in different terminals of CONCOR in Two Bid tendering system through e-tendering mode.

Bid Reference	Tender No. : CONNSIUC/TECHIAFSS/2026
Tendered Quantity	17 Nos.
Estimated Cost	Rs. 44,19,619/- (Inclusive of GST)
Earnest Money Deposit (EMD)*	₹ 88,392/- As per Clause 3 of Section-II (through online payment gateway to CONCOR)
Cost of Document*	Rs. 1000/- incl. taxes through online payment gateway to CONCOR
Tender Processing Fee (Non-Refundable)*	Rs. 2608/- (Inclusive of Taxes) through online payment
Period of Tender Sale (online)	from 07.10.2026 at 15:00 Hrs to 26.10.2026 at up to 16:00 hrs
Date and time of Submission of Bid	29.10.2026 at 17:00 Hrs
Date and time of opening of Bid	30.10.2026 at 11:00 Hrs

*Through e-Payment. For eligibility criteria and other details please log into www.concorindia.com or eprocure.gov.in or www.tenderwizard.com/COIL. Bidders are requested to visit the website regularly. CONCOR reserves the right to reject any or all the tenders without assigning any reasons therefor. For complete details login www.tenderwizard.com/COIL.
SGM/TA-1

NORTHERN RAILWAY
Tender Notice No. 47/2026-2027 Dated: 06.10.2026
Invitation of Tenders through E-Procurement system
Principal Chief Materials Manager, Northern Railway, New Delhi-110001, for and on behalf of the President of India, invites e-tenders through e-procurement system for supply of the following items:-

S. No.	Tender No.	Brief Description	Qty.	Closing Date
01	07260213	AIR SPRING SET	96 SET	29.10.26
02	77269033	RUNNING CONTRACT FOR CHECK A-RGC RAILS 9.5M LONG TO RDSO	500 SET	29.10.26
03	19255052	BLOWER FOR OIL COOLING UNIT WITH B CASING	196 NOS	02.11.26
04	77269031	RUNNING CONTRACT FOR C.I. FITTINGS FOR 1 IN 12 THICK WEB SWITCHES	100 SET	02.11.26
05	77269041	RUNNING CONTRACT FOR 1M LONG A-RGC FINISH PLATE	4880 NOS	19.11.26
06	77269038	RUNNING CONTRACT FOR 06MM NCR RGC GRSP	250 SET	20.11.26

NOTE- 1. Vendors may visit the IREPS website i.e. www.ireps.gov.in for details. 2. No Manual offer will be entertained.
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

Animal Husbandry Commissionerate, Maharashtra State, Pune.
e-Tender Notice
Animal Husbandry Commissionerate, Maharashtra State, Pune is inviting tenders from reputed and experienced bidders in the competitive tender process as follows.
e-tendering for procurement of essential medicines to organizations under animal husbandry department.
Tender forms to be filled by interested tenderers, nature of services and goods etc. Detailed information regarding this has been made available on the website dahd.maharashtra.gov.in. Submission of tender will be online and last date for submission of tender will be 26.10.2026 till 6.00 P.M.
Address: Animal Husbandry Commissionerate, Opposite Spicer College, Aundh, Pune, Maharashtra-411 067
Email: cah.diseasecontrol@gmail.com
signed by/
Commissioner Animal Husbandry, Animal Husbandry Commissionerate, Aundh, Pune- 67.
State of Maharashtra
dgipr/2026-27/3115

**JAMMU AND KASHMIR POLICE**
DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS JAMMU
0191-2561578 (O), 0191-254780 (F), Email- sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
Hue and Cry Notice
Rule No. 712/191
SHO P/S Jhajjar Kotli, Jammu has intimated that accused person namely Babar Choudhary S/O Mohd Hussain R/O Ward No. 04, Marralie Basti Miran Sahib, Tehsil R.S Pura, District Jammu is evading his arrest/wanted in case FIR No. 95 U/S 223 RPC, 11 PCA Act, 3/181 MV Act of P/S Jhajjar Kotli, Jammu, since the commission of crime. Despite repeated raids/efforts the accused could not be traced/still absconded.
It is therefore requested that Hue and Cry Notice of above mentioned accused is being published for the information of Police establishments / Public in general having any clue related to the whereabouts / present location of above named accused, kindly communicate the same on the below mentioned contact / Telephone numbers.
Description Roll :-
Name : Babar Choudhary
S/O : Mohd Hussain
Address : Ward No. 04, Marralie Basti Miran Sahib, Tehsil R.S Pura, District Jammu
Age : 26 Years
Height : 5'6"
Complexion : Wheatish
Eyes : Black
Contacts/Telephone Numbers:-
1. DPO, Jammu : 0191-2547807, 0191-2561578
2. SSP Jammu Mail I.D : sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
3. PCR Jammu : 0191-2605949
4. SP Rural Jammu : 0191-2605949
5. SDPO Nagrota : 0191-2673666
6. PHO P/S Jhajjar Kotli : 0191-2668008
Sr. Superintendent of Police
Jammu
DIP/J-11852/26 – DATE 06.10.2026

SALUTE THE SOLDIER
CENTRAL INDUSTRIAL SECURITY FORCE

Sl./FIRE
M. K. BALA SINGH
CISF UNIT/VSP
VIZAG
07-10-2000
CISF proudly remembers the supreme sacrifice of this brave-heart. On this day, he laid down his life while saving the lives of employees of Vishakapatnam Steel Plant during massive fire at Coal Chemical Plant. His courage and bravery would remain an abiding source of inspiration for the force. The force will remain eternally indebted to him for his noble deed.

HC (GD) Dharmeshwar Nath
CT (GD) Dileesh Chathuroli
CT (GD) Praveen P
CT (DVR) Vivek Kumar Yadav
"Sashastra Seema Bal" solemnly honors the selfless courage and indomitable spirit of HC (GD) Dharmeshwar Nath, CT(GD) Dileesh Chathuroli Thazhakuniyil, CT(GD) Praveen P and CT(DVR) Vivek Kumar of 41st Bn SSB, who made the supreme sacrifice for the Nation. On this day, they attained martyrdom in an IED blast carried out by anti-national elements in Dantewada, Chhattisgarh. Their unwavering dedication, heroic sacrifice, and steadfast commitment to duty shall remain etched in our collective memory, inspiring generations to uphold the values they so bravely defended.
"SASHASTRA SEEMA BAL"

**ARMY PUBLIC SCHOOL, DHAULA KUAN**
RIDGE ROAD DHAULA KUAN-110010
TENDER NOTICE
Sealed tenders are invited from leading firms with professional expertise for providing School Canteen Services to Army Public School, Dhaula Kuan. Firms with past experience in providing required services and having Registration No, EPF Code, ESI Code, GST Code etc may contact school office between 9:00 a.m to 3:00 p.m. on any working day for collection of tender forms costing Rs 500/- between 07 Oct 2026 to 21 Oct 2026 . Last date for submission of tender form is 22 Oct 2026 by 1100 hrs. Visit to access infrastructure availability at school can be organized at the time of tender collection. For any queries contact this No 9592398107 please.
Principal, APS, Dhaula Kuan

WB HIDCO
EOI notice No. 03 of 2026-2027
An Expression of Interest is invited from the Experienced Agencies having experienced in similar nature of empanelment works for "Engagement of Sculptor / Statue Maker agency in turnkey basis for making, supply and erection of 125 feet tall Bronze Statue of Dr. Syama Prasad Mookerjee at Eco Park, in New Town, Kolkata." Bid Submission closing (Online)- 02.11.2026 upto 12.00 Noon. Pre-Bid meeting on- 09.10.2026 at 12:00 Noon.
Sd/-
General Manager (Engg)-IV

**ANDHRA PRADESH POWER CO-ORDINATION COMMITTEE**
VIDYUT SOUDHA :: VIJAYAWADA
TENDER NOTICE
APPCO on behalf of the APDISCOMs inviting bids in single stage, two enveloped followed by e-RA through Bharat Electronic e-Tendering Portal vide Tender No.APPCO/BESS-02/2026-27 for setting up of 1500 MW / 6,000 MWh (4-hour) BESS capacity in Andhra Pradesh, for procurement by APDISCOMs, on Demand basis, under Tariff-Based Competitive Bidding (TBCB) on BOO Model. The interested and eligible applicants may participate in the bidding process through the ISN-ETS (Bharat Electronic e-Tendering) Portal and the Bid documents are available after 07.10.2026 at 19:00 hrs. The due date for submission of bids is 23.11.2026. For complete details and tender access visit: <https://www.bharat-electronictender.com> : Ph: 9493120085.
Sd/- Chief General Manager/APPCO
R.O.No.GMCC/APTRANSCO/164/26-27 Power Purchase & Legal

**JAMMU AND KASHMIR POLICE**
DISTRICT POLICE HEADOURTERS JAMMU
0191-2561578 (O), 0191-254780 (F), Email- sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
Hue and Cry Notice
Rule No. 712/191
SDPO City East, Jammu has intimated that accused person namely Bhala Parsad S/O Latta R/O Bihar A/P Trikuta Nagar Sec. 04, Jammu is evading his arrest / wanted in case. FIR No. 17/2004 U/S 457/380 RPC of P/S Bahu Fort, Jammu. Despite repeated raids/ efforts the accused could not be traced / still absconded.
It is therefore requested that Hue and Cry Notice of above mentioned accused is being published for the information of Police establishments/ Public in general having any clue related to the whereabouts/ present location of above named accused, kindly communicate the same on the below mentioned contact/ Telephone numbers.
Description Roll :-
Name : Bhala Parsad
S/O : Latta
Address : Bihar A/P Trikuta Nagar Sec. 04, Jammu
Age : 45-50 years
Contacts/Telephone Numbers:-
1. DPO, Jammu : 0191-2547807, 0191-2561578
2. SSP Jammu Mail I.D : sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
3. PCR Jammu : 0191-2605949
4

At 36, Bhuvneshwar is back as selectors shape plan for 2027 World Cup

India recall the veteran seamer for T20I series in New Zealand

Venkata Krishna B
Chennai, October 6

THE DECISION to include Bhuvneshwar Kumar in the T20I squad for the tour of New Zealand might have come out of the blue. But the call-up had been imminent over the last three months, particularly after the 36-year-old's IPL 2026, in which he took 28 wickets and finished one behind South Af-

rican Kagiso Rabada in the race for the Purple Cap. It was during the subsequent tour of the UK, after Harshit Rana was injured again, that Bhuvneshwar's name started doing the rounds.

It is close to four years since Bhuvneshwar last played for India. It was not a case of him suddenly losing his place: his last Test was in January 2018, his last ODI in January 2022, and by November that year, he was out of the T20I set-up too.

In the domestic circuit, his recent appearances have been limited to the Syed Mushtaq Ali T20 Trophy and the IPL, where he has bowled Royal Challengers Bengaluru to successive titles. Even then, an India

call-up appeared far-fetched.

But here he is again, back in India's T20I squad for the tour of New Zealand, and not because the first-choice players are busy with other commitments. There is a big picture that the selectors and the Indian team management are hoping Bhuvneshwar will help complete.

With India clearly short on balance, there are conversations around the possibility of taking the seamer to the 2027 World Cup to be played in South Africa, Zimbabwe and Namibia next year.

While there is little doubt regarding Bhuvneshwar's skills and what he offers with the ball,



Bhuvneshwar Kumar last played for India in Nov 2022. FILE

the only question is whether his body can take the load in ODI cricket again.

He last played the Vijay Hazare Trophy in 2023, and if he is to be considered seriously for next year's World Cup in southern Africa, it is understood that the selectors want to see where he stands in terms of fitness and whether he can take the load of bowling 10 overs.

Hard work pays off

Over the last couple of years, the work he has put in — he has hired a physio and trainer — has shown in the middle.

He has looked unplayable, making the new ball talk. From Sachin Tendulkar to

Virat Kohli, there has been admiration for how Bhuvneshwar troubled batsmen from different eras with his movement with the new ball: the wobble seam landing on the surface and moving either way, as he intended.

In a conversation with *The Indian Express* in June, just after the IPL, he had said it was up to the selectors to pick him if they felt he was worthy of an India recall.

"It's my nature that I don't want to show that I want to play," he said.

"Everyone is doing their job. Selectors are doing their job. I am doing my job. It is their responsibility to select. If

they think I am good enough, they will do their job. I have played, I have done what I had to do. If I had not played, I would have been dying to be asked to play a match. It is a big thing to play for India, and I am one of the lucky ones to have done so," he added.

Rarely does Indian cricket go back to a cricketer, particularly a fast bowler it believed it had moved on from, after four long years. But then not all are Bhuvneshwar Kumar.

T20I SQUAD FOR NZ TOUR:

Shreyas Iyer (C), Abhishek Sharma, Sanju Samson (WK), Vaibhav Sooryavanshi, Ishan Kishan (WK),

Tilak Varma (VC), Axar Patel, Shivam Dube, Nitish Kumar Reddy, Naman Dhir, Prince Yadav, Mayank Yadav, Arshdeep Singh, Bhuvneshwar Kumar, Varun Chakaravathy, Kuldeep Yadav.

INDIA A SQUAD FOR NZ TOUR:

Yashasvi Jaiswal, KL Rahul, Devdutt Padikkal, Ravichandran Smaran, Rishabh Pant* (WK), Dhruv Jurel (C) (WK), Washington Sundar, Auqib Nabi, Akash Deep, Anshul Kamboj, Manav Suthar, Mukesh Choudhary, Sai Sudarsan, Yash Rathod, Mukesh Kumar,* Subject to fitness.

“There were moments when I had to put my individual performance, my own growth, and what I wanted for myself aside, because I believed the team had to come first.”

HARMANPREET KAUR, AFTER QUITTING INDIA CAPTAINCY

Leader who made India believe

Harmanpreet quits as India's only Women's World Cup-winning skipper, leaving a legacy beyond the trophy

Shankar Narayan
Mumbai, October 6

HARMANPREET KAUR ran back to complete the catch that sealed India's 2025 ODI World Cup triumph. The captain who had carried Indian women's cricket through expectation was there at the finish.

But her legacy is bigger than that trophy.

Harmanpreet leaves captaincy having changed what India expects from itself. Before her, India had reached the ODI World Cup final in 2005 and 2017 under Mithali Raj. Under Harmanpreet, India became regulars at the business end of tournaments: the 2018 T20 World Cup semifinal, the 2020 T20 World Cup final, the 2023 T20 World Cup semifinal and, eventually, the 2025 ODI World Cup title at home.

Her biggest contribution was renewed belief. Semifinals and finals were no longer a flash-in-the-pan moment. India started to feel like they belonged there.

She took over when Indian women's cricket was growing, but was still searching for consistency and belief. At the 2018 T20 World Cup, her first major tournament as captain, she announced herself with a 103 against New Zealand. It was a statement of the captain she would be: aggressive, unafraid of the big stage.

That intensity stayed with her. Harmanpreet was emotional, vocal and sometimes combative. Players were coming in with bigger ambitions, and her job was to build a team that believed it could compete at the highest level.

Her batting, however, became less consistent as the years went by. Her strike rate was a concern. The Harmanpreet who could win a match from anywhere showed up less often.

But she still produced when India needed her.

In the 2025 ODI World Cup semifinal against Australia, with India chasing a record target, Harmanpreet scored a pivotal 89 and helped to keep the chase alive alongside Jemimah Rodrigues.

A year later, in a must-win T20 World Cup game against Australia, she made 56 off 27, hitting three sixes in the final over to take India to a competitive total.

Those innings offered reminders of the player India will want to see more often.

In her farewell post, Harmanpreet acknowledged the cost of captaincy herself. "There were moments when I had to put my individual performance, my own growth, and what I wanted for myself aside, because I believed the team had to come first," she wrote.

There were difficult days too: defeats, criticism, ques-



Harmanpreet Kaur took the winning catch in the 2025 Women's ODI World Cup final in Navi Mumbai that helped India lift their maiden ICC title. AP

Decision to step down came after a nudge from selectors

Venkata Krishna B & Devendra Pandey
Chennai/Mumbai, October 6

tions over her decisions. She faced them as openly as she celebrated the wins.

"I gave this team everything I had," she wrote. "I carried the responsibility with pride."

She said every difficult decision was made with one intention: "to make this TEAM better and to give other players the opportunity to grow, believe in themselves and become the best versions of themselves."

She leaves behind a team in which Smriti Mandhana has become the batting leader, Deepti Sharma a central figure, and younger players such as N Sree Charani have emerged with confidence. It is a team that has won a World Cup and now knows what it feels like to be there.

Harmanpreet wrote that she leaves captaincy with "a heart full of emotions, but also with PEACE" because she believes the team is in a good place. It is a team with "talent, character, belief and a future" that she is excited to be part of.

Her post ends: "Now, I'm ready to play for the love of the game again." That is what Indian cricket will hope for.

Without the burden of captaincy, Harmanpreet can now focus on being the batter who can change a game. At 37, the hope is that giving up the captaincy brings back more of her best batting. India have a home global event, the Women's Champions Trophy, in February next year, before bigger challenges arrive in 2028 and 2029.

She says she has "done her duty". She leaves the next captain with more than a World Cup trophy: a team that believes it can compete on the biggest stages.

"Captaincy ends. The journey continues," Harmanpreet wrote. For Indian cricket, the hope is that the next chapter brings back the player who made everyone believe.

A YEAR after leading India to the ODI World Cup, Harmanpreet Kaur stepped down as captain of the national women's cricket team in all formats — a surprise decision that she announced through an Instagram post Tuesday, a day after attending a team review meeting with BCCI officials and selectors in Guwahati.

The 37-year-old also said in the post that she was ready to continue playing for the country. "Now, I am ready to play for the love of the game. Captaincy ends. The journey continues," she posted.

The ODI World Cup at home last year was the team's first ever ICC title. But this July, the side failed to progress to the knockout rounds of the T20 World Cup for the second time in a row, prompting the selectors to decide on a change in leadership — although Harmanpreet was keen to continue, BCCI sources told *The Indian Express*.

"The decision to move on from Harmanpreet as captain was by the selectors. After the end of the T20 World Cup, a review meeting was planned. But it took place after the Asian Games (where the team won gold). Harmanpreet wanted to continue as captain, but the selectors prevailed. The selectors felt it was time to build for the next World Cup cycle. There was no question of split captaincy," the sources said.

The Indian Express has learnt that women's team coach Amol Muzumdar, vice-

30-year-old Mandhana named captain hours after Harmanpreet steps down



Smriti Mandhana has been part of the Indian team since 2013. CREIMAS

With Harmanpreet at the helm, India became a top contender: 2018 T20 World Cup semifinal, 2020 T20 WC final, 2023 T20 WC semifinal and, eventually, the 2025 ODI WC title.

captain Smriti Mandhana and Harmanpreet met separately with BCCI secretary Devajit Saikia and women's selection committee chief Amita Sharma in Guwahati.

Mandhana (30) was named captain hours after Harman-

preet stepped down as skipper.

Harmanpreet's last assignment as captain was the Asian Games campaign, where India defended its title. She captained India in five Tests, 51 ODIs and 155 T20Is, and also led the team to three Asia Cup titles. She was appointed T20 captain in 2016 and took over the reins of the ODI team in 2022 after Mithali Raj's retirement.

India had reached the ODI World Cup final in 2005 and 2017 under Mithali. With Harmanpreet at the helm, India became a top contender in the international arena: 2018 T20 World Cup semifinal, 2020 T20 World Cup final, 2023 T20 World Cup semifinal and, eventually, the 2025 ODI World Cup title. However, India were

knocked out in the group stage of the 2024 and 2026 T20 World Cups.

In an official statement, BCCI president Mithun Manhas said Harmanpreet's "contribution as captain will always hold a special place in the history of Indian cricket".

"She took on the responsibility at an important stage in the growth of women's cricket and helped the Indian team build on the strong foundation laid by those who came before her. Over the years, she led India through some very important moments and helped the team compete with confidence against the best in the world. The World Cup victory in 2025 will undoubtedly be the defining achievement of her captaincy," Manhas said.

Saikia also highlighted the World Cup win in his tribute. "Harmanpreet, you can be immensely proud of what you have achieved as captain of India. You embraced the responsibility from the very beginning and went on to lead India through some of the most important moments in its journey, while playing an important role in the growth of Indian women's cricket," he said.

"You experienced the disappointment of falling short, but continued to believe in the team and its ability to achieve more. That is what made the World Cup victory in 2025 so special. You had been part of the journey for many years and eventually had the opportunity to lead India to its first women's cricket World Cup title. That will always remain one of the great moments in Indian cricket," Saikia said.



Shreyas Iyer got to his first T20I ton off just 42 balls. VISHALSRIVASTAV

Shankar Narayan
Mumbai, October 6

THE LAST time Shreyas Iyer scored a T20I half-century before Tuesday was nearly three months ago — an unbeaten 80 against England at Bristol. Since then, he had not crossed 30 in 10 matches, with India's top three often taking the pressure off him.

The script changed dramatically at the Ekana Stadium in Lucknow. Chasing 172, Iyer walked in with India 35/2. India had lost both openers inside the first 21 balls. Roston Chase and Akeal Hosein had found early rhythm with the ball. Iyer absorbed the early pressure before turning the game decisively in India's favour.

The opening came in the sixth over. Shamar Joseph needed to build on the spinners' start. Instead, he gave Iyer and India a release. He conceded 12 runs as Iyer went aerial over cover before repeating the treatment against Romario Shepherd. The West Indies kept bowling outside off, but on a pitch offering little movement, Iyer was able to free his arms and find the gaps.

It forced the bowlers to go short. That had been regarded as a weakness in Iyer's game. On Tuesday, he repeatedly brought out the pull against the rising delivery and found success. He reached his fifty in 28 balls, but the acceleration was only beginning.

After seeing off the pacers, Iyer turned his attention to spin. Hosein was brought back in the 13th over and Iyer gave himself room before launching him over extra cover. The next over brought an assault on Forde, as Iyer struck two sixes before pulling another delivery over the boundary.

He was given a reprieve when Joseph could not hold on to a miscued shot towards long-on. He reached his maiden T20I hundred with a six before India completed the chase in just 14.4 overs.

Kishan's role

At the other end, Ishan Kishan found himself playing a different role. Walking in at No.3, he did not try to match Iyer's aggression. Instead, he played the perfect supporting act, rotating the strike and waiting for opportunities to attack.

His first boundary came when he went back to a slightly short delivery from Chase and whipped it through the leg side. Against Joseph, he then found the boundary through cover before taking advantage of another hit-me delivery from the pacer. He pulled Shepherd for a boundary and later cut

Hosein through the off side, while his running kept the chase moving.

There was one moment of drama when Kishan miscued a full toss towards deep cover. Forde appeared to have taken the catch, but the TV umpire ruled that the ball had touched the ground. By then, however, the partnership had taken complete control. Kishan stayed unbeaten as he and Iyer added 137 for the third wicket, allowing India to race home with 32 balls to spare.

Earlier, India's spin trio did the heavy lifting after the West Indies threatened to set a daunting score in good batting conditions. After Arshdeep Singh and Mayank Yadav failed to hit their straps early, Axar Patel, Kuldeep Yadav and Naman Dhir combined to take seven wickets for 90 runs, recovering from a middle-overs assault by Shai Hope and Sherfane Rutherford to keep the total manageable.

After Shimron Hetmyer was run out, Axar dismissed Rovman Powell for nought to leave the West Indies 44/3 after six overs. But Hope and Rutherford then shifted the momentum, taking on Kuldeep and forcing Iyer to look elsewhere.

Kuldeep, playing his first T20I since February, conceded 24 in his first two overs as Rutherford lofted him over cover and Hope swept him over wide long-on. Iyer brought him back after Hope's dismissal at 107/4.

Then came the turnaround. Kuldeep found his lengths and Roston Chase fell lbw, going back to a delivery he should have played forward to. His final two overs cost only nine runs and brought two wickets, including Matthew Forde.

Dhir, meanwhile, made an immediate impact on debut. After being handed the ball, he dismissed Hope for 52 before returning to remove Romario Shepherd and Shamar Springer. His three wickets gave India the control they needed.

Axar's miserly spell, Kuldeep's comeback and Dhir's three wickets ensured India recovered despite the pacers' discipline. The late 36-run stand between Rutherford and Akeal Hosein gave the West Indies something to defend, but the spinners had already done enough to keep the target within reach.

BRIEF SCORES: West Indies 171 all out in 19.1 overs (Sherfane Rutherford 56, Shai Hope 52; Naman Dhir 3/31, Axar Patel 2/26, Kuldeep Yadav 2/33) lost to India 172/2 in 14.4 overs (Shreyas Iyer 102 not out, Ishan Kishan 37) by 8 wickets.



